MINJOK HERALD

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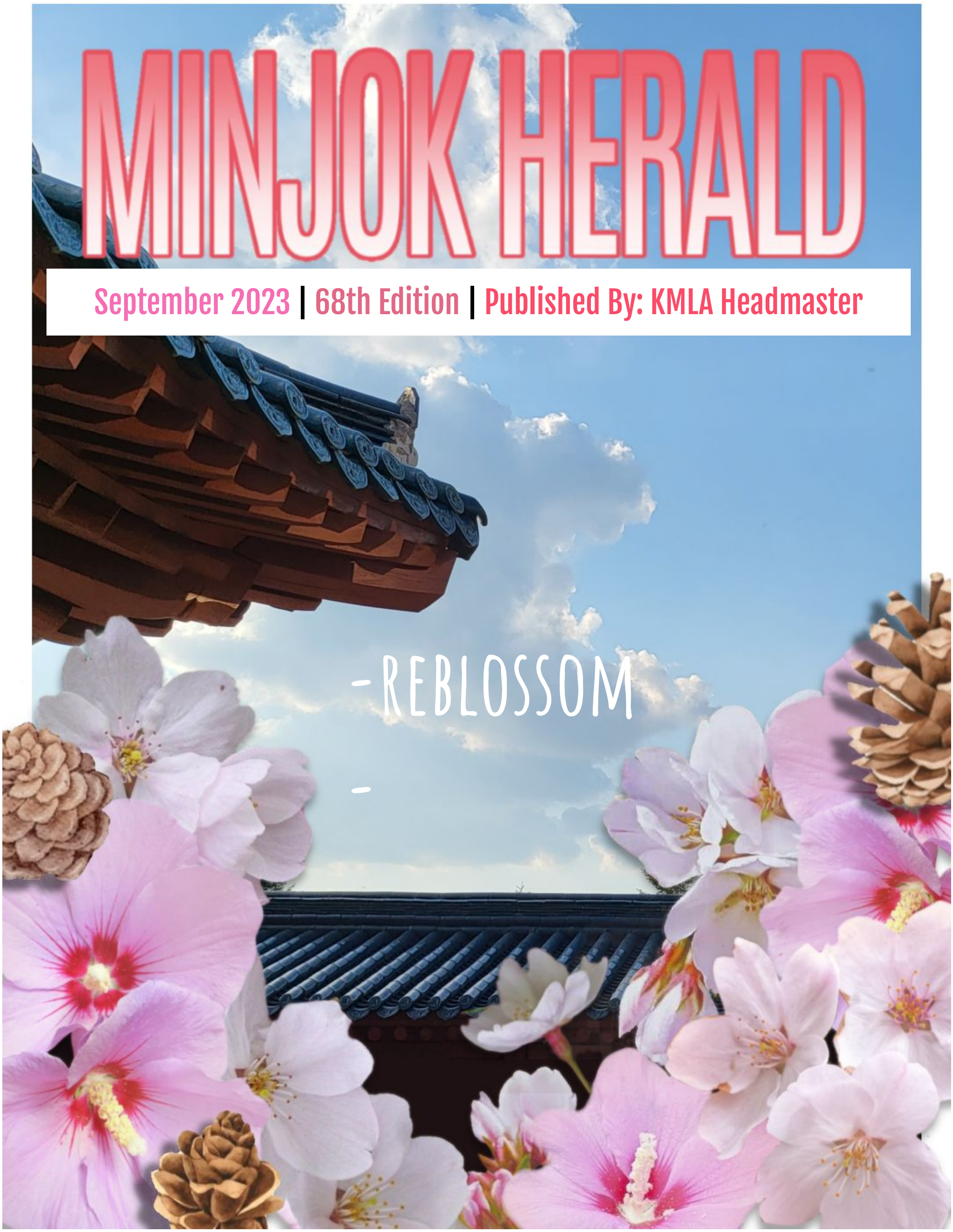

-REBLOSSOM

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Editor's Note

Dearest Readers,

"Put it before them briefly so they will read it, clearly so they will appreciate it, picturesquely so they will remember it, and above all, accurately so they will be guided by its light." This quote comes from Joseph Pulitzer, one of history's most famous newspaper publishers. Nowadays, the power of the newspaper itself has reduced tremendously. We can barely see someone reading a newspaper or even holding a newspaper around us. Minjok Herald and many other newspapers have been facing downfalls recently. However, the power of reading articles still exists today beyond any other literature piece we can find. As Pulitzer states, journalism exists for the spirit of remembrance, and readers should be able to appreciate and find a guiding light within themselves while reading the article. Readers can explore the insights of ongoing issues of the world and shatter the barriers of beliefs they locked within themselves. Within these values, journalism will continue its spirit forever.

As the editor-in-chief of Minjok Herald, I had never experienced the power of words fully until I became the editor-in-chief seven months ago. Looking at many different articles that the beautiful team of Minjok Herald wrote, scamming through articles by other student-led journals such as Harvard Crimson, Yale Daily News, The Oxford Student, and many others, I and the rest of Minjok Herald were able to see the insights of each journalist, their perspective of the world, and most importantly their love towards enlightening others through their pen and MacBook. Trying to convey all the spirit of journalism we learned, struggling to write the perfect editor's note, and pressing the backspace button furiously, I realized it's nearly impossible to shift others' minds how I want them to feel.

Even though there is a saying you can't break a rock with an egg, if there's a single crack we can make by throwing the egg, it's worth all the shots we took. Through this edition of Minjok Herald, we wish to deliver the spirit of journalism itself RE BLOSSOMING the essence of journalism. KMLA started to rebloom after three years of COVID-19, with vision trips coming back, masks being taken off, graduation and entrance ceremonies coming alive, and all the other everyday events that we could never feel for the past three years. Along with the blooming of KMLA, it's time for journalism to bloom the power it has. With the hectic life schedule of KMLA, debating till 2 a.m., dealing with all the essays and work we have to finish, writing sponsorship emails for buying a Lacrosse goal post, playing Lacrosse till midnight, organizing climate conference, making a booklet for the most valuable children alive, and so many other things going on reading Minjok Herald would be the least essential thing in the readers' mind. However, we hope the readers take time and immerse themselves in the spirit of the words written in this edition of Minjok Herald.

To the members of Minjok Herald, I want to express my sincere gratitude for the tireless efforts and dedication you've put into this edition. The success of the 68th edition simply wouldn't have happened without your passion and commitment.

Hopefully, this edition gives you a spark of new thoughts, shatters the beliefs you had, and, most importantly, finds your guiding light within the soul of articles.

With lots of love,
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Minho Choi

Suh-yoon Jahng

Minseo Kang

Jeonggyeom Kuk

Sangmin Lee

Seyoung Lim

Daeun Song

Seoeun Yang

Jiwoo Ye

PLAYLIST

FOR THE 68TH EDITION

We are Young Fun

Empire state of mind Pt.2 Alicia Keys

Party in The U.S.A Miley Cyrus

Sunflower Post Malone, Swae Lee

New Rules Dua Lipa

Never Gonna Give You Up Rick Astley

Better Days One Republic

Rise Katy Perry

Fight Song Rachel Platten

Unstoppable Sia

Roar Katy Perry

Stronger Kelly Clarkson

The Climb Miley Cyrus

Flowers Miley Cyrus

Bloom Troye Sivan

Poker Face Lady Gaga

May we never ever shed
another tear for today

'Cause oh, I know that
there'll be better days

From 'Better Days'

"Reblooming" with Teachers@KMLA

With what we now know as "The Covid-Era" thankfully in our rearview mirror (at least for now), The Minjok Herald reached out to our beloved teachers to gain a sense of how and if they are experiencing this sense of "reblossom" in their constant efforts to maintain and strengthen the ideals of the Korean Minjok Leadership Academy. Here is what we learned.

"What aspect of life at KMLA was toughest for you during the Covid-era?"

Most teachers mentioned the challenges presented by students wearing masks. Despite the safety they provide, Mr. Kim Ilsoo and Mr. Eom mentioned the emotional connection that masks hindered, while Mr. Garrioch compared the experience to scuba diving. "With half of everyone's face missing, it often felt like teaching underwater where communication needs extra body language and volume and eye contact to compensate. Not always bad, but taking off the mask and being above the surface again is a breath of air we all needed." Ms. Whang mentioned witnessing how students had such limited access to the full experience of KMLA. "As a teacher, my biggest regret was not being able to interact freely with my students. I felt that they were not able to fully enjoy the community such as free dormitory life and various events."

"Over the past year with restrictions lifted, what mood, event, or activity made you happiest to see returning?"

Many teachers simply mentioned how seeing faces in full view recharged their desire to teach. "Of course, the return of various events is great," said Mr.Ilsoo Kim. "But I was even more happy that students and teachers could see each other's faces and see the look in each other's eyes." Another teacher mentioned the difficulty of teaching on Zoom, and now being able to witness how students are reacting to lectures: "It's so nice to walk back and forth in front of the white board again." Ms. Whang cited socialization as the thing she's happy to have again. "Before the coronavirus, students used to come and spend time with us during breaks…In fact, I didn't realize it before, but now that I've been deprived of that opportunity while doing virtual classes, I can feel how important those small moments of socialization were. I feel that the time to talk and get to know students freely and comfortably, without having to wear a mask, is precious." For Mr. Garrioch, he's simply happy to see students traveling again. "I think the Vision Trip coming back gives the students a lot of impulse to study hard and have clearer goals. It's such an essential KMLA experience that is also about friendship. Just the ability to interact with the world without having to check your temperature or to constantly worry about a back-up plan is incredibly liberating. I am thrilled to see eager students getting out there again and experiencing everything from competitions to alumni interviews."

"Is there any aspect of KMLA's life before Covid that you feel hasn't returned as you might hope?"

Many teachers mentioned the word "connection" still seems slow to return in some aspects, be it socially or with the surrounding community, but most predominantly with mentorship between upper and lower classmen. Ms. Whang, who knows the inner workings of student life like no other, had this to say: "The biggest thing I feel is student autonomy. In the past, it seemed that seniors learned by overseeing the activities of the student government directly, and that it was naturally inherited by the juniors. But the 24th student government was really hindered by not being able to conduct face-to-face, and the 25th student government did not have the opportunity to model themselves with as much confidence. So it seems that student autonomy is being carried out with a different feeling. It's not that it's good or bad, it's just that I feel there is still a bit of disconnect. Despite that disconnect, I think it's really great that the 26th, 27th, and 28th students are all participating to reinvigorate student autonomy." Mr. Garrioch, the advisor for The Minjok Herald, wonders about the health of club activities. "As the article "Candlelight Spirit" written by Jimin Ha in this edition mentions, KMLA's connection to local residents in the surrounding school area perhaps hasn't come back strongly or quickly enough. I also wonder what clubs have vanished and which ones have evolved - for better or worse - and why some of these changes have happened. Maybe there's an idea for the next edition?" We will wait and see.

"What do you feel is essential for KMLA to fully 'blossom'?"

Not unexpectedly, most teachers had lots of bright and positive words for this question. Mr. Ilsoo Kim emphasized "for both light and heavy topics, free discussion and making eye contact with each other to create and implement new thoughts." Another teacher emphasized the need for patience, as getting back to "normal" should not be a race despite a new sense of freedom. Perhaps Mr. Albert Lee, one of our newest teachers, said it best: "Teamwork, some hard work, love, and, of course, plenty of sunshine!"

Letter for Mr. Shin

Dearest Mr Shin,

These days, you are always in my thoughts. The fact that I never had the chance to give you a hand written letter devastates me. This may be too late, but I hope with all my might that this letter reaches you wherever your soul has peacefully come to rest.

Going into the Chemistry Lab feels so different now. Your kind voice echoes in my memory and reminds me "We will do more experiments at the end of the year!" I can easily picture the times I spent in the lab in your summer session classes. We'll take care of the lab well, Mr Shin. You don't have to worry.

I cannot imagine how I could have gone through my first year at KMLA without you. I was able to grow a massive love for science and our school thanks to you. You are the reason that I have decided to plunge myself deeper into studying science, both during and after my high-school years. Whenever I had a question, disregarding how silly or obnoxious it was, you were always willing to answer me. Writing about this reminds me of the time when I asked you the difference between a "theory" and a "law". You enthusiastically answered my question, and a few days later checked on me if I had understood it correctly. Thinking about it, I was (and always will be) proud that I had you as both my chemistry teacher and life teacher.

In many ways, you were like a father to me- a loving man with whom I have shared so many memories, a teacher that makes me feel proud just by standing next to him, a person that I can always reach out to, a person that I will always miss. It breaks my heart that I will never be able to say this to you in person.

I wish that you will now let go of any hardship, pain, or sorrow that you had and rest in peace. The time that I was able to meet you was short, but it contains a lot of happy memories. Everything you told me is and will always be a big part of me, something that I will cherish and remember for the rest of my life.

I, and the other students you may have inspired just as equally, will always remember your smile and cheerful voice.

Until we meet again,

Jung Won Shin

Welcome to KMLA

8 A New Era for the Korean Department with a Whiff of Fresh Air

10 The New Celebrity of KMLA Appeared

11 The King of Economics Enters the Era of KMLA

12 A New Element for the Set of KMLA

14 The Enthusiastic Astronomist

15 From Philosophy to Schoolosohpy

A NEW ERA FOR THE KOREAN DEPARTMENT WITH A WHIFF OF FRESH AIR: MR. KISOON PARK AND MR. YEONSEOK ROO

27th waver Inyoung Yi

Just like students, teachers come and go from the KMLA family, and recently the Korean Department welcomed, two new teachers, being Mr. Park Ki-Soon and Mr. Roo Yeon-seok. Before joining us, both Mr. Park and Mr. Roo graduated from Seoul National University. While Mr. Park has already worked in various high schools, this will be Mr. Roo's first time becoming a full-time highschool teacher ever since he completed his Master's and Ph.D. I simultaneously interviewed both of them in an effort to introduce them to their new community of eager students. This interview was done on March 15th, at Mr.Roo's office with both Mr.Park and Mr.Roo.

MH: To start, since you both majored in literature, what is your favorite literature piece?

Roo: "Heonhwa-ga" ("The Song of Everlasting Sorrow"). It is a poem related to the story of Lady Su and the historical background, which I only knew as historical material rather than a work of literature. It was a fresh shock to discover that it is a work that deals with themes that every human being cannot help but face. It allowed for new interpretations and perspectives. It made me realize that the knowledge I gained from literary works was not superficial and that literature does not have a definitive answer. I discovered this when I was 21 years old. Also the 10-volume "Samgukji" (The Three Kingdoms) by author Im Yeon-yeol. It deals with the same subject matter as many others, but reading Im Yeon-yeol's novelization of the Three Kingdoms showed me that the same material can be portrayed differently depending on the author's writing style. It can captivate people. I could feel that the words in the novel were able to draw people in. It's a work that anyone who wants to write their own novels or poems should read.

Park: "Jeulgeoun Pyeonji" (The Joyful Letter) by Hwang Dong-kyu. Although it seems like a story between lovers, I think it would be good to show this kind of attitude in relationships between people. I would like to use it in literature classes.

MH: I thought you would share a more familiar piece with us, but all of those pieces sound so intriguing. I should try them out sometime! Getting to know more about you, when were you the happiest in your life?

Roo: I would say happiness is something that should continue on. Happiness that has a beginning and an end cannot be considered something unforgettable. Happiness has increased since I came to KMLA last year.

Park: The happiest moment for me was when my first child was born and I took parental leave. It was the first time I had ever rested in my life.

MH: I feel that! What about in high school. What's your favorite high school memory?

Roo: My happiest high school memory was when the results of the early admissions for Seoul National University were announced. I was incredibly thrilled. I vividly remember that moment from turning on the computer to checking the results.

Park: My favorite high school memory was getting accepted into Seoul National University. It was the best feeling since high school was mostly about running towards university itself.

MH: I can sense the happiness through your facial expressions from here as well. Then why did you decide to apply for a Korean major? Why did you become a teacher?

Roo: I've always enjoyed reading literature since I was young. My parents had jobs related to writing, so I naturally received their influence. I initially planned to pursue a similar field of study, such as journalism or Korean literature. However, it was through the influence of my teachers that I became aware of the Korean education major and decided to choose it.

Park: During my time in middle school, I went through a period of confusion and uncertainty. My Korean teacher at the time gave me a lot of books and encouraged me to focus. After performing poorly on the college entrance exam, I decided to enter a teacher training college. While enjoying my time as an exchange student in Denmark, I realized that being a teacher would align well with my personality.

MH: You guys are both such amazing teachers. I'm so glad to have you as my teachers. So you've achieved at least one of your dreams. What else is on your bucket list?

Roo: I want to earn my degree and then go on a solo trip abroad. I want to travel alone and explore freely according to my schedule, without being limited by money or time.

Park: I've never really thought about a bucket list. I've never planned for the future. I'm more focused on living diligently in the present.

MH: I'm more of a dreamer so I can't relate to Mr. Park, but I wish all of your dreams come true! Continuing this happy mood, where's your happy place?

Roo: If you look beside the archery range, there's a small path near the guesthouse. At around 9:30 to 10:00 PM on clear nights without clouds, you can see the stars beautifully because no tall mountains are obstructing the view. Watching the stars there is my hobby. I get excited at the thought of stargazing. Mr. Song recommended an app for stargazing, and thanks to that, it became more fun than ever.

Park: Home. A home with children. Joy is multiplied by a hundred, and challenges are also quadrupled. However, it's difficult without them.

From University Alumni

MH: **Aww, that's so sweet of you. Looking at your faces, you seem to be enjoying KMLA life so far. Why did you come to KMLA and do you ever regret it?**

Roo: Before coming here, I was a graduate student. If you ask your parents, if they are professors, you'll understand that the doctoral program is exhausting, financially and physically. Since my major is education, pursuing a Ph.D. allows me to be a teacher at a school. Although it hasn't been a long time, I have had temporary teaching experiences for 1-3 months at several schools and I wanted to work at a school where I can settle down and stay for a long time. That's when Mr. Lee recommended me a good opportunity and offered me a position. After going through interviews and selections, I joined KMLA. I have no complaints about the teaching profession itself, working with colleagues, or the classes. My only regret is that when I first started, during the first weekend, I didn't go to Seoul and stayed here. I felt as if I was left alone in this world. Everything was empty including the Baemin application. Now I always go home every week, without exception, on my days off.

Park: I came to KMLA with a strong ambition for teaching. I don't have many regrets because there haven't been many major incidents compared to Sadae High School, so it's been alright. However, hanbok (traditional Korean clothing) is very expensive. I'm currently using Durumagi and a hat that Mr.Kwon lent me. I love clothes, but pretty Hanboks are expensive, and cheap clothes aren't pretty.

To work colleagues

MH: **Our interview is coming toward the end, sadly. Do you have any life tips you want to share with KMLA community before ending?**

Roo: My life motto has changed. Do not live while focusing on the big picture (this doesn't apply to students actually). As we become adults and grow older, let's not live just focusing on the big picture. In the past, I used to think we should live according to a predetermined plan, but at some point, I realized that I became trapped by the big picture. Nowadays, the world changes rapidly, and the picture I paint can frequently change. It seems that the current trend is to color as much as I want, then color as much as I want again, gradually completing the picture along the way.

Park: If you try with all of your heart for every moment of your life, all the paths that might seem bumpy become the best path for you.

THE NEW CELEBRITY OF KMLA APPEARED:

MR. ALBERT LEE

28th waver Jeonggyeom Kuk

Mr. Albert Lee is the new English teacher at KMLA. He previously taught students at GLPS, a summer camp affiliated with KMLA, and has now transitioned to a mainstream English teaching role. This interview was conducted on June 22nd.

MH: Can you briefly introduce yourself?

I'm originally from Ireland and have been living in Korea for 13 years. Teaching has been my lifelong passion. I taught as a high school teacher in Ireland for many years, then spent some time in America before coming to Wonju, where I worked as a university English teacher and lecturer until joining KMLA. Over the last decade, I've been deeply involved in the GLPS camp as the coordinator of the research/presentation program. This year, I officially joined the school as a full-time teacher. I currently live in Wonju and commute daily, and I'm delighted to be here.

MH: You said that you were a lecturer of the GLPS. Was there any impressive memory for the GLPS?

Certainly, there are many memorable moments, especially involving students who later became part of this school. The connection between the GLPS program and KMLA is very strong, and many students from my freshman classes have already studied with me in GLPS. Some special memories involve witnessing young, hardworking, and intelligent students achieve remarkable things within the framework of that program.

MH: What inspired you to become a KMLA teacher, and what do you love most about this school?

I've always felt like I was a part of this school, thanks to my extensive involvement in GLPS, where I've been a part of 20 camps. Many students I taught at GLPS later became students here, and I met many TAs and PAs who were already part of this school. The strong connection and my fondness for the place, along with knowing people who work here, made me want to be a part of it. Timing played a role, and it feels like the right moment.

MH: Can you share your favorite place in the school or in general?

I enjoy spending time at the gym. I'm involved with the Crossover basketball club, and I have a deep love for sports. Coaching these young athletes has been a rewarding experience, and they've achieved success through their dedication. While it's not because of me, I appreciate being around them. So, if I had to pick a favorite place to hang out, it would probably be the gym whenever there's free time.

MH: Do you have any personal goals you aim to achieve in life?

Absolutely, my main goal is quite simple—to do the best job I can in helping as many people as possible. Helping others improve or excel in their pursuits is deeply fulfilling. This isn't just a political statement; genuinely assisting someone is one of the most meaningful things one can do. While I may not have specific, pinpointed goals, as a teacher my overarching objective is to be as helpful as I can in my professional capacity.

MH: For students facing the challenges of high school, do you have any advice?

Of course. One of the most important roles we, as teachers, can play is to be more than just purveyors of subject matter. I often write 'take care of each other' on the board. I believe that forming friendships, cultivating strong relationships, and looking out for one another are the keys to success, whether here at school or in life in general. Building alliances and helping one another is fundamental. If you extend your hand to help someone, they, in turn, can help you. Trying to go it alone can be an arduous task and often makes things more difficult. So, my advice is to take care of each other, help each other, and never hesitate to ask for help when needed. Also, maintain a sense of humor in your life. These three principles can carry you through most challenges.

THE KING OF ECONOMICS ENTERS THE ERA OF KMLA:

MR. DOOKYUN WANG

Interview with Mr. Dookyun Wang, the new economics teacher at KMLA and a former university professor in New York, conducted on June 29th.

MH: Please introduce yourself briefly.

Wang: Hello, I'm DooKyun Wang, a Macroeconomist and now an Economics teacher at KMLA. I've had the privilege of working as a university professor in New York for about 10 years before joining this esteemed institution.

MH: What led you to choose economics as your major among all the other subjects?

Wang: When I applied to KMLA, I took a look back at my high school transcript and noticed an interesting trend. In my first year, my interest was in literature, in the second year, it was literature again, but in the third year, it had shifted to international economics. I was a bookish boy who loved poetry and literature, but when I was introduced to supply and demand curves, I couldn't stop pondering over other economic concepts. That's when I "thought" that teaching Economics was my calling and that studying Economics was the only thing I truly loved.

MH: After spending a long time studying economics, do you have a favorite theory that you encountered?

Wang: Honestly, after over 20 years of studying Economics, I don't have a favorite theory anymore. While I used to love Melitz (international economics) and Matsuyama (development), my affection for them has faded over time. My focus now is on imparting a holistic understanding of Economics to my students.

MH: That's understandable. Can you recall your happiest moment in life?

Wang: My wife would say it was the moment I first saw her, but truthfully, my memory is not so sharp when it comes to happy moments. A few unfortunate accidents in my life seem to have blurred many of my memories.

MH: Transitioning from being a university professor, what made you decide to become a high school teacher?

Wang: To be honest, I never thought that I would teach in a high school, but life has a way of surprising us. The opportunity to teach in an English-speaking environment, be a part of higher education, and work with great students at KMLA was a dream come true for me.

MH: If you were to take three things to the desert, what would they be?

Wang: Ah, that's an interesting question. In the desert, I would definitely need my Macbook Air to keep me entertained, a water canteen to stay hydrated, and my trusty desert boots to navigate the sandy terrain.

MH: Finally, any last tips or comments for the KMLA family?

Wang: To all of you, keep up the great work, you are doing just fine. Your passion for learning is inspiring, and I'm thrilled to be a part of this vibrant community. Go, Minjok Herald! As this is the last interview, I need to grade the Final exam. Please be attentive to the underlined points and remember to keep calm while signing your final exam. Good luck!

A NEW ELEMENT FOR THE SET KMLA={X | X IS A MEMBER OF KMLA}

MS. DONGSOON LEE

28th waver Seyoung Lim

Mathematics is an intricate subject that often challenges students in achieving high grades. The Math Department has welcomed a new colleague, Ms. Dong-soon Lee, who joined the task of teaching this tough subject to students. She is currently leading the freshmen classes and finished her graduate course before coming to KMLA. She also stayed as a teacher at Whimoon High School. This interview, done on June 22nd, will introduce her to students who had not been familiar with her.

MH: To start with the interview, how did you come to KMLA?

I visited the school once when I wasn't working here. My husband already had a job as a teacher. He said that the school needed a teacher. I didn't look KMLA up, but he just told me the school was hiring a teacher, so I thought of volunteering. It's rather light-hearted, I didn't have any decisive events in coming here.

MH: I see. Some connections happen without definite starts, but they move on to stronger bondings nonetheless. Then you have been in KMLA for nearly half a year. What are some positive and negative parts of this school as a teacher?

For the good parts, firstly, the students are highly focused on the class. That's a great plus point compared to ordinary high schools. And one more thing is that many students have mathematical thinking skills. Their questions are very intriguing. I can look at questions from different perspectives and understand their views, and their hardworking attitudes are also touching. I would say that's the positive side.
Some negative parts are that students are good at paying attention, but many are so tired because they are sleep deprived. And some just sleep in front of me. I don't want to understand that as an educator. But some students desperately try to stay conscious, and I feel sorry for them. I can't guarantee them their sleeping time. I hope you guys can do your schoolwork after sleeping for at least six hours, but many usually say, "I slept for four hours," or "Six hours is a lot of sleep." I think that's a minus point.

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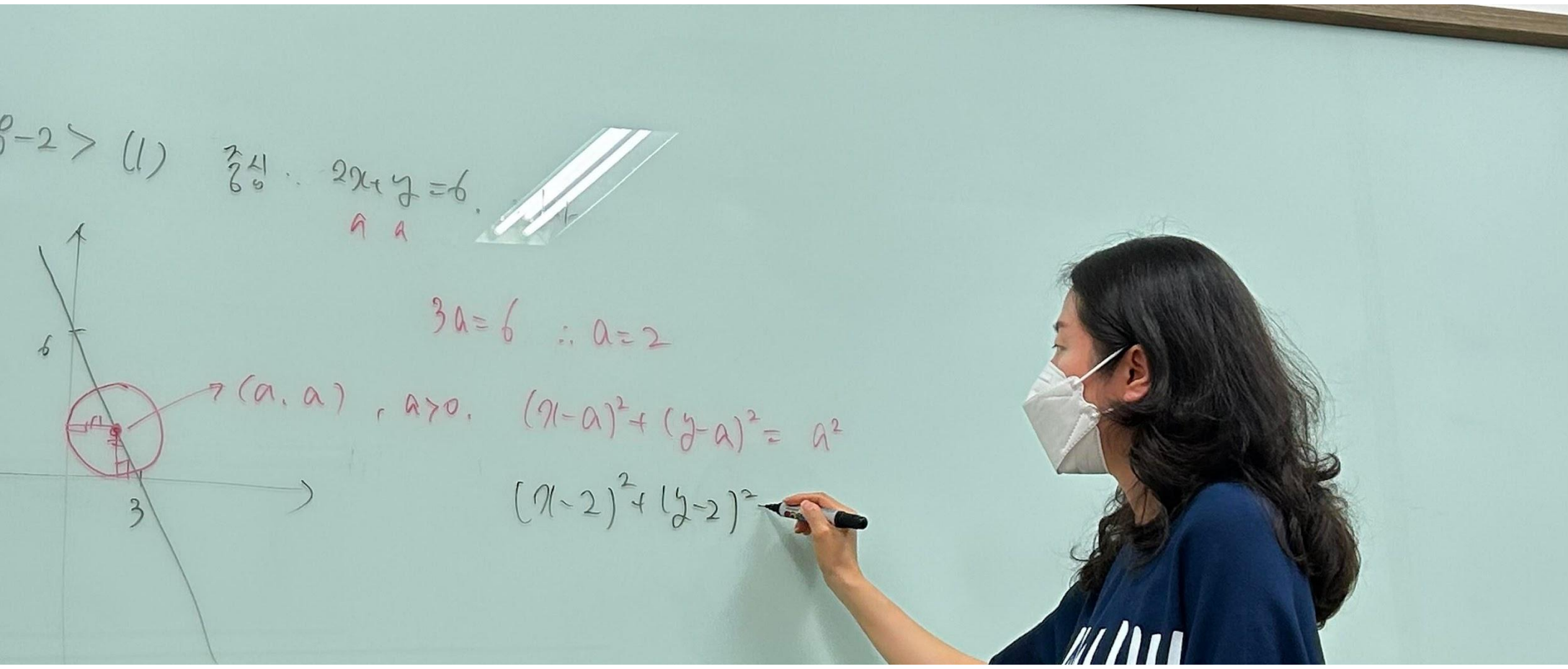
MH: I agree, it is hard to get enough sleep in this school. Continuing, I've heard you had been a teacher at Whimoon High School. Though it is a long past, how would you compare KMLA and Whimoon High School (WHS) when it comes to teaching?

Ardor for studying is nearly equal. But at that time, student admission was random because WHS was an ordinary high school. For a few students who had failed to enter technical high schools, they slept through the whole period. Students in athletic clubs barely turned up as well. There were extreme score gaps between the best and the worst grade. Except for that, everything else was quite similar. And since it was an ordinary high school, the government interfered with the educational curriculum a lot back then. It was solely textbook-based and focused on university admission. I'm not sure how WHS changed after it became a private school.

MH: That's a lot of detail! Then let's go to the farther past. Why did you become a teacher?

I never dreamt of a teacher. I had never thought of it and had never wanted it. But my time is different from yours, isn't it? It was normal for students to go to universities based on their test scores, not their interests. So my teacher recommended me to go to the College of Education. Since I liked Math and Chemistry, I applied for the two. I made Math the first choice but genuinely had hoped for a Chemistry major. But I qualified at my first choice so I couldn't even choose it. If I go back the time, I'd like to try Chemistry this time.



MH: Liking Math is not very easy for many students! How did you come to like Math?

I just liked it. I wasn't bored when I studied Math and didn't even recognize how time passed when solving Math problems. There are a lot of subjects in high school, right? I wouldn't study the other subjects because I was so immersed in Math. I would open other books but eventually come back to Math. Math teachers usually have the same reason: it's fun for them.

MH: I can see how much you liked Math by your face. I'll take a bigger range. What are on your bucket list?

I want to learn psychology. Living up until the moment, humans were the most difficult to understand. They're not logical at all. I couldn't understand why they would say something so weird in a specific context. It was out of the range of logic. That was confusing and frustrating, so I wanted to know about human minds. If I have enough time and energy, I would like to study it as a sort of refinement.

MH: It's amazing that you still have a new field to be interested in. Moving on, what mathematician do you respect the most?

There would be people who get Fields Medal like June E. Huh. But there are mathematicians other than those who are very passionate in their fields. So other than achievements and based on personality, there is a mathematician called Myung-hwan Kim. He wasn't my professor, but he taught Math to his students in a kind manner. When you continue to study Math, there are times when you experience frustration. Since all the questions are hard to understand and solve, you sometimes strive but don't have any results. In that aspect, that professor always reassured and waited for his students. Though he was in a different lab, he looked very warm.
Even apart from him, professors in Math Department that I've met were always good models as educators. They shared their ideas, tutored us well, and didn't care about financial problems. To be honest, professors at Seoul National University have a relatively small amount of salary because it's a national school. But they spent their money on students. I would say the atmosphere was different from most labs.

MH: What a heartwarming story! Taking this mood with us, math is used in various areas, isn't it? In your opinion, what is the most helpful math formula when we live in the world?

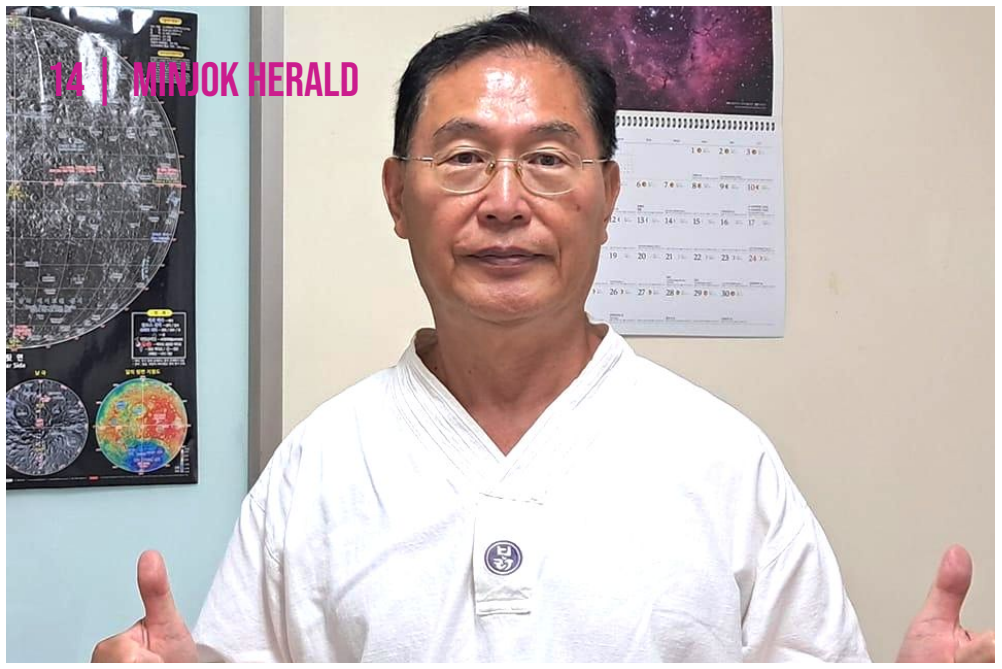
I can't think of a single formula, but I think what matters more is the way of thinking. Mathematicians have this logical thinking process. They are very good at deduction because they divide the steps of reactions in a certain situation with logical thoughts. For example, when there is a meeting with math teachers nobody talks irrelevant to the topic. And they generally know how to bend their opinions when it's proven wrong. So when you meet people who studied math in society you can see that their behaviors are usually organized. And to relate to my major, financial mathematics, you become thoughtful and almost skeptical when I consider purchasing a product.

MH: Those are surely needed for handling conflicts. Next is a bonus question by an anonymous 28th waver. When will the Math exams be easy?

I assume the midterms were the last chance. It can't get easy afterwards. During the second term, you will learn more versatile concepts-which means it will be harder for you. Until the midterms, teachers didn't have many choices in making the problems. So I'm sorry, but it won't be easier.

MH: That is sad news as a freshman myself. Heading to the end of the interview, how would you advise students who struggle with Math?

You have to like Math to be good at it. To do that, you need to feel satisfaction and a feeling of achievement. Don't linger on your mistakes or the questions you got wrong. Remember what you solved and be happy with it. And try to feel more of that happiness day by day. That's the important mindset.



THE ENTHUSIASTIC ASTRONOMIST MR. YOUNGUNG LEE

28th waver Seohyeon Choi

Astronomy, with its enigmatic allure, holds an endless array of questions waiting to be unraveled. Embracing an insatiable curiosity for the cosmos and armed with a wealth of knowledge, the esteemed Professor Lee has joined the ranks of KMLA's faculty. Eager to pursue the concept of "integrated education" during his lectures, he embarked on this new journey with enthusiasm. In this interview, we delve deeper into the life of Mr. Lee.

MH: You have given numerous lectures throughout your career. Could you tell us which one stands out the most and why?

My lectures usually cater to a diverse audience, spanning from elementary to college students, and even the general public. One, in particular, remains etched in my memory—the lecture I delivered on a small island near Wando. Initially, I was scheduled to speak at a high school on Nohwado and Bogildo, which required a lengthy 5-hour journey from Daejeon to Wando. To make the trip worthwhile, I decided to approach the Wando Office of Education, offering a donation lecture to multiple schools in the area. We ended up visiting three schools, including Nohwa Jungang Elementary School, which had a total of around 33 students in grades 4 to 6. Due to its remote location, not many people ventured there to lecture, making it an unforgettable experience for both the students and me. The children were thrilled beyond measure, eagerly asking an endless stream of questions during the Q&A session. It was heartwarming to witness their genuine curiosity, and I cherish their picture as my Facebook background to this day.

MH: There's a rumor that you place great importance on health care. Could you share the reason behind this and your secret to maintaining good health?

Until my late 30s, I never paid much attention to health care. Engaging in active sports like tennis, I inadvertently injured my back due to overexertion and had to face three years of challenging back pain. After consulting a doctor and receiving an x-ray, it was revealed to be a disc-related issue, causing the cartilage between the bone and the lumbar vertebra to protrude and press on the nerve. The doctor offered two options: surgery or physical therapy to avoid nerve compression. I chose physical therapy and, with time, managed to overcome the pain. This experience taught me the value of health, and I started practicing Kuksundo to strengthen my back. Since then, I've been highly conscious of my health, emphasizing exercise and mindful eating. Considering that our bodies are made up of elements derived from the universe and the food we consume, I focus on maintaining a healthy diet and avoiding harmful substances. This way, at the age of 68, I still possess youthful vitality and do not rely on any special medications.

MH: Thank you for sharing your valuable insights on health. Now, could you explain your motivation for choosing to teach at KMLA?

Professor Seok-beom Hong, who was in charge of astronomy here, had to take a year-long leave of absence due to family reasons, creating an opportunity for KMLA to seek an astronomy teacher. Coincidentally, I came across an article mentioning the school's search for an astronomy instructor shortly after retiring. Although I was primarily giving lectures during that time, various circumstances, including the pandemic, limited my speaking engagements. When I visited the school's website, the emphasis on integrated studies and the holistic educational approach caught my attention. As someone who has always enjoyed doing integrated lectures, the word "integrated" appealed to me, prompting me to apply for the position. I'm thrilled to be part of KMLA, where I can impart integrated knowledge and engage with students in meaningful discussions. It brings me immense joy to teach here.

MH: Your enthusiasm is palpable, and it's clear you love being here. Finally, could you tell us about any noteworthy astronomical phenomena we should look out for this year?

The realm of astronomy is replete with various phenomena to observe. I hold a deep interest not only in astronomy but also in climate change issues. The Earth's current state is the result of human presence and increased carbon emissions. Additionally, solar activity plays a vital role in shaping climate change throughout history. The sun, as a crucial celestial body, provides energy for all life on Earth. Its sunspot activity follows an 11-year cycle, but irregularities can occur, leading to variations in solar energy. These fluctuations have significant implications for our planet, reminiscent of past ice ages. While some argue that a large-scale ice age is unlikely to happen in this century, some solar astronomers propose the possibility of a minor ice age. Considering the urgency of global warming, we must remain attentive to solar activity and its potential impact on Earth.

MH: Thank you for your great answers. We wholeheartedly welcome you, Mr. Lee.

FROM PHILOSOPHY TO SCHOOLOSOPHY

MS. SOHYUN KWAK

28th waver Daeun Song

We often view philosophy as complex, yet it holds immense value. At KMLA, Ms. Sohyun Kwak, a philosophy major, teaches social studies to 1st graders and East Asian philosophy to 2nd and 3rd graders. Her students adore her for showcasing the charm of philosophy in her classes. Minjok Herald recently interviewed her, giving us insights into her unique teaching approach.

MH: What was the reason for your decision to become a teacher?

When I was teaching at a university after obtaining my Ph.D, about 30% of the students would disappear from the classroom after the midterm exam of the first semester. It continued like that. The reason was that students who felt freedom to think in college realized that their majors didn't suit their aptitude, so they changed majors, took a leave of absence, dropped out, or repeated a year. I also experienced the same thing when I was young, and even after 20 years, I still felt sad when I saw students who couldn't live their lives as they wished. People who can't live their lives as they want, who live according to others' thoughts, are physically alive but spiritually dead. Their eyes are lifeless, and they lack enthusiasm in everything they do. I wondered why we continue to nurture such people in Korea. I felt that someone had to make a change. So, while teaching at the university during the day, I gave philosophy lectures at nearby high schools in the evenings. One day, a student came to me and greeted me. It was a student who took my class three years ago when they were in 10th grade, and now they have become a university student and registered for my class. The student wanted to go to the College of Business Administration when they were in 10th grade, but their mother wanted them to become a doctor, so they said they would go to medical school. I remember we argued because I told them, "You'll regret it later." After that, I hadn't seen that student. When I asked, ‘So did you go to medical school now?’, he laughed and said he was attending business school. So I thought, ‘The philosophy class is effective’. If I worked as a teacher in high school, I moved to Aae High School because I thought, ‘I can raise people who study the way they want’.

MH: When are you happiest while teaching?

It is when I see students thinking. I am happy to hear them when they speak. They are not parrots who memorize and repeat other people's words, because they are living people. I am happy when I meet these “living people”.

MH: What motivated you to come to KMLA?

I worked as a philosophy teacher at my previous school for 3 years, but my contract expired. I was thinking about going back to college, but I fortunately found out about KMLA. A science teacher sat next to me in the faculty office before coming to KMLA, he applied for an autonomous private high school and failed. He went to Seoul National University and finished his master's degree at Korea University. So he kept saying that he didn't know why he failed. I was also curious about what kind of place it was. Then I read the news and it said that the autonomous private high school was on the verge of closing, so I applied. I thought, ‘If it’s not now, I won’t have a chance to work.’ After submitting the application form, I took a look around the school, and was surprised to find that the school lessons matched my usual educational goals. I applied because I wanted to contribute to nurturing students to have the ability to ‘Study according to their talent and aptitude’, so rather than chasing after wealth and fame.

MH: When is the happiest time of your life?

Maybe now. I like KMLA students. They are a bit different from other autonomous private high school students or general college students. They know how to think and speak for themselves. Also pure and polite. They are intellectually brilliant, and innocence is alive too. Also, I like the teachers. They have excellent professionalism and have a strong personality, which makes them attractive. Though we often fight over disagreements, but I think we have the same heart for the school. I am happy right now because I can spend my daily life with such wonderful people and learn from them.

MH: Do you have anything to say to high school students?

Rather than worrying about money, job, or future, I hope you take care of your soul now. “Am I living as myself now? Why are you studying? What kind of person do you want to become by studying?” If you continue to ask these questions and do not see study as a tool of getting a job but as a training to perfect yourself, you will become a person whose words, thoughts, and actions are consistent.

MH: What is the life goal you want to achieve?

I hope I can continuously help those who are studying philosophy and society, which I love. I hope they feel comfortable while being with me, affirming themselves as they are. And I want to become a writer who brings to life the beautiful breath of all beings in the world.

MH: Who is your favorite philosopher?

It's difficult to name just one person. My favorite philosophers have changed as my age and concerns have changed. In my 20s, I was interested in existentialism and social issues, so I studied Sartre, Foucault, Wittgenstein, Roth, Nietzsche, Marx, and Luce Irigaray. In my 30s, I wanted to become a true person, so I studied Laozi and Zhuangzi. I love all of them.

MH: Which philosopher will receive attention in 2023?

It would be François Jullien. He is a French philosopher who seeks to overcome the limits and decline of Western rationalism through Eastern thought. I deeply resonate with his insights, and he gave a lecture in Korea a few years ago. I'm not sure if he will receive public attention, but I think he is an important philosopher because he shows the potential to go beyond the limits of Western rationalism with Eastern thought.

NEWS

17 Welcome to Highschool , Freshman!
18 Changes: “Reblossom”
19 A Vote for Change; 35th Student Council Election
20 Looking Back to April Fools’ Day
21 Keeping Up with KMLA: Thank You Card Committee
22 Update From 28th Wavers: #Just _Finished_Midterm
23 The New MPT System in KMLA
23 Everything Except for Vision Trip
24 Vision trip Map
26 A Whole New World: 28th Waver’s Vision Trip, West Coast
26 KMLA Meets the World: 28th Waver’s Vision Trip, East Coast

31 Concentrate, Shoot, and Achieve
32 The Friendly Match: KMLA VS KSA
32 As Long as We are Here, We are Invincible: 2023 Gangwon State Championship
33 Alma Mater Homecoming Day A to Z: Until We Meet Again
34 Being an Adult: Coming- of-age ceremony
35 FRED: Fabulously Ravishing Educational Dialogues
37 A Bed-dazzling replacement: Finally, a good Night’s Sleep
37 Satire cartoon
38 Commemorative ceremony with KCC a.k.a. KMLA Patron

Freshmen... Welcome to High School!

28th waver Seoeun Yang

Close your eyes. Picture a school with a campus even bigger than some universities. One with green grass, and beautiful buildings built in the Korean traditional style. One filled with passionate students and brilliant teachers all dressed in traditional Korean clothing. That's the Korean Minjok Leadership Academy, or as some call it, KMLA. And that's the school that my fellow 28th wavers finally became an official member of this Wednesday.

On March 1st, the 28th entrance ceremony was held at KMLA. 156 students, all dressed in formal traditional Korean clothing, wore bright smiles on their faces as they officially entered high school. This was the first entrance ceremony not hampered much by Covid-19 in a few years. The ceremony was held in the auditorium and although many wore masks, it was filled with people. The event started at 10:30 in the morning and lasted for 2 hours, ending at 12:30.

The entrance ceremony started off with the opening parade. All teachers walked in and took their seats while students bowed to show respect. Processional and grand drumming performed by DaeChwiTa soon followed. Patriotic spirit was in the air as students, teachers, and guests saluted to the national flag and sang the national anthem. It was truly moving to see everyone become one at heart as they sang all the lyrics out loud.

All students recited the school motto and the goal of the English Only Policy, repeating after the two MCs, Junyoung Ro and Juhyun Kim. After, two teachers and two students went up on stage to recite the Declaration of Independence. Speeches were made by the headmaster and deputy headmaster, and awards and prizes were given to outstanding faculty members and students. Then, class presidents from classes 1 and 2 represented the freshmen during oath-taking.

Arguably the best part of the entrance ceremony, the candlelight ceremony began soon after. Students each lit up a candle, passing the flame to the person next to them until all candles were lit. Each student walked up to the front, holding their bright candle gently in their hands. Teachers then took the candles one by one and placed them on a stand. Hopeful candles created a majestic painting of orange hue, shining and glittering brilliantly.

Two student representatives from class 8 led all freshmen in reciting the 28th Wave KMLA Declaration. The declaration was written by the students, in which they stated future goals, hopes, and plans at KMLA. Soon, students were congratulated by the headmaster and invited guests. Next, the 28th wavers bowed to the 26th and 27th wavers and finally towards their parents, who supported them tremendously along the way. The ceremony was closed with a grand performance from Samuchim. Students sang the school anthem as well.

At the end of the ceremony, students were embraced by friends and family, who knew how hard each and every one of them worked to get to where they now stood. Smiling from ear to ear, students took pictures with their loved ones, both inside and outside the auditorium.

After the ceremony, many students went on to celebrate their new beginnings, with about 4 hours to spend with friends and family. Most went out for lunch and ate the famous Hoengseong hanwoo.

High school was a time I truly thought would never come. But now it has become a reality. I felt joy and pride, but also a hint of concern for the future, and a touch of sadness. I got the chance to ask some students about how they felt. One commented that they were glad that the ceremony was finally over, yet it felt a bit bittersweet. Another said that it felt great to finally enter high school and that they were excited about the upcoming classes. Some expressed their worry about their future life at KMLA.

A lot of different opinions were given on the entrance ceremony, but one thing is clear. We, the 28th wavers, are now official members of KMLA.

Welcome to high school, freshmen!

Changes: “Re-blossom”

28th waver Seohyeon Choi

What does it mean to “re-blossom?” It implies that a flower perhaps suffered a period without enough water or light, and began to wither and wilt. For students of any age in any part of the world, they may know how that flower feels - having spent more than two years struggling for real education in virtual classrooms, or those filled with masked students and teachers - who had limited opportunities to interact. This article will explore how KMLA - and its emblematic flower - the mugunghwa - meaning “eternal blossom that never fades” - has finally begun to “re-blossom” as the pandemic era fades.

“Anti-ti-ti-ti fragile fragile” - A lively song echoes through the halls of the Culture Center, signaling the revival of karaoke in classroom 127. On March 10th, the karaoke experience “blossomed” once more, reclaiming its place as one of the most beloved activities among stressed-out students. To say the least, removing the machine throughout the entire pandemic was logical and necessary - as singing and sharing microphones are not conducive to “social distancing.” But with the worst of that situation now in our rearview mirror, everything from Black Pink to Charlie Puth with varying levels of talent can be heard resounding (sometimes screeching) once again.

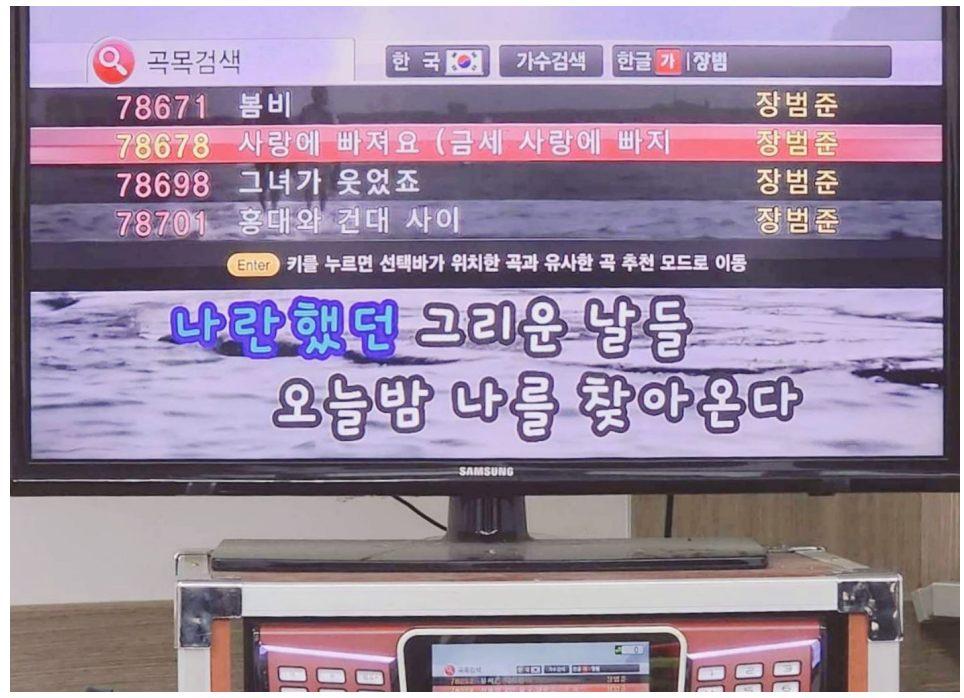
But if you like to sing, you have to be fast. Every Sunday at 23:55, students eagerly log on to KMLAonline to secure their reservations. With the system resetting every week, the race to book a slot has intensified as it officially opens at midnight for dinnertime and weekend reservations. On March 17th, the karaoke machine received an upgrade with two new microphones and an updated song selection, including the newest hits from acts like LE SSERAFIM or New Jeans, making it an even hotter attraction.

Craving a hot dog or a donut after a study session on Sunday afternoon? Not so easy from the start of 2020. But since the start of the 2022 academic year, students were granted the freedom to visit service stations over the weekends. Although the changes seemed minor, they represented a significant step toward normalcy. Even more than exploring highway rest stops, students crave visits to their hometowns, especially during the new year. The reduction of the hyuto intervals from three weeks to two has further contributed to student body happiness. In an interview, 26th waver Choi Hyeon-jun passionately advocated for the fixed two-week hyuto cycle, emphasizing that missing a single week meant being unable to visit home for months.

Perhaps the most liberating and blossoming change occurred on February 17th, 2023, as students were finally and officially able to bid farewell to their masks. While it was not a complete escape, they could now wear masks at their own discretion.

For nearly twenty months, masks had covered more than half of their faces and hid smiles, and muffled their words.
Even if important events like mid-term tests, festivals, or Vision Trip require masks for short durations, the ability to take them off is a massive relief to most.

Life in the KMLA isolated rural bubble has always depended on one thing that allows students opportunities to develop their academic resumes, and that is the chance to travel abroad for competitions. While some considered themselves fortunate to engage in such events while staying in Korea, most students in KMLA had different perspectives. Recently, a few 26th wavers visited the U.S. to participate in the Conrad Challenge. Kim Jung-woo, who participated in the Conrad Challenge, had this to say:



▲ Karaoke Screen of our school

MH | Did you enjoy the competition in the U.S.?

Yes. Since we had two years of prevention of going to foreign countries, I was stuck in Korea. And having the experience in the States was totally different.

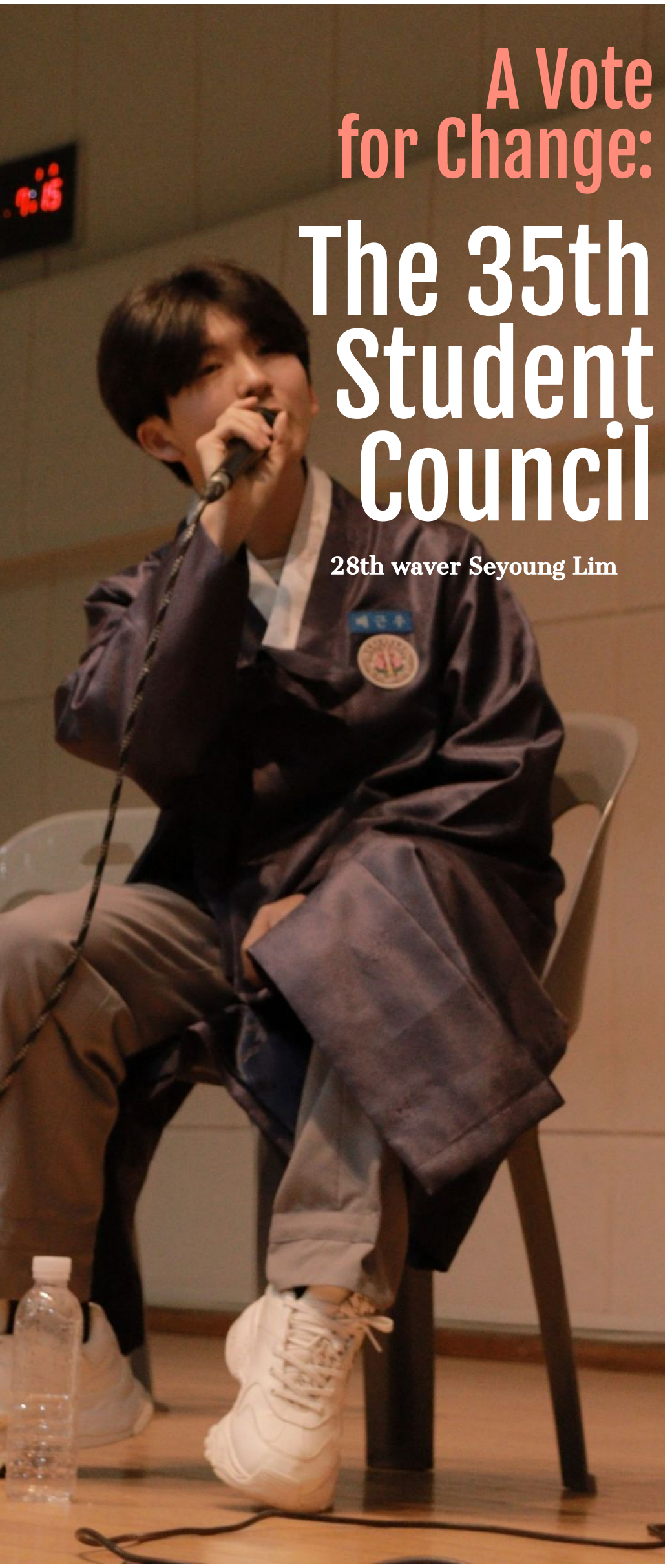
MH | What was it like to actually go to the U.S. and travel abroad for the competition?

We felt that the atmosphere at the stage was really different from the experience during the COVID years. It was about the competition, but also the mixture of cultures and traditions in the cities.

MH | Do you prefer the competitions that are held online or offline?

I absolutely prefer the offline contest. In the online contest, I am only able to express myself virtually through Zoom. This may block me from showing my movements and conveying my ideas. Also, it may be misunderstood by others. Plus, through the offline contest, we are able to create our ideas into tangible results.

All of the above examples point towards the “re-blossoming” of KMLA as it gets closer and closer to what it was before COVID-19 wreaked havoc on the world. The question is - will this spirit take it even further into a better version - with students bursting with pent-up energy, enthusiasm, and desire to compensate for what was lost and sacrificed? 28th wavers are determined to meet this expectation as the first unhindered wave since the 24th wave graduated. For the 26th and 27th, they must make the most of what remains on their time at KMLA. Good luck to us all as we “re-blossom” and share light and rain with our precious mugunghwa.



A Vote for Change: The 35th Student Council

28th waver Seyoung Lim

These last two weeks have been busy for the students in KMLA. The school underwent a new student council election, starting on March 14th and ending on March 26th. The results first came out on March 25th via Facebook notice. It will be the 35th school council, performing the duties until the end of the first term.

There were 29 candidates when the election began. However, some resigned or were disqualified before the actual vote. When the students were making their final decisions, there were 25 candidates left on the ballot. Students picked three people for Head and Deputy Chair of each Council: Legislative, Executive, and Judicial. They also chose two candidates, each a member of the three commissions.

However, the process students went through during the election wasn't just voting. Several schedules were carried out for the last two weeks. On March 14th, the written assignments of all the candidates were uploaded on KMLA Online, which required them to answer both common and specific questions regarding the councils applied for.

Following this, there were two sets of in-person question-and-answer sessions on the 15th and 21st, held in front of all students in the auditorium. The questions were based on their answers from their written assignments and asked them about the potential effectiveness of their promises and proposed solutions to possible problems, etc. The candidates also had opportunities to debate with one another.

The final event was a PRESS question-and-answer session on March 22nd. The PRESS is a team composed of two official newspaper clubs in KMLA. They wrote analysis articles for every event related to the election and stenographic records for the two question-and-answer sessions above. The purpose is to help students understand what the candidates are promising more clearly. Some constructive criticism is needed to aid students to choose better candidates, but the PRESS does not exist to judge them hastily. Keeping an unbiased and objective balance is crucial for the official media of KMLA.

The order was the same except for the fact that the members of the PRESS asked the questions. The session went on for an hour and a half. A reporter of the PRESS and a candidate had a one-on-one period for questioning and answering. The questions contained doubtful points about the promises and claims that students might have wondered about.

Early Voting began on the night of Thursday, March 23rd, and all voting closed when the school day ended on Friday the 24th. The voting rate was exceedingly high compared to the last few elections, reaching 99.34%. The 26th wavers managed to accomplish 100%.

The 34th Student Council worked as an Electoral Commission and took charge of all schedules. However, there was criticism about their vote counting. It was said that the Electoral Commission began ballot counting when the voting was still in progress, next to the students who were handing their votes in. The Electoral Commission admitted their method could cause controversy, but emphasised that the counts were done fairly and confidentially. They also promised that they would pursue noncontroversial voting and counting.

The members of the Legislative and Executive Councils were concluded on March 25th. But there was a demand for a recount for the Judicial Council. The Electoral Commission underwent a recount on the 26th, but there weren't any changes in the results.

KMLA's student council is unique and highly different compared to most high schools in Korea. They have more work, authority, and, therefore, responsibility. Since these councils are formed by our own hands, we should also remember that we are responsible for their acts. With high hopes for the 35th Student Council, KMLA can once again look forward to improvements.

Looking Back to April Fools' Day:

The Fragile Line Between Innocent Pranks and Reckless Misbehavior

28th waver Jiwoo Ye

"Children can teach you how to appreciate the present moment."

Like this quote, sometimes, childishness isn't only about being immature and rude. Sometimes, acting like a child can mean letting go of all your worries, fears, and complicated thoughts and enjoying the present moment. That's why April Fools' Day is still loved around the globe. If you search 'April fools', tons of foolish, dumb jokes and pranks pop up. From classic pranks like placing whoopee cushions under chairs to one-of-a-kind unique pranks like a fake text, one day seems too short to pull off every foolish thing you've dreamed of.

This year, April Fools' Day in KMLA was full of pure joy and enthusiasm for students, regardless of age, grade, or gender. There were unique, mind-blasting pranks that created beautiful, unforgettable memories.

A disappointing thing was that April 1st fell on a Saturday when many students had returned home. There weren't many ways for students to enjoy pranks altogether, so what they did was use the perfect platform, Facebook. The first Facebook prank came from the Department of Food Service. While introducing themselves as the Department of Student Guidance, they added a funny warning that couples are not allowed to sit together in the cafeteria anymore. This was the starting point for a relay of pranks from different departments and clubs, where everyone uploaded ridiculous, foolish posts that highlighted their unique role in the school. The Department of Physical Education, for example, posted that their department will be dissolved. Then came the Department of Library Management with a shocking announcement that the Mankyeong Library was no longer in service. An interesting thing about this trend was how each department seemed solemn and strict about their jobs, while also revealing their hidden childishness and mischievousness.

For example, the Department of Audit and Inspection, with a very very rigorous reputation, posted that a member of the Department of Student Guidance was impeached for ridiculous reasons such as "almost being late for school". The very solemn Department of Justice shocked students by announcing that students had to rap to a given beat when reading the final defending speeches. This was an unforgettable experience since it is hard to see students adding humor to their announcements as representatives of departments. 'Meok9 sa9 pal9', which used to be rigid and dry when it came to official announcements, was full of humor, passion, and silliness that day.

There were also students who thought up pranks to pretend to be someone else on Facebook. Some changed their profile pictures to look like others. There was nothing worrisome about this mimicking, and students weren't rude enough to cross any lines or harm another's reputation. However, there still existed the potential for things to become problematic. "Impersonation" has a potential problem of defamation. If someone does not fully understand April Fools' Day, they can easily be deceived by impersonated posts. This is largely because the online space is a place where people only communicate through superficial information. Only the profile picture of a person and the name defines and differentiates who is who. This makes it much easier to completely deceive other people, and sometimes, leads to defamation. Therefore, this kind of pranking would need extra caution or further warning.

Perhaps the most traditional April Fools' prank of KMLA with a long history is swapping school uniforms between girls and boys. This may be the only day of the year when girls are allowed to wear pants and boys are allowed skirts. Due to April 1st falling on Saturday, students received permission to carry out the tradition on the following Monday. On Sunday, Meok9 sa9 pal9 started to bustle with the excited posts of wavers looking for people to swap uniforms with. After Honjeong, the cafeteria was full of students switching uniforms and leaving goofy photos amid laughter. On Monday morning, this all continued on the way to classes. Not only did this give students an opportunity to be childish, but it also offered a temporary solution to the long gender conflict surrounding school uniforms. As a byproduct beyond entertainment, many boys learned how girls' school uniforms truly present inconveniences in terms of comfort and mobility as they moved around campus.

Keeping Up With KMLA:
Thank You Card Committee

28th waver Minseo Kang

The hardest day of the week is unquestionably Monday. Not only is it the start of a new week, but it also means that the weekend, when being lazy is acceptable, is over.

Even KMLA students are not immune to the dismal symptoms of "Monday Blues." Once the week begins, students must not only perform early morning exercises but also attend the weekly "Morning Assembly." Owing to this demanding schedule, students—particularly first-years who are not yet fully accustomed to the "KMLA lifestyle"—have difficulty staying awake.

The "Thank You Card Committee," a newly established group, is attempting to break this loop. A new event has been organized by a group of Ms. Song Kyungsil's "Positive Psychology" class students to make the week more enjoyable. Every second Monday morning, two students have the chance to express their thanks to their teachers, friends, or any faculty members of KMLA. Through this small event, they hoped to provide the KMLA family a chance to express gratitude to those they were unable to thank in person, sharing their feelings and thinking back on days they were grateful for by writing and reciting heartwarming letters. And during that process, they hoped for the people to have a break from the busy Minsa life and look back at the human relationship around them positively. Hence, the reader, receiver, and other students who are listening to this wonderful exchange of words could all experience the bright, good emotion.

On April 3rd, three participants kicked off this unique new program by reading their thank-you cards. 26th waver, Jimin Ha, first read her letter to Eunchae Song, in whose company she felt a deep sense of gratitude for constantly sharing laughter, from which recalled a moment when she needed support. In her letter, she talked about the time when her friend brought a pack of headbands after hearing her saying: "I'm running out of hair straps". Jimin Ha showed her great appreciation to her fellow friend, saying that she was touched that her friend remembered even a simple phrase she spoke. Although at first it seemed difficult to publically read such a sincere and loving letter, all listeners, including the recipient and any third parties, felt the positive energy spreading among them.

The 27th waver Park Jiyoung was the second reader. Her letter was dedicated to her first roommates. She expressed her gratitude for them being her first roommates and spoke about how they assisted her in adjusting to KMLA. The audience that was reading the letter felt warmth emanating from their hearts since it was so emotionally charged. Specifically, at the end of the letter when she gave a shout-out to her past roommates for being awesome and supportive friends, the audience at the auditorium felt themselves smiling at such a wholesome event. The letter seemed particularly intimate and emotional to them since, as first-year students, their housemates were the very first friends they had made at the school.

Mr. Oh Byungmoon was the final person to read. He thanked Mr. Kim Jung Soo for helping him to fit in when he initially began to teach at KMLA. He talked about the first time when Mr. Kim approached him and talked about World War 2. Mr. Oh said that although his major was not war history, he felt welcomed when he was a new teacher at KMLA. In the letter, he showed great appreciation to his colleague for inviting him to gatherings and talking to him about his interests. Thus he felt really glad that he came to teach at this school. The listeners grinned in response to Mr. Oh's candid and lighthearted message. Particularly, they could relate to the letter even more because everyone has at least had the experience of adjusting to a new environment or school.

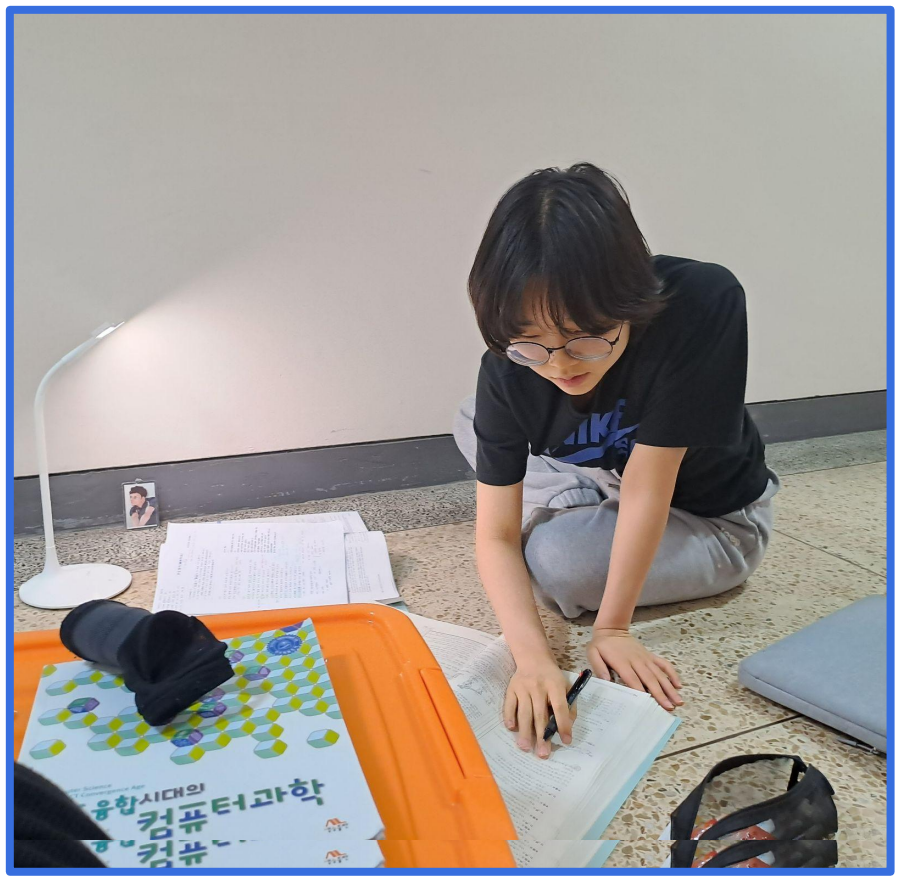
> **"Positive Psychology tells you that, to feel a positive feeling, it doesn't always require one to do or experience something. Especially when it comes to thanking something or someone. One can feel positive emotions when watching the other's interaction of sharing their gratitude, or when drawing a picture of the interaction. This can lead to actual additional actions showing gratitude, which makes it into a cycle."**

Ms. Song, the teacher of positive psychology as well as who organized this event, explained. "Thus that is why all of us must share gratitude. When you thank someone, the person who received the gratitude does more good intended actions, and people who saw that would have some sort of motivation to do positive acts. I think there is a greater social benefit than the expense of saying the simple phrase 'thank you'".

The Monday morning function at the new school was a huge success. “The Thank You Card Reading event was one of the first morning patriotism Meetings that I didn’t fall asleep in! It was great fun hearing all sorts of positive stories, and I want to participate in the event.” Said Yoon Hong Jung. “You know, I think this is a great event. Instead of sharing your thanks to others personally, you’ll be sharing them with the entire school. This way, the positive sentiment will not only be shared among two people but with everyone.” Commented Ji You Yoon on the event. Likewise, students who attended the morning assembly showed great appreciation for the event. Everyone felt energized and less worn out. Moreover, the public audience was able to take in wonderful energy and begin their day bright and cheerful. The recipients felt valued, the readers gained tremendous satisfaction in being able to thank them properly, and the general audience felt pleased.

In a school community that has rarely celebrated group events or gatherings during the last three years of the pandemic, this program is a refreshing breath of air and positivity that can only be described as an essential ingredient to KMLA’s “reboot.” The group is now using Google Forms to recruit volunteers for the letter reading. At the Patriotism Morning Meeting, everyone in KMLA is more than welcome to write and read aloud their letters.
“ Through this event, I hope for the KMLA family to remember that there is always time to thank one another. Just simply remembering this fact can encourage the act of gratitude and the view to positively perceive this community.” Ms.Song commented when asked about the prospect of the “Thank You Card Committee”.

Although this program has just recently started, students have already shown a strong commitment to it. For the Teacher’s Day event, three students personally wrote and volunteered to read their letters dedicated to the teachers. This warm exchange of frank yet warm thank yous brought a big grin to many faces. Especially since that event was designed for thanking their teachers, while listening to the letters, the speaker and all the third party students were able to recall the times when they felt a great appreciation to their school teachers, making the day even more special. Perhaps, the application of the thank-you notes reading will lift the depressing Morning Blues, encouraging students to begin a new day of life as KMLAins.



Minjok Herald

3m

Update From 28th Wavers:

#just_finished_midterm
#OMG_we_screwed_up

28th waver Suhyoon Jahng

The biggest challenge for high school students is difficult exams, especially for KMLA freshmen. Too many chapters covered and the fight against the clock often result in what is referred to as the “time attack.”

28th wavers had their first mid-term exams from April 19th to the 25th, including seven subjects of English, Korean History, Math, Korean, Programming, Foreign Language, and K Module. Having 7 subjects for the mid-term session is quite unusual, so many students were under pressure and mental stress. Most students worried for weeks, anxious until the last moment. But those anxieties motivated students to try harder, and it was normal to see them at the study hall until 2am.

It seems that exams made many students panic, as they reported that there were too many essay questions in English and Korean tests that ate up their test time. Some complained about Korean history problems, which caused confusion resulting in wrong answers. Some teachers said that there were some students who couldn’t manage to fill in all the answers.

An anonymous freshman said the following after completing her Spanish exam. "I really messed this up! KMLA is a new level of completely different test structure which reminded me of Aespa's next level. I pulled all nighters for three days straight, and Monster drink runs through my veins. It feels as if my body and soul are separated forever like Romeo and Juliette." And when I asked her about what she wanted to do after the test, she replied, "I want to eat Bul-dak and sleep forever like the sleeping beauty."

During the test period, there was a meme that was widely spread among 28th wavers. It's "ship-ji anta," meaning “something is not easy.” Though this meme might not have a profound meaning, it shows how much freshmen are carrying burdens on their shoulders and finding tasks "not easy."

Though the students were in an environment where they cannot get help from private academies and parents, the 28th wavers have done a great job with their first high-school mid-term exam regardless of the result. Now, let's pack our stuff for the Vision Trip and forget about the exams!

403

Like Comment Send

Visiontrip West Website

Visiontrip West Youtube Channel

The New MPT System in KMLA

The Minjok Peer Tutoring system underwent big changes this year due to many complaints accusing it of becoming an easy way towards receiving volunteer hours without actual teaching. To solve this, a new MPT system has been introduced.

The main purpose of the original MPT program was to have students teach and learn from each other. The mentees would get support in subjects they needed help with, while the mentors would earn volunteer hours. Originally, the student mentors had to gather their mentees for in-person sessions. Some formed their group randomly by having students sign up for their class on Facebook, while others formed groups with close friends.

However, this original system had two big problems. Firstly, since the mentors had the privilege to choose mentees, many students could not take MPT classes even if they wanted to. Secondly, students took advantage of the MPT system to receive volunteer hours. Students paired and grouped together with close friends and used the time to self-study. When MPT managers patrolled the classes, they simply pretended to teach each other.

A new MPT system was introduced to solve these problems. The biggest change that took place is that rather than allowing mentors to form their groups independently, MPT managers acted as a third party to allocate the mentees to mentors. The new system had a new manual with several steps. Students willing to be mentors had to come up with a solid lesson plan in order to open their classes. Then, mentees seeking help would read the syllabus and sign up. The MPT managers would then match the mentees with mentors accordingly.

However, the new MPT system is controversial. Some students miss the original system, maintaining that classes are better if the mentors pick the mentees. They state that mentees could ask questions to mentors more easily if they were close. On the other hand, students who support the new system claim that actual teaching happens and that everybody willing to take a peer tutoring class gets a chance.

27th waver Hee Won Lee, now a 2nd year MPT manager, affirmed that the new MPT system is better for several reasons. She stated, “The former system allowed too many students to play or self-study rather than teach. Also, if there is a class with only seniors, it is more difficult for the junior and freshman MPT managers to give warnings. Above all, the new MPT system is fair to all students because it groups students randomly.”

With new changes introduced, students and teachers are hoping that the MPT system will rebloom.

Vision Trip: Everything Except for the Trip

28th waver Sangmin Lee

On May 3rd, the 28th wavers embarked on the 10-day Vision Trip to the US. Students were separated into two groups, each heading East and West. While the trip itself was meaningful and entertaining, other external aspects made it much more enjoyable.

The orientation allowed the trip to flow smoothly without any unexpected events delaying the schedule. Students were provided with specific information regarding the flight, luggage, tip culture, and the overall schedule. This meant better preparation and thus less time spent getting through the airport. The most memorable part of the OT was the presentations. Students formed groups to choose topics about the trip and introduced their research. This helped students appreciate the locations during the trip ahead of the actual visits.

A guidebook made for the Vision Trip turned out to play a crucial role in the journey as well. The book included information regarding just about everything and was useful for packing luggage, following schedules, and etiquette. Two print copies were given to each student, including one for parents.

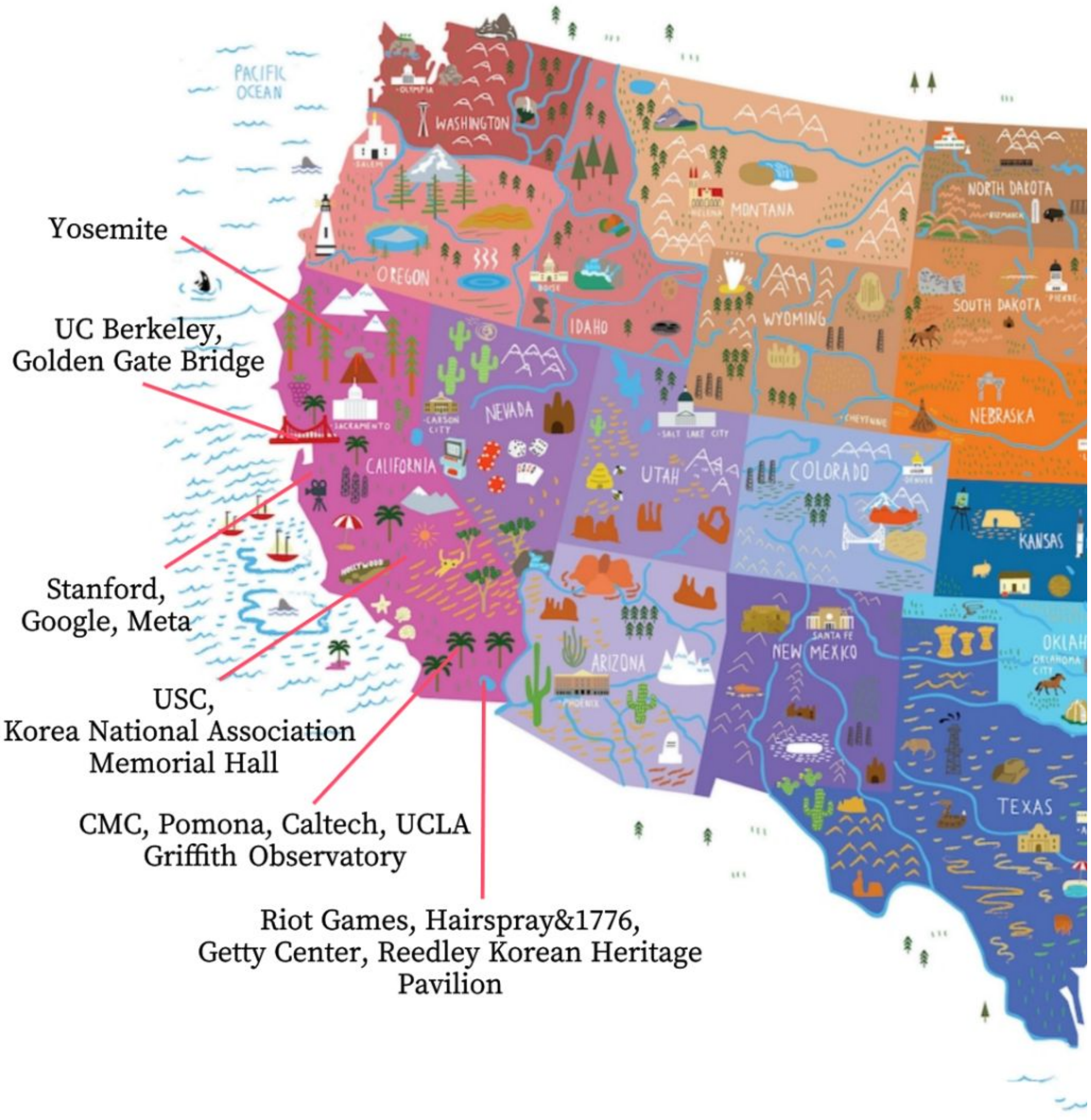
Facebook groups and websites are something KMLAians cannot live without, and it wasn’t an exception during the Vision Trip. The Vision Trip Facebook group was used for everything from voting to important notices to uploading pictures. Being a private group, it also took on the role of “mukgu-sagu-palgu” as well. The website was another source of information, as well as being full of photos and videos. The schedule was more specifically provided with maps and videos, and there were introductions to the alumni at each university.

What about a YouTube channel with dozens of shorts and videos? That’s right, students were actively encouraged to film shorts during the trip and submit them. There were dance challenges, food reviews, and so much more content about small but cherishable moments. Other precious moments were captured on camera and uploaded as videos. These were viewable for parents, allowing them to follow along the journey.

All of these external factors helped students prepare, enjoy, and look back on the Vision Trip, and none of this would have been possible if not for the efforts of the teachers and leaders of each group. From making an entire website to researching the exact process of the airport system, an enormous amount of effort must have been necessary for all of it to happen. Designers also worked on guidebooks and custom hoodies. It is only right that a special thanks is given to everyone involved.

On Teacher's Day, one last surprise arrived. Alumni that go as far back as the 7th wave made an appearance in a video message where they expressed their appreciation toward the teachers in KMLA. While it is easy to focus on the events that happened during the Vision Trip, we must also look back and acknowledge the immense roles of the organizers as well.

The West


PACIFIC OCEAN
WASHINGTON
OREGON
CALIFORNIA
NEVADA
IDAHO
MONTANA
WYOMING
UTAH
COLORADO
ARIZONA
NEW MEXICO
NORTH DAKOTA
SOUTH DAKOTA
NEBRASKA
KANSAS
OKLAHOMA
TEXAS
Yosemite
UC Berkeley,
Golden Gate Bridge
Stanford,
Google, Meta
USC,
Korea National Association
Memorial Hall
CMC, Pomona, Caltech, UCLA
Griffith Observatory
Riot Games, Hairspray&1776,
Getty Center, Reedley Korean Heritage
Pavilion

The East

Columbia University, Statue of Liberty,
Times Square, Broadway
Yale, Olin&Motional,
MIT, Harvard University
Central Park, MoMA,
One World Trade Center,
Wall Street
UPenn, Liberty Bell,
Smithsonian Museum
MINNESOTA
WISCONSIN
IOWA
MICHIGAN
ILLINOIS
INDIANA
OHIO
PENNSYLVANIA
NEW YORK
MAINE
VERMONT
NEW HAMPSHIRE
MASSACHUSETTS
RHODE ISLAND
CONNECTICUT
WEST VIRGINIA
VIRGINIA
KENTUCKY
TENNESSEE
NORTH CAROLINA
SOUTH CAROLINA
GEORGIA
FLORIDA
ALABAMA
MISSISSIPPI
LOUISIANA
ARKANSAS
MISSOURI
TOPEKA
JEFFERSON CITY
GULF OF MEXICO

A Whole New World - The West

28th waver Suhyoon Jahng

This year is special for KMLA and its members. Among major school events that have resumed after the pandemic, the revival of the Vision Trip garnered the most anticipation, and has been the talk of the town, especially for 28th wavers who recently finished their trip, and for 27th wavers who eagerly await their own chance during the upcoming Summer Session.

Vision Trip first started with the very first students to enter KMLA way back in 1997, with the express purpose of providing insight and widening vision. Except for the early waves, who went to Europe, students traditionally went to both the western and eastern sides of the US. This is the first year of traveling separate courses, and this article will cover the west. From the north to the south of sunny California, students visited tourist attractions, universities, and companies such as Google and Facebook. They also took in lectures from KMLA alumni and had Q&A sessions.

On Wednesday, May 3rd, the journey from Korea began as students woke up at 6 a.m., ate breakfast on the 1st floor of the dormitory with their eyes half closed, and got on the bus. It took several hours to get to Incheon Airport, but the travel time didn't seem to matter to us, as we were filled with joy and anticipation. Finally, we arrived at the airport and teachers busily gathered students for check-in. It was quite chaotic, but all teachers and all 71 students managed to board safely.

FOOD

Students faced the new tastes of America at every meal, every day. Introduced to “real” fast food and American style steak, one of the more memorable meals saw student dine at a local American buffet. The restaurant was smaller than anticipated, but we were delighted to have a delicious meal after a tough hike in the Yosemite. The moment we opened the door, the mouthwatering smells of everything hit us as shouts of “I’m starving!” were heard. Waiting in line, holding plates, constantly sticking their heads out like hungry baby birds, students piled up food on their plates and gulped down protein. The American-style steak was the all-time favorite item since we were able to order depending on our taste as the chef cooked the meat on the spot. After having a satisfying dinner, delicious

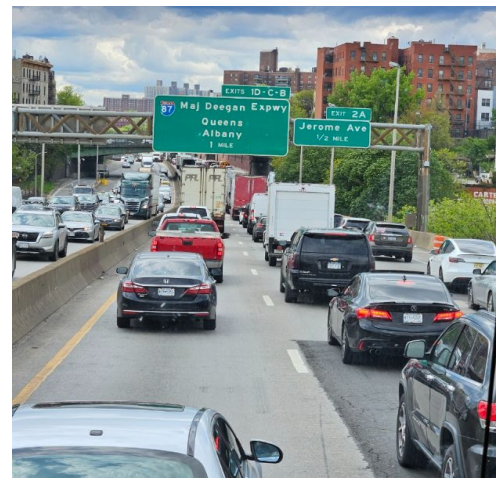
KMLA Meets the World - The East

28th waver Minseo Kang

It seems 2023 is the milestone for a restart in KMLA, especially for the fact that the Vision Trip has finally resurrected after being on hold from COVID-19. For many, this 10-day trip to America was the first time being abroad, and adding to the specialness was the chance to travel with friends and teachers as a temporary escape from the demanding KMLA routine.

The Vision Trip not only provides a chance to visit a dream university or company, but also gives us a true break. Especially since the pandemic, not many people had chances to travel abroad, and the idea of boarding an airplane, staying in a different country within completely different environments was a thrilling opportunity.

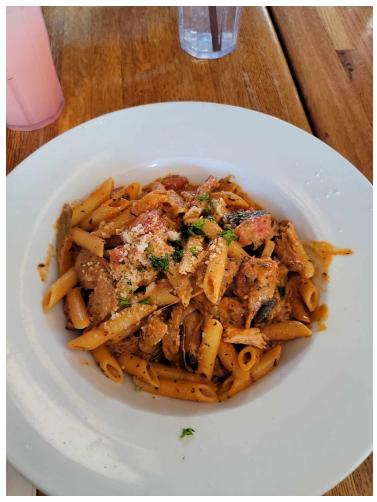
Hence, on Wednesday, May 3rd, with hearts filled with anticipation, we hopped on a flight to the “Whole New World”.

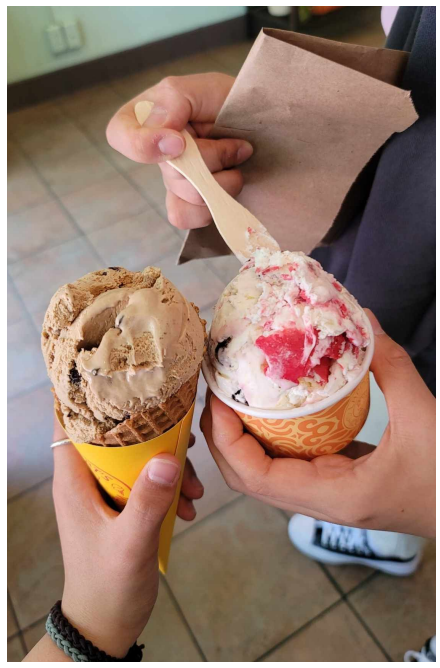


FOOD

Everyday was another great introduction to the “taste of America” as we ate everywhere ranging from buffets to fast food stands , welcomed by the sight of deep-fried everything. From prawns to pickles, all had been dipped in hot boiling oil at least once, coated in breadcrumbs. Even students who hardly look at anything green at school were shocked by how a buffet lacked vegetables. The world famous “Philly Cheese Steak Sandwich” was another great surprise packed with meat.

ice cream sundaes awaited us. Then we returned to the hotel with our minds over the moon.





Despite falling in love with the true "taste of America," when asked what their favorite meal of the trip was, the near unanimous answer was "the Yukgaejang we had on the first day of the trip." Well, we are KOREANS, after all.

This is the taste of America!

"The lunch was really filling… It had grilled meat. and soft buns, with melted cheese… really delicious. And the sandwich was huge! longer than a half of my arm!"

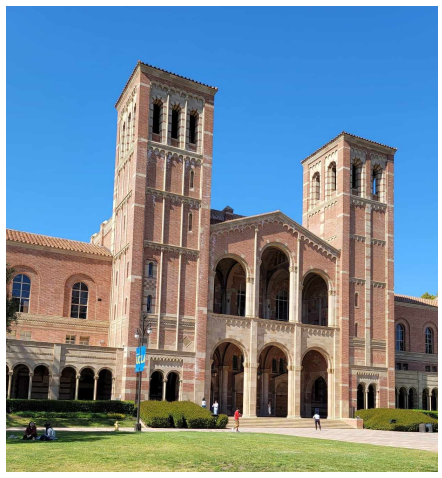
"Oh the buffet? My favorite food there was the dessert bar. I mean, all you can eat ice cream? With hot fudge? And rainbow sprinkles? That's the true pathway to heaven right there!"

Nonetheless it was a great experience. Thanks to those meals we not only had our eyes widened, but also our taste buds enlightened. However, when asked about a favorite meal of the entire trip, 9 out of 10 said: "Definitely budaejjigae at Korean Town." Guess no matter where we are, it is impossible to forget the "taste of Korea."

FUN

28th WAVERS VISION TRIP: EAST

We had really been looking forward to meeting the KMLA alumni. Teachers had been telling us during classes about who we would meet during the Vision Trip, which filled us with high hopes. We met alumni who were studying at USC, CMC, Pomona, UCLA, UC Berkeley, and Stanford. It seemed that they were pursuing their philosophy in life, and all students naturally looked up to them. They were able to give substantial but warm advice to us, as we of course worry about grades, colleges, and goals in life just like they did when they were in our shoes.



At UC Berkeley, a 17th waver said, "In highschool, I wanted to major in economics. But after entering college, I got interested in materials science. So I decided to re-enter college and took the SAT again. After graduating college, I had to decide on my graduate school. I felt like computer science was

One of the most memorable events was meeting alumni. Seeing Sunbaes pioneering into unknown fields or pursuing their greatest passions was inspiring. Especially since these alumni lived dynamic lives before us, they were able to give frank, yet thoughtful advice.

"One thing I've learned as an international student is that life is unpredictable. I, for one, never thought I'd go to law school… but here I am. So, my advice is that you should be aware of the unexpected. And if you feel lost right now, whether you don't know what to do or you think your future is doomed after finishing your midterms, this is only a part of a process. You'll get through." Those were the advice from the 10th waver graduate Hwang Chanhee, at a lecture hall in Columbia.

Another great experience for the 28th wavers was a chance to listen to a lecture of Yale professors. Among them, a monk-professor who studies religion spoke about the attitude of life, what mindset we need to have to get through the difficult days.

FUN

essential in modern society, so I studied programming on my own and entered graduate school." It was quite clear that our alumni had also gone through trials and errors, conflicts and failures. "We were the same as you guys when we were at KMLA, but look at who we've become! You will overcome anything." Their heart-warming words blew hope and courage into our hearts.

MISTAKES

Students learned about American "tip culture" on the bus to the airport. The teachers emphasized that giving a tip when leaving a restaurant or hotel is minimum courtesy, and we took it quite seriously. On the second day of the trip, we had free time to have dinner at South Lake. One student talked about her incident at Chipotle. She bought a 9-dollar burrito and gave a 20 dollar bill to the cashier. She did not know how to give the tip, so all she said was: "You can keep the change." After she sat in her seat with her food, she realized that she had given 11 dollars to the cashier, regretting it for the rest of the trip: "The 11 dollars I used at Chipotle! If it wasn't for that, I could've bought another cap at Stanford…"

"Life, metaphorically, is a triangular wheel. Like this, life, without your efforts, is already painful, so why make it worse? Accept the pain and let go. That is the key to tranquility." Students, despite some unfamiliarity with such depth of religion, were very focused on the lecture, holding on to his every word. With plenty to think about, we reflected on the times when we thought highschool life was crushing us, and were perhaps left with a great question: "What if I accepted my situation, and focused on what I should do rather than sulking… Wouldn't that be more helpful?"

MISTAKES

Thankfully, there weren't many significant mishaps for students on the east coast. Students were not tardy or lost, no one got robbed or got sick . However, there were some trivial incidents due to carelessness.

"I went to Five Guys for lunch," one student said. "I ordered a cheeseburger and fries, but when I got my order, my burger only had two pieces of patty with zero sauce and lettuce! I mean… I thought this was actually the 'American style' so I ate everything without throwing food away, but I was shocked! Who knew that you needed to ask for vegetables in your burgers? I thought tomatoes and lettuce were the basics!"

Like her, students were often confused by the ordering culture, with the added complication of tipping culture.

"Wait… are we supposed to tip at fast food restaurants?"

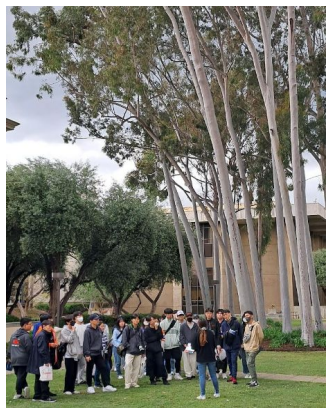
"I thought the meal cost $30, but they automatically had us pay extra bucks for tips!"

" How much were we supposed to pay for tips..?"

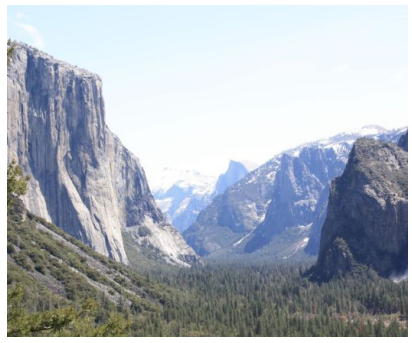
Despite the unfamiliar custom, KMLAins were able to learn through trial and error, and by the end of the trip they became masters at paying at restaurants.

Another "mistake" was lack of time. Looking forward to exploring New York's famous sites, ranging from Central Park to Times Square, unfortunate turns of events resulted in a mere 30 minutes in Central Park for lunch, and 10 minutes in Times Square. Obviously, students were not happy about this tight schedule.

"The time we wasted for simple things compared to the 10 minutes in Times Square! Unfathomable!"
"I feel like I've completely lost the purpose of my trip!"

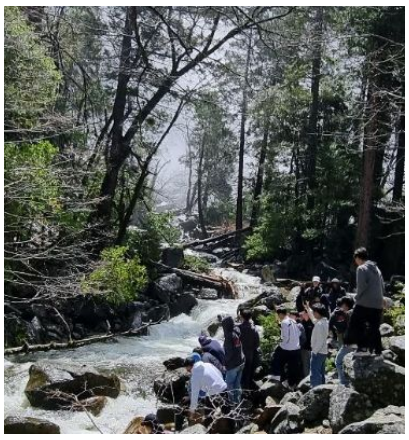


WHERE



We went to countless places to widen our vision. From Los Angeles to Hollywood, Yosemite and San Francisco, we tried to widen perspectives by experiencing new things and meeting new people.

The biggest highlight of our trip was Yosemite, which is a National Park famous for the huge waterfall. We walked through gorgeous woods, overwhelmed by breathtaking scenery as we climbed up rocks and



dipped our hands in the shallow water. Some incidents happened, too. Yosemite is Mother Nature at her wildest after all. As students were having their lunch boxes at an open space in Yosemite, a crow flew by and pooped on a student's food and her brand-new clothes. She panicked and then regarded her ruined lunch in disgust, but she later recalled the incident with amusement. Something to tell her grandchildren?

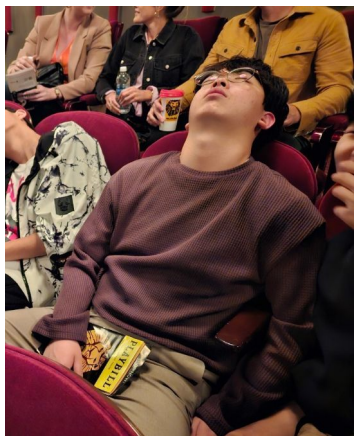
Moving from one place to another quickly, students often juggled between shopping at gift stores or touring museums. Despite their moans, students were very cooperative. Following the teacher's instructions, we were able to enjoy our Vision Trip in one-piece with no significant injuries.

"To be completely honest with you, 28th wavers were the best wave I've ever led on a Vision Trip!" Mr. Kim announced on the last day. In fact, he was so happy and satisfied throughout the eight day excursion that he decided to forgive all penalty points he gave out during the Vision Trip.

WHERE

From Washington DC to New York, from New Port to Yale, we tried to see and experience as much as we could. One of the greatest highlights was New York, the "Empire State," the "City that Never Sleeps." First, we arrived at a pier to take a boat tour to see the Statue of Liberty. Despite the strong wind and blinding sunlight, that did not stop us from enthusiastically taking pictures and holding tightly on the rail to get a better view of Lady Liberty.

In the midst of the energetic city, we visited Times Square where the lights seemed to never go off, where giant screens flashed commercials for everything ranging from Netflix shows to new technology, blinding tourists with sparks and luminosity. In the midst of the Rockefeller Center, where a tall building and a golden statue are signature symbols, the streets were filled with colors and noise. "Do not fall behind! You could get lost!" The tour guide repeatedly reminded us. Unfortunately, the busy schedule rushed us from one site to the next without proper time to fully admire the city in a single day. "It is truly tragic that we are given such a limited time in a city that has unlimited possibilities…" One student lamented while walking down 42nd Street.



busy schedule rushed us from one site to the next without proper time to fully admire the city in a single day. "It is truly tragic that we are given such a limited time in a city that has unlimited possibilities…" One student lamented while walking down 42nd Street. Nonetheless, we tried our best to make the

TMI

Fun but panicked moments occurred due to our English-fright. Some students said they were having dinner at Sausalito Village. A manager asked if they wanted a picture. Students thought it was free but later the receipt added 15 dollars. A Similar incident happened in Hollywood. From Spiderman to Wednesday Addams, cosplays stood in a queue and a big fan of Wednesday took a picture. “Yo, no tip?!” the lady said. The student didn’t know what to do and had to give 20 dollars.

Overall, students learned they should always be aware of money. In Korea would they have committed the same mistake? It seems “English-fright” was at the root of most incidents after all.

Through our "vision" trip, we were able to firm up our vision and find clearer paths towards our dreams. None of this would have been possible without the generous Q&A sessions and conversations with KMLA graduates who are now studying and working in various fields. Many 28th wavers have common worries about bad grades and nailing down fields of interest, but alumni told us that they had once had the exact same concerns as ours, also experiencing bad grades and rejections from school clubs. But there was one thing in particular that they commonly emphasized: there’s no need for us to be afraid of challenging ourselves, and we should make constant effort to find what we truly love. The vision trip came to an end. Students have now resumed their daily lives and will be pressured for grades, health, and human relationships as the semester draws closer to the end. Nevertheless, there is no doubt that we are now emboldened to navigate through whatever may come our way. Keep it up, 28th wavers!

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28th WAVERS VISION TRIP: WEST

most of it, appreciating every design and capturing every moment through cameras. Our day ended with an amazing Broadway musical, but exhaustion made this an opportunity for many to take a sweet slumber with musicals as a lullaby.

TMI

The 28th wavers’ East Coast Vision Trip was so dynamic that each student has their own unique story to tell. For the record, one student Kim Hyunsoo bought a toy flute from a gift store in Pennsylvania and played the school’s Monday Morning Assembly song throughout the entire trip. He was even captured playing in the middle of a crowd at the dazzling Time Square.

“Well… I think his attempt to play flute at Times Square had other intentions… but it was a great attempt to introduce Korean culture to the international audience. Did they listen? No. But it was an interesting attempt…”

“Uhh…. It was quite funny to hear the familiar school tune at such a busy, bustling place. I guess in a way this is the extension to the past wavers’ Vision Trip when they actually brought Goggwari and played Samulnori at Times Square.”

Truly, this trip was a page filled with heart-warming events. On the last day, we gathered at the hotel lobby to write thank you letters to the guides, teachers, and drivers who all tried their very best to make the 28th Vision Trip memorable. We planned a secret event in which we surprised the lead teachers by giving them handwritten letters when departing JFK International Airport. “This Vision Trip has a lot of significance in our lives. Here in this exotic unfamiliar place, we were able to build our dreams, and make many many unforgettable memories with our friends. And the main reason why this trip was awesome was because there were great teachers who meticulously planned and looked after us. Therefore, we’ve decided to dedicate this letter to you teachers!” Lee Sungjae said on behalf of the 28th East Coast teams.

As representing students handed the letters to teachers, the students applauded, and cheers erupted when Mr. Kim announced that he would discharge all the penalty points he gave out during the trip.

Like these small anecdotes, the 28th Vision Trip holds myriad precious memories for the 28th wavers to continually retell. Beautiful memories, which we can hold dearly in our hearts and reminisce from time to time.

28th WAVERS VISION TRIP: EAST

Concentrate, Shoot, and Achieve

28th waver Seohyeon Choi

Zing—Bam! An arrow slices the air and hits the target. Every weekday at 6 am, archers gather for morning exercise. Recently, KMLA's Korean Archery Club competed in the Youth National Korean Archery Competition and finished in flying colors: Men's Team - Gold; Women's Team - Silver; Individual - Ryoo Si-ho - Gold, Kwon Na-young - Bronze, Park Kang-been - Gold, Sim Seong-hyeon - Silver, Bae Kang-min - Bronze.

MH: How do you feel about the success?

Sim Seong-hyeon: I'm a senior, but due to circumstances I got to participate. I practiced a short period, but I'm delighted to get decent results. And I was happy to spend a good time with club members.

Kwon Na-young: Watching teams compete I always thought I'd like to try. But Korean traditional bow is unpopular so I gave up hope. However, her I am! Great times with teammates was so meaningful.

MH: What aspects did you practice hardest?

Na Jin-young: I worked hard on matching breath and cultivating cooperative spirit. There are times when we get nervous and shoot poorly. However, while practicing this time, we encouraged each other and corrected our postures. We prepared as much as possible for unexpected situations.

MH: Any dissatisfactions?

Oh Ji-hoon: The competition was May 10th right after AP tests, meaning I missed two weeks of practice. So, from an international student's point of view, the tournament results were a little unsatisfying.

Ryoo Si-ho: I won first, but I only shot three arrows correctly out of fifteen which isn't that good. I was just lucky and got the award. Teacher Seong Heon-je reminded us that it was by pure luck that our team won. He added that normally we should've done better to get an award, and I agree.

MH: What is needed to develop further?

Na Jin-young: We need our alumnus' interest and focus, and interest in Korean archery. If we enjoy Korean archery ourselves and avoid complacency, we can improve naturally.

MH: What is considered most important in Korean archery?

Seo Woo-chan: Peace of mind. When I shoot, I have to believe in myself to hit the target. You can only aim when your mind is stable. Accuracy and strength can't exist if you're shaking without composure.

Ryoo Si-ho: Concentration. You must breathe slowly and hold your breath before shooting. Only then can you shoot well.

MH: How'll you prepare for the next event?

Bae Kang-min: It's been almost half a year since my last event, so I didn't have enough experience or practice, so there were some regrets. Next year in May I want to go out and earn results without these feelings.

Oh Ji-hoon: Next time, I will go to the morning exercise regardless of AP.

Hwang Na-kyung: After steadily practicing and accumulating skill, I will not get nervous and shoot well, resulting in sweeping all awards!

Kwon Na-young: Something that teacher Seong Heon-je always says is that while holding posture, you should find your style rather than cling to ideals. As a new member, I haven't found my style yet. So, I hope I can secure this and shoot comfortably by next year.

Ryoo Si-ho: As I hit only three out of fifteen, I simply hope for more and a better result.

Korean archery requires high concentration and mind control, and we applaud our Korean archery team with a huge round of congratulations. Despite hardship, the result is great and they worked hard for it.

The Friendly Match: KMLA vs KSA

28th waver Seoeun Yang

On Saturday, May 20th, KMLA and KSA (Korean Science Academy) had their 10th annual friendly match held at KAIST. This event held particular significance since it was the first one held since 2019 due to the pandemic.

The event kicked off with two speeches, one each by both our KMLA headmaster, Dr. Manwi Han, and the KSA headmaster, Dr. Jongbae Choi. These speeches warmly welcomed students, teachers, and family members, expressing their hopes for a successful game.

The first event was the OX quiz. It worked as an icebreaker and got students talking amongst themselves. Sounds of laughter were heard as collective groans went out as the host announced the answers to each question. Small gifts were awarded to the 10 students that survived until the end.

As the games began, cheers and words of encouragement echoed throughout. The first contest featured KMLA's volleyball team, MVP. The game began with both teams on either side of the net, never once taking their eyes off the ball. They showed incredible teamwork and MVP managed to turn the tables after a while and stayed in the lead. Both teams fought hard, but KMLA's MVP took the win with a score of 42:31. KMLA 1, KSA 0.

Following the heated volleyball match, everyone, including students, teachers, and family members, gathered outdoors to support the soccer teams. Even though the blazing sun and cloudless sky combined to create unbearably hot weather, KMLA's soccer team, CGV, put in their best effort. Although both teams tried their best, the game ended in a tie with a score of 0:0. The score remained the same. KMLA 1, KSA 0.

After a lunch break, we were able to enjoy performances from both schools. KMLA's Samuchim presented a spectacular traditional Korean percussion performance, while KSA's dance team, Byeolbora, showcased impressive group dances, leaving the audience in awe.

Last but not least, the basketball game was held. Crossover, KMLA's basketball club, started off strong by scoring points just minutes into the game. Students chanted player's names and shouted out words of encouragement. KMLA was declared the winner with 52:33 being the final score. The overall tournament score became 2:0, with KMLA in the lead.

Between basketball games, KMLA's 28th wave performed a group dance, led by the four cheer captains. We performed with songs like "Pretty U," "Happy," and "As If It's Your Last". KSA's Byeolbora gave a performance as well. The dance team performed a cheer routine and danced to Seventeen's "BSS". The audience erupted into deafening cheering and applause.

Finally, to end the event, the first place trophy was awarded to KMLA. This victory was possible thanks to the efforts of the sports teams MVP, CGV, and Crossover, along with the entire 28th wave and Samuchim. The beaming smiles on everyone's faces were tell-tale signs of how proud they were of this accomplishment. We finished the friendly match by singing the school song, and KMLAians sang their hearts out.

As Long as We Are Here, We Are Invincible: 2023 Gangwon State Championships

28th waver Suhyoon Jahng

One of the biggest events our school participates in is the Gangwon State Championships. Sports clubs ranging from MVP (volleyball) to Crossover (basketball)to Raffine (fencing) participate annually.

Seven of our teams competed in kendo, girl's volleyball, boy's and girl's basketball, baseball, fencing, and handball.

For kendo, our school lost to Wontong High School 0 to 7, but the participants practiced hard every morning while the 1st graders were doing morning exercise. In volleyball, KMLA and Gangwon Foreign Language High School had two matches, and we won both rounds. For fencing in the girl's division, the players won gold in Fleuret and Épée, and a silver in sabre. Students who participated in the boy's division also performed well. They won silver in Fleuret, and bronze in Épée and sabre. Unfortunately, the girl's basketball, baseball, and handball teams didn't get a chance to participate in their games since there wasn't a team to compete with.

In boy's basketball, Crossover won a landslide victory against (name the team and city they are from). It was our first gold in 13 years. Crossover had three matches in three consecutive days with a different high school every time, and every member of the team shone as a star player.

According to Crossover member, Seungjae Lee, the players practiced every Wednesday during club time and Monday during self-study time, practicing shooting and establishing game plans. 28th wavers used extra dinner time to improve, with 26th and 27th wave members joining to coach.

"Well, was it tough? Of course it was. We had our final round with an elite team! But we aced the game because we had assuring sunbaes who constantly told us to not panic and to keep our heads in the game."explained Seungjae Lee
Through the championship, players developed unity and learned the power of teamwork, which eventually led to their first remarkable victory in 13 years.

At the Monday morning assembly on June 12th, the players of all seven teams were awarded with medals. They earned a huge round of applause from teachers and students. The whole school was proud of all the players who had tried their best at the state championship. Let's keep up this vibe for next year!

Alma Mater Homecoming Day A to Z:
Until We Meet Again

28th waver Seyoung Lim

"Better than a thousand days of diligent study is one day with a great teacher."

Worldwide, teachers have been well-respected throughout history, as this proverb implies. KMLA is no different in this culture. In fact, KMLA values teachers so much that students are all sent to their previous middle schools to visit former teachers. This tradition is called Alma Mater Homecoming Day

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This year's Alma Mater Homecoming Day was on Tuesday, May 30th, after the long holiday from the 27th to the 29th. As the tradition demands, students had to visit their schools with their school uniforms on. Some students visited elementary schools due to their schedules or physical distances from their schools. According to many 28th wavers who had experienced the event for the first time, it was rather awkward to walk around schools wearing sky-blue hanbok. One student commented that it was hard to keep her face calm when everyone around her was staring at her in awe. Nonetheless, the school uniform received countless compliments, regardless of the person wearing it.

The primary purpose of visiting the Alma Mater is to meet and thank the teachers, as mentioned above. Numerous students recalled that it was nice to see their previous teachers again. They chatted shortly with their teachers, who gave them endless support and cheers. A 28th waver said that her teachers often asked her about school life in general. A 27th waver expressed how much she loved the school because of the teachers and the classes. However, for those whose teachers had transferred to another school, the experience wasn't as touching. To see teachers who had taught them, some students even visited schools other than their own.

However, if visiting former teachers were the only purpose, there would be no reason to wear our school uniforms. The additional purpose (and some might argue the main one) of Alma Mater Homecoming Day is to illustrate KMLA life for middle school students. The Office of Public Relations designed brochures and videos which were used to promote the school. Many students held briefing sessions during their visits. The number of students who had applied for the briefing sessions varied from school to school, with some reaching up to two hundred while others ten to twenty. The presentation consists of a simple introduction to KMLA, academic works, club activities, timetables, and our community spirit known as the "KMLA Family."

Regardless of the scale, KMLAians tried their best to answer the given questions during question-and-answer sessions. One 28th waver said students usually asked about how the interview went, what visions KMLA values, and career-related pieces of advice. She noted that the questions reminisced of last year's memories when she was striving for the entrance examination.

There were a few opinions about the promotion video as well. Some students had to stifle their laughs while watching because it did not quite match the reality of school life. Others said it was well-composed of different parts of KMLA with a picturesque mood.

Now that the holidays are over, many students have a hard time returning to their daily routines. However, thoughts of the Alma Mater Homecoming Day and the admiring eyes of future KMLA hopefuls serve as our encouragement to strive forward. Catching up with our past and taking stock of how far we've come can serve as a great source of motivation!

Being an Adult:
Coming-of-Age Ceremony

28th waver Jeonggyeom Kuk

"With great power comes great responsibility."

With this classic phrase, Uncle Ben explained to Spider-Man what an adult is. An adult human automatically assumes greater authority and responsibility than a juvenile. On Friday, May 26th, 2023, KMLA's traditional Coming-of-Age Ceremony was conducted for the newly-adult seniors, with each step of the ceremony carrying its own significance.

Adding Korean customs to the Coming-of-Age Ceremony honors the maturation of third-graders. At the beginning of the ceremony, the chief guests and other visitors enter the gym, followed by many well-dressed parents and family members, many of them in colorful hanboks. Parents and guests bow,and eventually students enter.

The Hwang Hyeong-ju teacher then explained that the ceremony's hosts are the parents, with the invited guests participating at their request to provide valuable advice for their children. Guests were welcomed with a great deal of respect. Students in the third grade then donned gat (a traditional Korean cap made of bamboo and horsehair worn by men) or ayam (a fur cap worn by women during the winter).

Traditionally, adults wear gat and ayam, and this placement upon their heads signifies that the third graders are now mature individuals. When they pose as adults, they should assume adult responsibilities.

All of the students were given 'Ja(字),' a second name given to individuals when they reach adulthood and commonly used by their acquaintances. Students will adhere to the correct interpretation of Ja. Ro Jun-young, the 3rd grader, said that his 'Ja' is 'Hyedang', which means "the house full of grace'. He said his grandmother made Ja for him since she wants him to always live with God. He said that he felt as if he was born again with his new Ja. Also because it has nice meaning and pronunciation, he thinks it's lovely enough to be called with his 'ja'. The principal guest advised them: "Live each moment by the profound meaning of your Ja." When adults have a second identity, they should have adult responsibilities.

Finally, the third graders shared tea with their ancestors and parents. Before the ceremony, the parents traveled to the southern region of Korea to obtain their "first tree-grown tea." The third graders first shared tea with their progenitors using this tea.

Traditionally, when a person first becomes an adult, he or she visits his or her forefather and shares alcohol with him or her. For obvious reasons, tea is substituted for alcohol at KMLA's version of the Coming of Age ceremony. The result is a touching scene of students drinking tea with their parents. Throughout this process, Hwang Hyeong-ju explained how the vitality of life and ancestors is transmitted to the students via their parents and how we should keep in mind that third graders have a responsibility as future leaders who draw their inspiration from life, their parents, and their ancestors.

"With great power comes great responsibility." During the Coming-of-Age Ceremony, all students symbolically became adults. They are now recognized as more capable of effecting change than children. Therefore, as the entire ceremony emphasizes, all students must have greater responsibilities than children. We all hope our KMLA seniors feel a greater sense of pride and ambition from this beautiful ceremony that has finally resumed normally after the lifting Covid-19 restrictions.

Good luck to the 26th wave!

FRED: Fabulously Ravishing Educational Dialogues

28th waver Minseo Kang

For many students, Memorial Day means sleeping in, catching up on homework and enjoying a relaxed day without morning exercise. Yet, on the morning of June 6th, 15 students gathered at the Dasan Auditorium holding iPads or printed scripts, nervously speaking to themselves as they made last minute preparations to compete in KMLA's English Speech and Presentation Contest, otherwise known as 2023's FRED. Modeled after the world famous TED Talks, FRED also features a stage decorated with the giant sized red letters, which Mr. Garrioch, the creator of the event, says stands for "Fun Reinspired through Edutainment and Diversity."

As KMLA's most prestigious English-speaking contest, FRED is now in its tenth year having begun in 2013. Benchmarking the spirit of TED, every year contestants are presented with a theme. From there, students freely propose a topic in a written application, and then English Department teachers select those which they feel best meet the standards of the event. Finalists then have the biggest task of preparing an 8-minute talk, which can include anything from their own personal stories to issues that they are passionate about. Really, anything goes.

This year's theme was "This is an actual fact," owing to our current age where advanced technologies and media are constantly leading towards widespread false information. Regardless of whether or not a fact is identified, students are to utter the phrase "This is an actual fact" as they present their speech. Constantly reminded that FRED is open-topic, students did not limit their topics and rather explored unique topics ranging from recycling masks to understanding the complexities of Korean history. FRED encourages students to "think outside the box" hoping that creativity is fully expressed in an open playground for free speech.

This English speaking contest is not your conventional "high school speech contest." To provide the contestants with utmost accuracy and a professional experience, members of EOP volunteered to help out with this event. The Head of the EOP Department, Ryan Hong, acted as MC, while two other members took pictures, and two acted as time keepers, with a few additional students monitoring the doors to prevent disturbances during speeches. From the stage's design to the planned schedule, everything was meticulously planned to perfection.

> **"FRED is all about having fun. We don't want you to feel pressured or scared about this, so think of it as a workshop and a learning experience of trial and error rather than a contest. It's a rare chance to develop your public speaking skill, which is becoming more and more important day by day,"**

said Mr. Garrioch, the contest's main organizer, at the opening. Joined by two other judges Mr. Wayne Baumgardner and Mr. Albert Lee, Mr Garrioch thanked everyone who decided to dedicate their precious morning hours to join the crowd at the auditorium. And thus began FRED 2023, and it was fascinating to hear all kinds of ideas in the short span of 8 minutes as the event progressed. Many attendees and contestants had positive things to say.

"I worried that I might fall asleep in the auditorium chair because it had the perfect angle for a comfortable nap, but actually the talks the students gave today were so entrancing that I forgot to sleep and got immersed into their speech!"

At the conclusion of the event, Mr. Garrioch shared that the judges were extremely impressed with the dedication shown by busy KMLA students to make the event extremely competitive. "To be completely honest with you all, Mr. Baumgardner and I, who have judged every FRED since it began ten years ago, agree that the general quality of presentations has never been this high!"

Originally, the announcement of the FRED results was scheduled for the next Morning Assembly, but due to conflicting events such as the seniors' and juniors' finals, it was later announced on July 3rd through the KMLA's school website. The first-place winner was **Lim Seyoung**, a 28th waver, who impressed the audience with her speech titled "Indifferent to Crisis: Disposable Masks." Securing the second place were two contestants from the 28th wave, **Minseo Kang** and **Hyowon Son**. Lastly, the third-place winners were **Ain Cho**, a 28th waver, **Seojin Lee** from the 27th wave, and **Seoin Kim** from the 26th wave.

Reflecting on her experience, **Seyoung Lim**, the winner of this year's FRED, shared, “I initially joined the contest because I wanted to challenge myself with a free topic speech. Watching confident speakers on TED inspired me to share my own genuine ideas and experiences.” She further explained, "Developing the idea for my speech was the real challenge, and it took me around two weeks. However, once I settled on the topic, the rest of the process was relatively smooth. Creating the presentation and memorizing the speech weren't as difficult as I anticipated. Winning first place came as a pleasant surprise to me because I felt there were many other captivating and coherent speeches in the contest. Nevertheless, I'm sincerely grateful and happy with the final result, feeling that my time and effort were well spent."

Hyowon Son, the second-place winner, considered her participation in FRED a memorable experience. "When I first saw the notice, I thought to myself, 'When else will I have the opportunity to deliver an English public speech to an audience?' So, just for the fun of it, I signed up." She added, “When I heard the theme, ‘This is an actual fact,’ I pondered on the concept of trustworthy facts and realized that the most reliable ones come from my own experiences. This led me to brainstorm about myself, my passions, and aspirations. Having just returned from the Vision Trip, I had numerous selfies, which sparked the idea of crafting a speech around them.” Reflecting on her second-place victory, she expressed, "I intended to deliver a lighthearted and comedic speech, similar to what standup comedians do. Despite getting nervous and stumbling over some lines, I'm extremely grateful and honored to receive this award. Participating in this competition has been a valuable and enriching experience!"

Obviously, these were no match for those million view YouTube TED talks, but in their 8-minute speeches, participants embedded themselves into the spirit of what it means to be a KMLA student. Spending hours on trying to prepare for the presentation. Waking up early in the morning when they could have slept in. Courageously standing in front of an audience, telling their own stories. Through this process, the students gained something for themselves by sharing themselves with others, and everyone's a winner in that regard.

I think it is a great way of motivating students to convey their thoughts to others. The free themes were another reason to enjoy the contest. It allows people to be creative. To think about how to connect their stories together to create their own ‘fact’.

FRED is a great opportunity for everyone regardless of their field to enjoy. Usually, students tend to follow the status quo: the internationals go to all sorts of contests, and domestics usually focus on the term tests and scores. However, in this competition, everyone could enjoy it without any stress or pressure. It indeed was the perfect space to enjoy and learn from one another.

These are the thoughts of the students who were at the auditorium on that day.

Whether or not fun memories or important life lessons were gained from these thought-provoking talks, we can confidently say that 2023’s FRED was a huge success, and yet another step forward as KMLA reblooms.

A Bed-Dazzling Replacement: Finally, a Good Night's Sleep

28th waver Sangmin Lee

Since the opening of KMLA in 1996, one has to wonder what the average bunk bed in the dorm has witnessed. Hosting multiple students from each of the 28 waves, that amounts to over 3 million hours of REM sleep dedicated to nightmares of quizzes and morning exercises. Finally, after 24 years, the dorm beds in KMLA are finally being replaced as this article is being written. A monumental and expensive undertaking that hasn't been seen since the opening of the school in 1996; no doubt this is more than just a physical change in the facility.

Regarding the question, "Why did the school decide to replace the beds at this time?", the Administration Office referred to the change as "inevitable" and "required for the students" for the furniture had grown too old. The school, scheduled to go through yet another construction regarding the repair of the ceilings, showed no hesitation to go through changes for the safety and comfort of students.

Prior to the replacement, students were asked to clean their rooms and remove everything from their previous beds. During the 7th and 8th periods on May 26th, a school-scale cleaning took place. Since the bed, desk, and mattress were being replaced, students had to move everything to the personal closet, GLPS closet, or the bathroom. Chairs were stored separately in the empty lecture rooms.

While the process was tedious and took a long time, the air was full of excitement for the change. Just the idea that their 24-year-old furniture was being replaced made students eager to finish the cleaning. "I think it's lucky that the change is happening during our time at the school," a 28th waver mentioned.

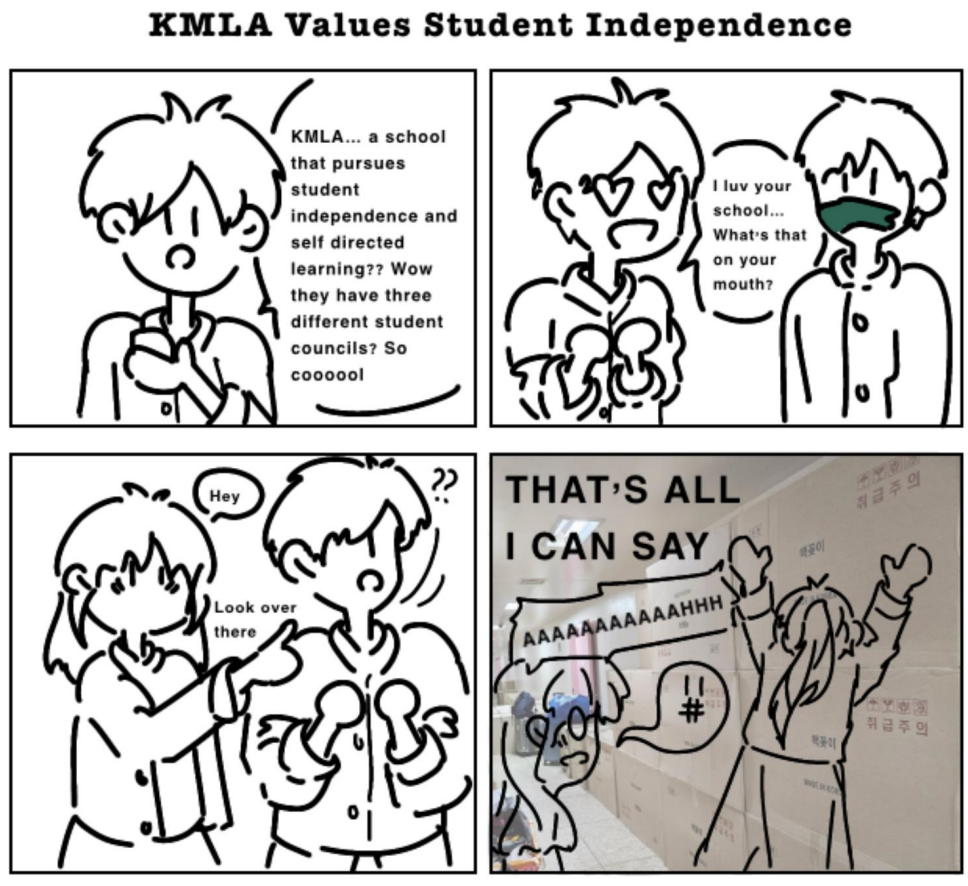
A couple of days prior, multiple trucks lined up in front of Deokgo House, along with hundreds of wooden planks filling the space beside the futsal field. The unusual sight showed the sheer scale of the event. Some students were surprised by the unfamiliar view, while others were excited about the change. The process lasted from Saturday to Tuesday as workers removed the existing beds and replaced them with 480 new ones. The individual cost of each bed was nearly 2 million won, surmounting over 900 million won in total.

The process of the replacement, however, didn't exactly flow the smoothest. Due to a mismeasurement, some personal closets had to be removed. While clothing hangers were provided as a temporary measure, students complained about the inconvenience and especially the absence of notice.

Also, while the workers had worked day and night to install the hundreds of beds, it was not possible to do it in time. At the time of the student's arrival, ladders for the beds weren't installed. The drawers had not been unboxed yet, making it the student's job to install them and throw away the boxes as well as clean the furniture. They were chaotic, exhausting hours for the students.

The results of the replacement, on the other hand, showed that the expenditure had not gone to waste. The beds have a higher railing that grants more privacy and prevents students from falling. The stairs are less steep, allowing for safer and more comfortable climbing. A 28th waver said, "Just the fact that it's new is enough for me." Another mentioned, "The extra bookshelf is what really does it for me."

One of the glaring problems in KMLA that students point out to this day, is the aging and outdated facilities. Decades-old beds are, or were, the most evident. However, KMLA is going through a change for the better. The change goes beyond just beds; improvements in other conditions are soon to arrive. Students are happy to see progress, and for the time being, they will no doubt be fascinated by the wonder of a good night's sleep. Perhaps not morning-exercise-desirable, but a fresh start to the day after sweeter dreams can be the beginning of a better KMLA life.



Commemorative Ceremony With KCC a.k.a KMLA Patron

28th waver Seyoung Lim

Nowadays, many students experience restful nights of sleep thanks to more comfortable beds and blackout curtains. They are also happy about cleaner desks with more space for them to use. Although there have been some issues regarding their installation of them, students are generally satisfied with their new dormitory interior. On every bed, there is a panel: This bedding set was made by KCC sponsorship.

KCC has been sponsoring KMLA by the will of the previous chairman, Sang-young Chung. The company has donated approximately 10 billion won to our school out of his legacy, and the current chairman, Mong-jin Chung, has privately contributed 3 billion won following the precedent. With their support, KMLA has given out scholarships to students, improved school facilities, and strived for better educational conditions.

In that regard, KCC authorities visited KMLA to join the facility replacement-commemorative ceremony on June 22nd. Held during school hours, it was a small-scale event with only a few teachers and students. Nonetheless, the concerned all participated, including the headmaster, the Director of the Administration Office, the Director of the Division of Student Affairs, and a few more teachers. Two seniors and seven freshmen also joined the ceremony while absent for their fourth periods, all wearing formal school uniforms.

Teacher Byeong-moon Oh, the Director of the Division of Student Affairs, started the ceremony by saying words of gratitude for the support of the KCC group. Then the headmaster and one of the executives of KCC each had a short speech in turn. They mostly were words of gratitude and hoping for a constant and friendly relationship between KMLA and KCC.

Certificates of Scholarship were also given out to the 28th wavers. After the speeches, five freshmen received their certificates from the executive member of KCC. One student expressed his feelings after getting it.

"I felt proud and grateful but a bit pressured at the same time. I felt that I owe society a debt after receiving a considerable amount of money as a scholarship, and I so thought I should be a person who can return surpassing worth to it."

On a side note, the company authorities went inside the dormitory to look around the rooms after the official ceremony. Although it was a necessary procedure, some of the students living on the ground floor had to undergo a thorough room cleaning the previous night. As a result, one of the 28th wavers was found exhausted on the day of the ceremony. When a teacher asked why during a class, he said he had to stay up until 3 am to finish all the cleaning.

Having a reliable partnership is always helpful. Such is the current partnership between KMLA and the KCC group. Hopefully, the relationship will improve more as time passes, growing into a "strong bond after consistent efforts.

EDS 40
MOCK TRIAL 41
HYEUMNARAE 43
CROSS COUNTRY 44

BEHIND THE CLUBS

THE HEART AND THE VERY SOUL OF KMLA LIFE.

ENGLISH DEBATE SOCIETY

27th waver Inyoung Yi

EDS, the English Debate Society, is a renowned club at KMLA that holds debates every week with Mr. Wayne Baumgardner as the coach. It has a rich history and is one of the most active and esteemed clubs in the school. The club has produced many successful alumni, and there is even a special group on Facebook with all the prior EDS members. This interview was done on June 23rd with Mr. Baumgardner in his office.

MH: When was EDS first started? How did it come into existence?

I don't exactly know. When I first came to KMLA in 2007, EDS already existed. But, it didn't have a coach back then. In 2007, the Asian Parliament format was new and we only knew the KMLA form of debate. There were some funny occasions where students would poi their teams as well. Debating was the only real activity high school students in Korea were able to do. And now, it has expanded to many different activities: math, science, bird watching, and others. But, back then EDS was 'the club'.

MH: EDS is indeed one of the most renowned clubs at KMLA. Why do you think it still holds the title of one of the best clubs?

Perhaps it's because of the club's long history of 20 years. I didn't realize it was so popular until now.

MH: What's your favorite memory of EDS, and do you have a favorite wave?

I've always felt like I was a part of this school, thanks to my extensive involvement in the GLPS program, where I've been a part of 20 camps. Many students I taught at GLPS later became students here, and I met many TAs and PAs who were already part of this school. The strong connection and my fondness for the place, along with knowing people who work here, made me want to be a part of it. Timing played a role, and it feels like the right moment.

MH: Can you share your favorite place in the school or in general?

Every memory with EDS is special to me. Witnessing students win tournaments and bringing pride to KMLA has been a gratifying experience. As for a favorite wave, each wave had its own unique style, chemistry, and way of doing club activities. It's hard to pick a favorite as they were all special and memorable in their own ways. One particularly memorable experience was when Jina Park, Jaesung Lee, and Jihoon Kang won every single debate tournament in Korea. They had perfect team chemistry and swept all speaker awards.

MH: That must have been an incredible achievement. When do you think EDS had its most glorious time?

I wouldn't say a specific "glorious time," but having WSDC members every year makes EDS feel glorious. Better keep up the good work.

MH: What skills do you think are required for an EDS member to excel in debating?

I mean you should ask EDS members this question, but I believe strong English skills, in-depth knowledge of global issues, confidence in public speaking, and clear logical thinking are essential for a good debater. Team chemistry is also crucial for effective collaboration.

MH: What, in your opinion, is the essence of debate?

Debate is about learning, challenging your own ideas, understanding why you believe in something, and appreciating the perspectives of others. It's a valuable way to examine various issues and fosters essential life skills such as communication, finding common ground, and critical thinking.

MH: Debate indeed offers a plethora of benefits. I'm so proud to be a member of EDS myself. Any last words for prior EDS members and current EDS members?

To all prior EDS members and current members, you hold a special place in my heart. I have always enjoyed our sessions together, regardless of the outcome. Your passion, commitment, and dedication on the podium have been remarkable. I hope your time in EDS has been a valuable learning experience and that you create amazing memories, just like I did with you.

I am so, so proud of EDS, and for a good reason. It's not just that we get grand prizes and awards but that we all work extremely hard to excel in what we love doing. It's commitment, teamwork and hard dedication you won't see anywhere else.

-Chaewon Kang, 26th waver of EDS-

MOCK TRIAL

28th waver Minseo Kang

Mock trials stand apart from other team activities by demanding more than mere words and presenting evidence to sway the juries. It is the intricate interplay between witnesses and attorneys, the subtleties of gestures, and the smallest of details that truly tip the scales in the jury's decision-making process. From the moment the team enters the courtroom, they fully embody their unique characters, whether it be a victim of voting fraud or a wrongly accused journalist. Whether passionately defending or analytically prosecuting, they skillfully craft and perform their scenes, armed with meticulously prepared evidence and the ability to adapt to impromptu challenges, drawing the audience deep into the courtroom drama.

KMLA Mock Trial has been making its own history since the 18th~20th wavers. 24th waver Sophie Kim, a former member of the KMLA Mock Trial as an attorney, takes us back through her journey and alluring charms of mock trials. As she is currently studying abroad, this interview was conducted via messenger.

MH: Can you briefly tell us about the history of KMLA Mock Trial?

I believe KMLA Mock Trial was founded among the 18th~ 20th wavers as an English mock courtroom club. Since then, the club has been participating in domestic competitions such as KMTA held both in winter and summer, as well as international competitions like Empire, building history together.

MH: What are the key activities of this club?

Our club members are initially presented with a “case” to work on. Usually, the case includes the testimonies of six witnesses, and additional pieces of evidence we call “exhibit”. Based on these given materials, we closely analyze how to present the case in a courtroom setting, assuming roles as judges, attorneys, and witnesses. Throughout the process, we engage in a dynamic interplay of eloquent arguments, quick thinking, theatrical performance, impromptu, and logical reasoning.

MH: What prompted you to join the Mock Trial initially?

I was always interested in English debates, and while looking for clubs with similar fields, I came across KMLA Mock Trial. At first sight, I had little intention of joining. However, after sitting in at one of their demonstrative performances, it completely changed my mind. Witnessing the charisma of the seniors during the mock trial compelled me to apply and become part of the club.

MH: Were there any significant challenges or obstacles you encountered during your Mock Trial? How did you overcome them?

During the first year of joining the mock trial, our team had the opportunity to participate in the Empire, an international competition held in San Francisco.

The pressure to excel in an international competition, combined with the presence of highly skilled teams from all around the world, created a significant sense of burden. To overcome these challenges, we fostered a sense of unity within our team. providing support and encouragement to one another. With the sense of unity, we developed an unwavering confidence, and with that we participated in the competition with determination.

MH: Did the COVID-19 pandemic impact the club activities?

Unfortunately, the Mock Trial was not able to avoid the impact of COVID-19. Due to this virus, many competitions and activities shifted to online platforms, which inevitably diminished the sense of intensity and quick thinking required in physical courtroom settings. As team selections and practices transitioned to virtual formats, it became more difficult to synchronize and establish the very needed teamwork. However, by combining online and in-person elements, we tried to recreate the vibrant atmosphere reminiscent of pre-pandemic times.

MH: Mock Trial seems to rely heavily on the synergy between the witness and the attorney, making teamwork an essential key in Mock Trial. What efforts did you undertake to enhance collaboration among the club members?

Extensive practice stands as the foundation of our efforts. The more we practiced, the better our coordination and ability to maintain seamless and professional flow during the competitions improved. Additionally, we assigned one attorney to work closely with one witness, allowing them to establish a strong rapport and, subsequently, compete together in multiple competitions. Understanding each other's styles and fostering camaraderie became vital components of our team dynamics. Furthermore, developing personal bonds and mutual reliance, while refraining from blaming one another, proved instrumental in maintaining team resilience throughout the journey.

MH: Since Mock Trial itself demands a lot of time and dedication, balancing between the school work and club activities must’ve been a great task. How did you navigate through this challenge?

Maintaining equilibrium between the demanding club activities and academic pursuits indeed posed a significant challenge. It was not until my second year of high school that I fully comprehended this aspect. Leveraging spare pockets of time, such as lunch breaks and free periods, I dedicated myself to mock trial preparations, maximizing efficiency during practice sessions.

MH: Were there any exhilarating moments you experienced during your Mock Trial journey?

The most exhilarating moment was delivering the final closing argument against a U.S. team during the Empire competition. Speaking extemporaneously for one minute, without relying on a script, allowed me to truly comprehend the essence of an adrenaline rush.

MH: Given the substantial time dedicated to case analysis and preparation among the club members, could you please share a memorable moment you experienced?

One of our cases involved a murder scenario where the restaurant owner had placed a business partner inside a refrigerator. I vividly remember a friend of mine trying to reenact that scene, venturing into the hotel's refrigerator and taking a commemorative photo.

MH: What is the most alluring aspect of Mock Trial that draws people in?

I believe that participating in Mock Trial offers a valuable opportunity to learn how to conduct oneself formally in English and develop essential qualities such as confidence and quick thinking. Moreover, the undeniable advantage lies in the profound friendships forged among team members. Throughout the multitude of competitions and practices, we have shared countless moments of laughter and tears, solidifying our bond.

MH: How did taking a part in KMLA Mock Trial influenced your life?

Prior to engaging in mock trials, my career plans remained uncertain. However, through active participation in the club, my interest in the field of law was profoundly piqued. I can confidently state that this involvement has had a substantial impact on shaping my current path, with my dedication extending to college-level mock trial

MH: Finally, do you have final thoughts or messages you'd like to share?

Being a part of the KMLA Mock Trial was a challenging but a rewarding experience. I would like to express my gratitude to my fellow mock trial friends from the 24th class.

"May it please the court"

HYEUM NARAE

Hyeumnarae is a renowned physics club at KMLA that undertakes the challenge of solving complex physics theories and conducting sophisticated experiments. Founded by the 11th wavers, the club's name, "Hyeumnarae," translates to "Thoughts with Wings" in Korean, signifying their commitment to exploring the world of physics with creativity and tenacity.

Mr. Kim Yonsoo, the club's mentor, shared insights about Hyeumnarae during a recent interview on June 28th at his office in Dasan Hall.

MH: When and by whom was Hyeumnarae first established?

I believe Hyeumnarae was first made by the 11th wavers. They wanted to make a club that could solve and discuss challenging physics problems and prove their theories with sophisticated experiments

MH: What does Hyeumnarae (혜움나래) exactly mean?

Ah, that's a very good question. "Hyeum" means "thoughts" in Korean, and "narae" means "wings" in Korean. We named our club "Hyeumnarae" since we wanted club members to explore the world of physics with creativity and great tenacity.

MH: I didn't know there was a profound meaning behind the club name Hyeumnarae. Then what does the club exactly do? Are there any specific activities that the club does?

We explore the world of physics and solve challenging physics problems. Every year, the KSG and KPS announce seventeen unresolved phenomena. Then the members of Hyeumnarae group into five and discuss within the group to find a solution to each problem until winter vacation. Students also work and lodge together round-the-clock for about three weeks during winter vacation and conduct experiments and establish theoretical models.It takes great effort, cooperation and creativity to reach a convincing conclusion. Then they attend KYPT (Korean Young Physicists' Tournament), and if they win, attend IYPT (International Young Physicists' Tournament).

MH: It sounds like an amazing club. When do you think was the glorious time of Hyeumnarae?

Well, obviously every wave! But to be more specific, 11, 12, 14, 15, 16, 19, 23, and 25 wavers of Hyeumnarae won the national championship. Additionally the 12, 14, and 15 wavers won the world championship!

28th waver Suhyoon Jahng

MH: Are there any unforgettable stories you would like to share?

Until the 19th waver, teachers had the power to select new members. Since I prioritize physical endurance over any other values, I made students do push-ups. It was part of the screening process! One student tried very hard, but didn't make the cut by a narrow margin. But he didn't fall apart. He tried harder and showed more enthusiasm in physics and experiments. This can be quite off-topic, but this is the thing that I wanted to tell the students. School clubs aren't everything in your life. I've seen too many freshmen who were disappointed because they got disqualified from a club. But clubs aren't everything in your life. You have so many chances ahead of you.

MH: Any last words for the Hyeumnarae members?

I am very proud of all the members of Hyeumnarae. All the members have done a great job, and I 100% believe in their potential. But always make sure, being physically fit is most important. And always try to challenge yourself!

"To me, Hyeumnarae represents a significant turning point in my high school journey. The life advice generously shared by Mr. Yeonsu Kim, as well as the invaluable mindset I've cultivated for my KMLA experience, have been instrumental in guiding me down the right path. While the improvement of my physics skills and my success in various competitions alongside my Hyeumnarae team members are certainly noteworthy achievements, I hold the belief that the true essence of Hyeumnarae transcends these accomplishments. The real essence of Hyeumnarae, in my view, lies in the unwavering spirit of exploration—a spirit that refuses to succumb to temptations and adversities. It also resides in the collaborative effort of helping fellow team members navigate their own journeys."

-Hangyun Cho, 27th waver of Hyeumnarae-

CROSS COUNTRY

28th waver Jeonggyeom Kuk

The area of the KMLA campus is approximately 1.1 million m^2, and the part of Deokgo Mountain that is owned by KMLA takes up a significant area of the campus. However, a lot of students only became familiar with the man-made places under the mountain, such as Deokgo House, Dasan and Chungmoo Halls, or the Culture Center. But the mountain itself is also a component of the school and a place of learning. A club named Crosscountry explores the nature of KMLA and learns from it under the guidance of Mr. Alexander Ganse. To gain a deeper sense of this club, I interviewed all involved, and as a member, myself, I've provided my own insights.

MH: How was Crosscountry started? How has it developed?

Not by me. By another teacher called Richard Menard. He was a Canadian English teacher, and he liked outdoor activities in a different way than I do. So without the nature, a more boy scout kind of approach. When he founded the club, three people signed up: three teachers and no students. And two years later, a student asked me, "Can you open a class in which you can teach me how to read animal footprints in the ground?" And I told him, "Class is too much for that. But this club is existing so sign up, and we have two hours a week and no tests, and I can teach you." So they did, and we started with two students, then next semester five students, and you can imagine how it became more.

The Activity of Crosscountry

Every Wednesday, students go outdoors and explore with Mr. Ganse. Sometimes he gives some explanations about the nature around KMLA, and sometimes students ask about what they've observed.

Location: Mountain behind the Deokgo House

Before Deokgo House was constructed, the site was a an untamed mountain. The school had to cut away the mountain to construct it.

Workers drilled holes and placed dynamite inside the rock, thereby creating a space. Therefore, following dynamite detonation, the rock was fractured, and the holes still remain.

Location: pond of Ham young dang, the Culture Center

When it rains, numerous frogs leap into the pond and reproduce there. Due to this, when the sun rises again and the water begins to evaporate, 'terrible' things occur. Therefore, Mr. Ganse installed a green net to prevent frogs from entering the pond.

Location: Behind the traditional Korean archery range

An example of Mr. Ganse's insight: "Is there anything strange about this?" The forest is excessively brown. And there are an excessive number of fallen leaves. Even though there are sufficient nutrients (dead leaves) in the soil of Deokgo Mountain, the recycling of these resources is sluggish due to the presence of certain problems. Mr. Ganse also showed the actual soil of Deokgo and other mountains. Everyone could see that their colors are different.

MH: What value did you gain through the Crosscountry activities?

Member 1: I originally loved mountains. It was a great time for me to walk the mountain and take pictures of it.

Member 2: It was interesting for me to learn about the story of KMLA. I learned that observation allows us to intuit a lot about natural phenomena.

Member 3: Looking at moles and mole tunnels was really interesting! It was the first time in my life, and I will remember it forever!

MH: Are there any messages for students about Crosscountry?

The message is, if you have been at KMLA and you have not used this opportunity to gain a true appreciation of the mountain, you may not have the chance again once you finish your three years here. Seize the moment and ask to join Mr. Ganse's tour in any capacity.

46 The Era of *Magikoon* and *Mahaeja* has Come to an End
47 Meok-Sa-Pal; KMLAian's Corner Store
48 KMLA's Great Culture of Sharing Values Revived
49 KMLA Parties: Stop Ctrl C and Ctrl V
50 Meaning Making in KMLA
51 Reboot and Reinforce: EOP Zones
52 The Story of KMLA: How Long Will it Last?
53 A Double Edge Sword: Chat GPT
54 Brining the Medical Divide
55 Is KMLA a Democratic Society?
57 The Candlelight Spirit of KMLA: Does It Still Exist?
58 LGBTQ Pride in KMLA
60 A Contemplation n the Penalty Point System
62 What Age 19 Means to You

Steve Jobs says, "The ones who are crazy enough to think they can change the world are those who do." Through past editions of the Minjok Herald, KMLAians asked for changes in our very own world, KMLA. Most of the time, our voices haven't changed our world dramatically or influenced society for the better. The fact that the world isn't changing that much could've discouraged many KMLAians. However, we're proud to say KMLAians are crazy enough to think they can change the world since yesterday, today, and tomorrow. With massive gratitude towards our community, which remains crazy, the crew of Minjok Herald proposes to go crazy once again. Through the school's sustainability, LGBTQ, candlelight spirit, and coping in KMLA, Minjok Herald, we ask readers to participate in staying crazy, shattering beliefs with the hope that together we are indeed who will change the world.

Editorial

The Era of *Magikoon* and *Mahaeja* Has Come to an End

27th waver Dogyeong Kim

As the Korean government declared wearing masks indoors to become voluntary from the 2nd of March in 2023, citizens felt a bit of freedom from wearing masks. However, there was no overnight change and of course some were not happy with the relaxed policy. For some it might be due to concerns of spreading Covid, while for others it is more of a psychological issue: inevitable anxiety that people will see how they really look without a mask. People around the world have covered up half of their faces for the better part of three years, thus, taking off masks could feel awkward. In fact, when taking off masks, people often look strikingly different from what we might have expected. Sometimes it is even more than we could have imagined.

As we ease forward out of the pandemic, it is not strange that the new word 'Mask fishing' appeared from the COVID-19 era. This new term, which consists of a combination of 'mask' and 'scammer' means that the difference in appearance is a sort of scam. In Korean, we call it a '*magikoon*', a compound word of 'mask' and 'scammer', meaning that wearing a mask looks better. '*Mahaeja*', on the other hand, is another compound word of 'mask' and 'victim', meaning that taking off the mask looks much better than wearing it.

Because of this reaction, many people want to know whether they are *magikoon* or *mahaeja*. Various smartphone apps for identifying *magikoon* have appeared on the Internet, drawing attention from users. In fact, if you analyze the picture of wearing a mask through the app, the degree of your 'scaming' will be determined within a minute. Though, it is difficult to say that it is an objective result, the emergence of such apps gave a glimpse towards how people are constantly aware of "lookism." and interested in new terms such as *magikoon* and *mahaeja*. An online community also used the expression 'Day of *Mahaeja*' to celebrate the time when the outdoor mask became nonobligatory, while some also satirized it as 'The Day of Judgment for the *Magikoon*'.

For further understanding, Minjok Herald interviewed Seunghyeon Park from the 26th wave.

MH: As you know, it is no longer mandatory to wear masks since the 2nd of March. Do you now go without your mask?

Yes, I do.

MH: How do you feel going maskless after 3 years of pandemic?

Of course, wearing a mask was a bit uncomfortable, so I think it is definitely convenient now. It is so nice to see my friends' whole faces that I didn't know before. I'm a bit embarrassed to walk around not wearing a mask, but I think it is interesting to see many of my friends looking different with masks on and without them.

MH: What do you think of others' faces without their mask?

Some were faces I expected and some were different from what I expected. I felt that the jaw area in the face might be more important than I thought in determining one's impression. If we wear a mask, we can only see the eyes because the jaw area is covered, so I think it is natural that people's impressions change when they take off their masks?

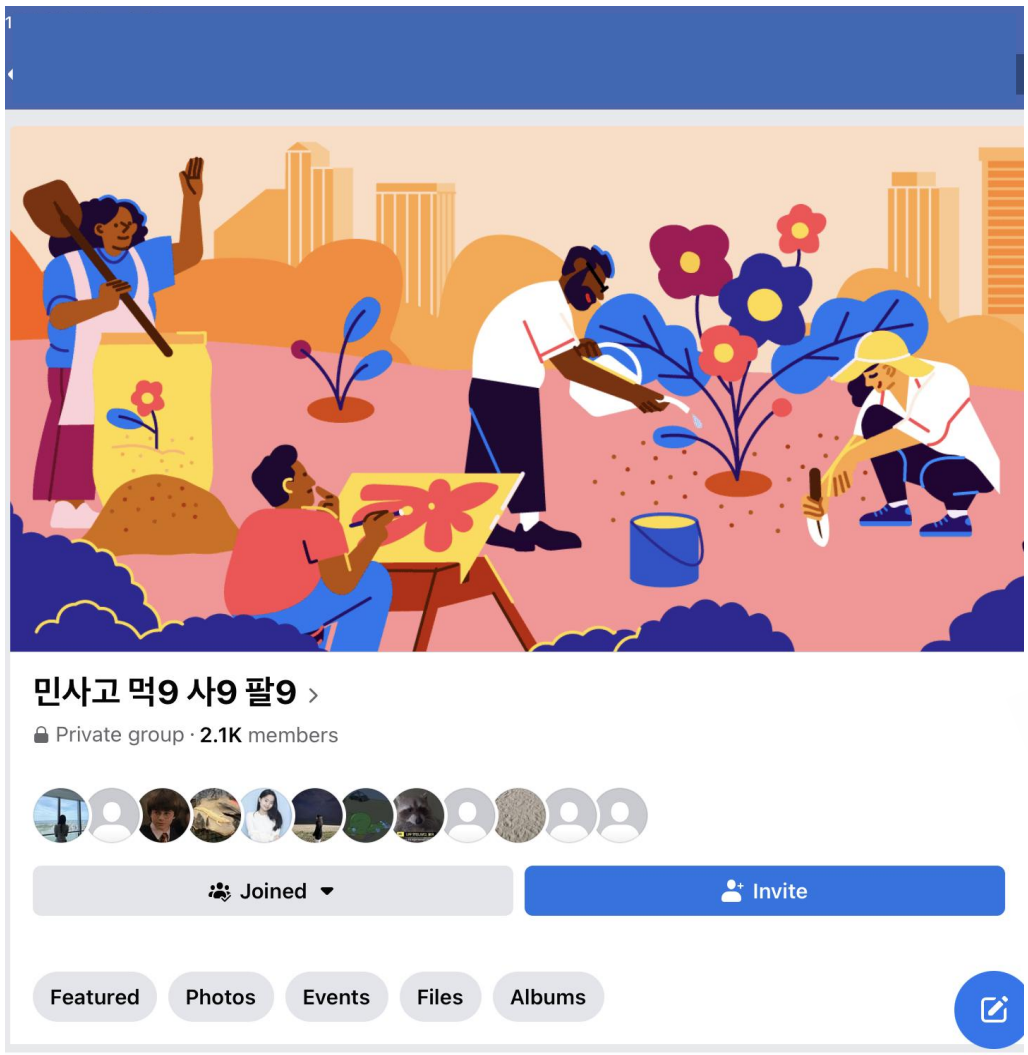
MH: Do you personally think that you are a *magikoon* or a *mahaeja*?

I don't think I fit in either one of the two. Rather than calling myself a "*magikoon*" or a "*mahaeja*", I would like to say that I'm embarrassed to take off my mask. When I asked my roommate if he thought I looked different with a mask on and without it, he said the difference wasn't that big, but still, there were some. He stated that when I wore a mask, I looked sharp because my eyes were keen, but when I took it off, he said that I don't look that sharp.

MH | What effects or changes in people's behavior do you expect as people take off their masks?

I think there are people who still wear masks because they have covered their faces and now they have to show their whole face. You might be embarrassed to think that you're suddenly showing your real face, and that's why I think everyone would pay more attention to their appearance, especially how they look. But masks protect us from diseases and viruses, therefore, cold or other infectious diseases might be transmitted unexpectedly. Plus, it will have a negative impact on the mask companies. As the demand for masks changed, there would definitely be an economic impact. Wearing a mask was covering oneself, so I think people would feel closer to each other when they take off their mask. Also, COVID-19 isn't over yet, but we can still feel as if it is, so I guess many people finally feel free.

As such, as wearing masks is no longer an obligation, many changes are happening socially and economically. Furthermore, there are also reactions such as "I need time to adjust to not wearing a mask" and "I need to take off my mask and buy some lipstick." There is also a ridiculous response that "People who still wear masks when it is no longer mandatory are *magikoon*." The Minjok Herald looks forward to documenting these reactions and changes as the situation evolves and adjusts. Soon, our social media pages and pictures of our youth won't be as vaguely depicted as clear "Covid era" reminders of difficult times. Regardless of when or why we finally go without masks, it should be a personal choice free of prejudices and labels.



▲ THE MEOK-SA-PAL GROUP PAGE

Meok-Sa-Pal: KMLAian's Corner Store

28th waver Seoeun Bae

Meok-Sa-Pal is a Facebook group created by an anonymous KMLA student on February 14th, 2012. Since then, it has been used for various purposes for 11 years. It is now one of the many Facebook groups KMLA students use in their daily lives. The group was originally created for buying and selling different kinds of food.

Because of the isolated KMLA environment, it is difficult to get access to food other than from the cafeteria. So Meok-Sa-Pal acts as a platform to buy or sell different snacks.

However, over the years Meok-Sa-Pal has evolved to serve a much more diverse purpose, and now is a platform for buying and selling student/dormitory necessities such as calculators or even vacuum cleaners, and even further as a bookstore. Also, the group is used for various announcement purposes, spreading essential news for clubs, departments, and even from teachers. The lives of KMLAians are so much more convenient because of it, and the last-minute purchase of a calculator before a next-day test is a common thing.

Despite the convenience and diverse usage of the Meok-Sa-Pal group, there are controversies around how students use it, primarily how it has lost its original purpose of selling food and snacks. Right now, more than half of the posts on the group are not about food. Rather, most of them are announcements or buy-and-sell posts. The problem is that there is another group for more "formal" or "official" announcements, and there is a lack of consistency about what to read and where to find it. Students say that they need a separate, unified group for these posts because the announcements are getting too unorganized and difficult to keep up with.

Fortunately, there have been many efforts to clean up the Meok-Sa-Pal group to make it more helpful. The administrators, two 26th wavers, have made a post that exhibits a simple guideline: all posts that could make some students uncomfortable or be considered as cyber-bullying will be erased. Also, 27th waver Geunwoo Bae, the current head of the Executive Council, has promised the students that he would bring further changes into the group.

During an interview, Geunwoo informed us of a new project he will be working on for the Facebook group. He says that one of the biggest problems he's noticed is how unorganized group buying is arranged. To make this a bit more convenient, he is going to simplify the process and unify the pricing. However, he did not address anything regarding the group losing its purpose or its unnecessary posts. For now, it seems like KMLAians have to rely on the admins as far as this matter goes.

Meok-Sa-Pal is definitely a convenient and useful Facebook group that is helping out a lot of KMLAians. However, it is also true that the group is losing its purpose and is cluttered with unnecessary posts. The administrators are trying to make changes in order to make the experience even more convenient. Although it is unclear if this is effective, it is promising to see attempts to solve it. The problems that Meok-Sa-Pal faces are not exclusive, as the majority of Facebook groups KMLAians use also have them. Acknowledging and solving these problems is necessary, and Meok-Sa-Pal can definitely be the start.

KMLA's great culture of Sharing Values Revived

28th waver Jeonggyeom Kuk

Typical superheroes exist in a fictional universe. Fans adore them, although they are not real men. However, there was a real superhero in Korean history who won every battle he engaged in, which is uncommon even in fictional works. The protagonist is Yi Sun-sin, the admiral of the Chosun Navy. To commemorate his greatness, on Friday, April 28th, 2023, Yi Sun-sin's birth celebration was held outside in KMLA's Minjokguan, and history teacher Kim Tae-wan and headmaster Han Man-wi made speeches.

Kim Tae-wan, a history instructor with wide understanding, told the gathered audience more than just how great Yi Sun-sin was. While explaining why Yi Sun-sin is admired, he related the values he represents as they apply to "a true KMLAian." He compared Yi Sun-sin to King Seonjo of Chosun, who fled the battlefield and abandoned his people. Seonjo believed that civil society existed to protect him. Mr. Kim added that Yi Sun-sin was different and had deep concern for his people.

A significant portion of the upper class utilizes people to accumulate wealth and increase their influence. In fact, in 2016, the senior executive of the Ministry of Education, Na Hyang-wook, stated that a status system should be implemented and that the public is the great unwashed. Na Hyang-wook wasn't the only person who considered people tools. Numerous powerful individuals view the powerless as their tools as opposed to coexisting partners. However, Choi Myeong-jae, founder of KMLA, once stated that KMLA should not have a second Yi Wan-yong, who sold his country and people to Japan for his personal safety and wealth. This educational philosophy is also reflected in the school's motto, which reads,

"Tomorrow's bright fatherland, and a better world for all." KMLA wants Yi Sun-sin, not Yi Wan-yong, because Yi Sun-sin recognizes that social leaders exist for civil society.

The headmaster, Han Man-wi imparted to the students a second attitude that they must adopt as maturing students. He connected Yi Sun-sin's existence before he became an admiral to the film "Rebound." Rebounding is the act of catching a basketball that has missed the ring.

Therefore, rebounding signifies a second opportunity. Since Yi Sun-sin also failed his first test to become an admiral and then succeeded in his second attempt, we can say that Yi Sun-sin also "rebounded."

The ceremony was conducted immediately after all students received their midterm exam results, which caused some students to worry about their future. In fact, many anonymous writers to the 28th wavers' Facebook group have written about their despair.

What Yi Sun-sin did is also what KMLAians must do. Richard Nixon said that the finest steel must go through the hottest fire. Since authentic KMLAians must aim to become the social leaders of the future, they should also remind themselves that they must strive to be the finest iron. Therefore, adversity must be endured in order to become great leaders. And rebounding, getting second chances, and repeating challenges will put them through the most rigorous training as they prepare for bright futures in leadership.

Living as a genuine KMLAian is challenging and exhausting. During difficult periods, students will occasionally forget what they need to remember. Sharing is one of the best ways to remember what we should do.

Due to the unfortunate COVID-19 situation, only Student Council members were permitted to attend Yi Sun-sin's birthday celebration last year. But beginning in 2023, the birth celebration for all students has resumed. As seen during the ceremony previously described, Yi Sun-sin's birth celebration was not simply a commemoration of the birth of the school emblem. By traveling to the same location and experiencing the same breeze, students could better communicate their values.

Lee Seung-jae, a KMLA 28th waver, stated, "What Kim Tae-wan teacher and Han Man-wi headmaster said inspired me. They gave excellent speeches, and I decided to try again after I listened. The Culture Center's traditional Korean architecture also played a crucial role in creating the atmosphere. It seems like the whole ceremony shows me how to live as a Korean future leader." He wasn't the only one who felt the emotion.

A significant number of students who attended with low enthusiasm changed their views and stated that they experienced an unexpected shift in their perspectives. They took many stunning photographs of the Culture Center and the standing students because they adored the ambiance and the content.

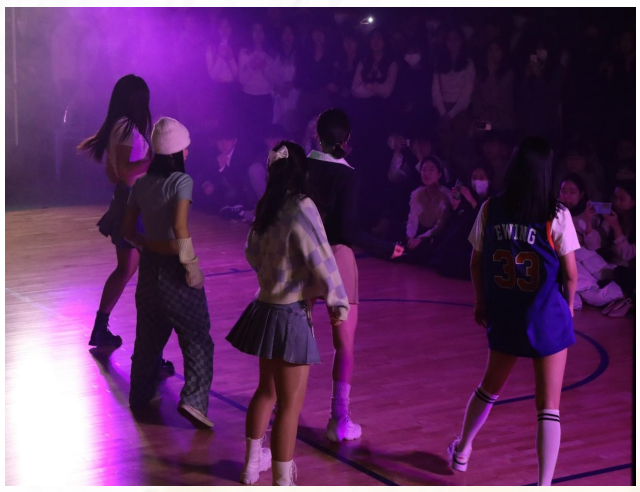
Yi Sun-sin stands before our school's gates as a towering iron statue because he exemplifies the type of students that KMLA wants to nurture. The significance of the celebration of Yi Sun-sin is that it inspires students to challenge themselves, persevere as developing individuals, and contemplate their future responsibility as future social leaders. Everything was possible because every instructor gave an excellent speech containing vital ideas, and everyone was able to gather in one location for a much-needed in-person celebration as the Korean Minjok Leadership Academy family continues to rebloom after a difficult era.

KMLA Parties:
Stop Ctrl C and Ctrl V

28th waver Daeun Song

KMLA has diverse activities that provide students with opportunities to learn, express themselves, and also to have fun. Among the favorites are annual KMLA parties which have continued for years, allowing students to release their stress from harsh student life. Here are the three main features:

1. Parties are performance-oriented.
2. Each party has a unique dress code.
3. There is a photo booth and photo time at the end of the party.



These features show up at most of the parties. The school's Executive Council and the Department of School Events Management recruit participants to stand on the stage before the party starts. The participants make an audition, and only the group that passes can stand. Accordingly, each party has its unique dress code. After the Executive Council announces it, students prepare their outfits. For example, the dress code for the 10 and 11th grade in the Graduation Party for 12th graders was "modernized hanbok" which is the uniform of KMLA. The dress code for the Welcome Party for freshmen was "formal look" such as suits and dresses.

There are photo booths at most of the parties, where students take pictures with each other to keep memories.

Though lots of students and teachers put immense effort towards planning and running parties, there are always murmurs among students that point out problems that need to be solved. Part of a party's purpose is to have fun, yet some students don't seem satisfied. According to a survey done on the KMLA Facebook group "Muk-gu-sa-gu-pal-gu", 41.4% of students are not satisfied with current KMLA parties.

The complaints stem mostly from the culture. The most mentioned reason was the performance-oriented events. It is good to have performances to encourage an active atmosphere, but having them as the main event makes some students exhausted. They also feel that the time for conversations with friends and suitable resting places is lacking.

The next most mentioned problem is student participation. Only a few students actually want to participate. This means that students lack passion towards these events and have to endure boredom, considering the party as a "time waste.". Teacher Oh Byeong-Mun, who is in charge of KMLA parties, gave his opinion in an interview. He agrees with having parties in KMLA, but emphasizes that they need changes in a better way. He said, "We need to consider what kind of party can make all students participate and enjoy."

Here are a few changes that can improve the party culture. First, change the spot. KMLA parties always take place in the school gym where they can accept all students. Also, it is easy to manage and decorate compared to other places. However, the internal structure of the gym makes repetitive events. The gym mainly consists of a big stage in front and a large area below, which means the s parties naturally become performance-oriented. The playfield of the school, the rooftop of Deokgo House, or the meeting rooms in Dasan Hall should be occasional substitutes. If there are problems with changing the place because of the number of students, maybe make these events optional instead of mandatory, and give tickets to those who want to participate.

Secondly, we should divide the spaces or make some booths. The current problem with parties is sitting through events that are not of interest to everyone. Borrowing the idea from "Minjok Festival," there can be multiple booths or divided spaces that host different events. For example, the "A Booth" is for games, "B Booth" is for talking with friends, while the "C Booth C" has drinks and food. This system will give students opportunities to choose, and spend their time more meaningfully.

Third, make places to rest for students who are looking to relax after exciting events. There are diverse types of people in KMLA. Some are very upbeat and social, using their whole energy for the party. Simultaneously, there are those who feel stressed when packed in with many people and lack the energy to stay hyped until the end. So, making a place to rest could be effective for recharging energy and joining parties in a better mood.

New themes are also necessary. A Pajama Movie Night Party was just one suggestion. A nice chance for students to watch movies together and make some memories in pajamas. Another great idea was DJ Parties, where there are rooms for different genres of music. Some suggested a talent show with recreation games, or even a food party, where every homeroom class organizes a different food and shares.

For a sustainable party culture, the most important thing is to promote unity among students. All students want to feel like they are included or at least considered. So, providing diverse places and events to accommodate students' tastes should become the key point. KMLA parties are precious raindrops in the harsh and dry bucket of KMLA life. It is necessary to think and reflect on the true purposes of parties and the needs of all students. The success of parties depends on how we plan. If we start the change, our efforts will lead to sustainable and fun parties in the very near future. Party on - everyone!

Meaning-Making in KMLA:

"All you have to do to change the world is change the way you see it."

28th waver Sangmin Lee

Have you ever been so exhausted that you felt like giving up? High school years are already confusing, and sometimes the system and atmosphere at KMLA are ruthless. Nonetheless, every student knows that "giving up" is not the solution, and it is crucial to keep going. Meaning-making, a concept popularized in the 1970s, is utilized in education and dealing with bereavement. More importantly, it can help solve all great difficulties just by changing the way we interpret life.

Goal or Fantasy? Apparently the Latter for Many

Look around at the media, or just your friends and family, and you'll hear countless accounts of people trying to get into medical school. More and more people are dropping out of university every year to take the CSAT again, aiming for medical school. One would think being in the most prestigious university in the country is a precious opportunity, but the number of students dropping out from Seoul National University is increasing.

Why are students giving up opportunities to navigate their fields of interest and instead aiming for medical school? It is no mystery; it's a "successful" job, which to many means guaranteed economic stability. While some students may genuinely be interested in the medical field, it is obvious that the number could not have increased so rapidly in a short period for simple passion. While medical school is the most pursued goal, this problem also exists within other fields such as law.

The problem is not extraneous by any means as it is happening in KMLA as well. Although the school actively encourages students to pursue their own path faithfully following the school motto that reads "Let us not study for the sake of personal gain," many come to KMLA to get good grades and aim for these fields. Since we all have so much potential, it is a tragedy to see so many of us conceding to "reality" without truly questioning the purpose of life.

Taking a deeper look into the problem, Mrs. Kim Min-Ju, our Director of College Counseling for Domestic Field, was interviewed to gain a sense of KMLA's current state.

MH: How many students in KMLA set medical school as their career path every year?

This year, I think there are about 20 students hoping to go to medical school, out of 93 domestic students.

MH: What do you think the reasons are that students choose to go to or change their paths to medical school?

Partly because students are interested in the field, partly because parents want them to go, and also because of the social atmosphere. I think these three reasons all play a role in making the students feel like they should go to medical school. However, since the school wants students to become leaders of various fields and classes, I want to see students pursue the path they truly desire.

MH: What words of advice can you give to students who think about giving up on their desired careers?

I want to tell them to experience a lot of things. This school is one the best in terms of all the experiences and opportunities it provides. That's why students should not be restricted by grades or other factors but rather try what they want. If you just follow everyone else's paths, you won't find a path of your own. During the first grade, try out everything you want. In second grade, narrow the path down and focus, and finalize your decision in third grade.

Meaning-Making: Interpret the World in Your Own Way

So, what is meaning-making, and how will it help deal with this struggle for your dream? Meaning-making is a term coined by educational critics Neil Postman and Charles Weingartner; it is the process of how people construe, understand, or make sense of life events, relationships, and the self. A study conducted by PubMed Central in 2020 showed that utilizing meaning-making during pandemic lockdowns actually provided long-term benefits for psychological adjustment. Similarly, meaning-making can help students in KMLA deal with adversities.

A major reason the problem occurs is that students, as well as adults around them, value success over passion. Taking a different view on life can help students find out what they really want to do. In the end, the ultimate goal is happiness, which is a subjective concept. Thus, it is imperative to come up with your own definition of happiness. There are many things that could make one happy; a specific job, good friends, helping others, or possibly success and fame. By doing what makes you happy and pursuing your own visions, your life will be an unregretful one.

Struggling with failure? Failure will be common in life, and it is a learning process. It is said that famous singer Psy followed a motto that encapsulates this message perfectly: "There must be a reason for the hardship. How successful am I going to be in the future?"

An excellent way to utilize meaning-making is by constantly listening for and absorbing anecdotes in a personal way. For example, teacher Yang Dong-Hyuk mentioned a story about a small boat; even if the wind and the waves interfere with the voyage, if the boat keeps its direction toward the destination instead of trying to fix every small issue, it will eventually make it. This story emphasizes the importance of keeping your eyes on your goal instead of obsessing about minor happenings. Experienced disappointment with grades? Don't be discouraged. Instead, envision what lies ahead and prepare. Your destination should not falter to what will ultimately be, in the end, just a small disturbance. Anyone can use meaning-making to overcome problems, and all that's needed is a shift in mindset.

Living as teenagers in South Korea, many feel like they are forced to give up their dreams. Without a clear vision in mind, students just follow the directions of their parents and end up blindly competing with each other. For students in KMLA, with the pressure to position themselves as future leaders, it is an important task to navigate their own fields. Meaning-making will help each individual in making it through the external pressure and negativity, providing light throughout their journey to reaching the seemingly impossible dream.

Reboot and Reinforce: EOP Zones

28th waver Seyoung Lim

What was your first impression of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy? It might have been various elective classes, club activities, or even amazing food in the cafeteria. There are many amazing traits about this school, each one of them making KMLA distinctive and unique. Among those, there is one image most acknowledged: students in hanbok while fluently exchanging English.

The tradition of using English has continued since the school was established. It has been documented into a policy of what we have always known as the "English Only Policy." To keep that spirit in mind, students recite the goal of the English Only Policy every week. However, it is currently hard to say that EOP is well-practiced. Except for a small minority of students whose English is fluent, most struggle to maintain the policy even during classes where it is expected. Teachers and students are all aware of this, but the pupils must keep EOP "perfunctorily" whenever an outsider comes to school. The spirit and the policy have long been regarded as a dead letter. To add, there is even a meme satirizing the situation.

The Department of EOP are beacons of the policy that stand for these reasons. They are in charge of promoting and activating the spirit of using English.According to a member, it even tried implementing programs such as EOP Radio.

EOP Radio consisted of casual English conversations between two Department members and sometimes radio hosts. After the five-minute talk, pop songs were played. However, broadcasted during lunchtime when most students take short naps after lunch, resulted in complaints about interrupting solitude. Also, the scripted conversations were unnatural and rigid.

This year, starting in March, the Department of EOP initiated a new policy: EOP Zones. Simply put, this intends to encourage English by making particular places EOP Zones and giving students incentives.

The policy aims to make EOP a pleasant, voluntary act in specific EOP Zones within Chungmoo Hall and Dasan Hall. Furthermore, it also aims to encourage students who were timid in using English due to peer pressure. I two or more students record their conversations in English for more than five minutes at three different times, they are given reward points. The points one can get are limited to two per week. The recording is accepted as long as it is outside the dormitory.

Here are some opinions of individual students who have experienced EOP Zones policy. First and foremost, the usage of English among students increased to some extent, especially for the 28th wavers, according to interviewees. This achievement should be strongly regarded since it was the priority of the policy. An interviewee began to use more English because she found an "excuse" to speak English while not being misunderstood as a "show off." She said that she had felt peer pressure when speaking in English since students who had lived abroad usually use it fluently. Another student said he is trying to use English habitually because of the policy and to raise his English skills. This also shows that the policy managed the second goal: encouraging students suffering from peer pressure.

In addition, an interviewee brought up an opinion that EOP Zones are the most effective out of all the other EOP promotion policies. Another student thought EOP Zones were better for motivating students than EOP Radio. Also, the policy didn't make students feel any stress because it wasn't forceful.

However, the 27th wave's opinions were not as positive. Many commonly said that the policy was not necessary. Some commented that EOP Zones are used to get reward points when desperate. One 27th waver thought activating EOP itself is better than designating particular areas. To wrap up, students' opinions vary from wave to wave. It seems that the 28th wavers show active participation since they are new to the school and therefore are more flexible in adjusting to changes.

However, some apprehensive attitudes exist. First, a hard nut to crack is that students might use the policy to avoid penalty points. This is a problem that was mentioned above as well. Although giving incentives to practice EOP is effective, there is an unavoidable task for the Department of EOP to reduce indiscreet awards. Secondly, EOP Zones don't guarantee that the policy will lead EOP to long-term development.

The usage of English might falter as soon as the reward disappears. There is a possibility that it will eventually become a vicious cycle. Thirdly, though EOP Zones are successful, they are still not well-known to everyone. Among the 28th wavers, there was wrong information that the criteria for the reward points had changed to once every three weeks. However, according to the head of the Department, no changes have been made since March. The Facebook page of the Department of EOP only has about 70 followers and is currently calling for more attention. Lastly, a student commented that students who have used English before often keep on speaking it. Students who avoid using English are not that motivated to practice the policy.

Fortunately, since these problems were long-lasting and constantly discussed, there is still hope that KMLA will find a stable solution. These policies are necessary since the situation has gone out of hand and cannot be brought back by taking bland measures. EOP represents students' efforts to make KMLA bloom with unique features. For better school culture and development, keeping the English Only Policy should be sincerely considered by students who compose the school.

The Story of KMLA:

28th waver Seoeun Yang

A roly-poly toy. An endearing toy embedded in many of our childhood memories. No matter how hard you flick it, a roly-poly bounces right back. The **Korean Minjok Leadership Academy**, otherwise known as **KMLA**, can be described as one giant roly-poly toy. And yes, while it may not possess the classic egg shape or bottom weight, it certainly has the ability to bounce back up when knocked down.

KMLA is, without a doubt, a unique school. Teachers and students wearing hanbok, studying in buildings built in the Korean traditional style, all while communicating primarily in English. However, this distinctive environment is not the only defining feature of KMLA. What truly sets it apart is its sense of community, the willingness to take risks, and the determination to overcome obstacles. But like any institution, KMLA has its imperfections and has experienced its fair share of ups and downs.

Since its doors were first opened in 1995 by founder Choi Myung Jae, the school has seen a lot of changes: from accepting female students a year after opening to having the total number of students grow to around 450. Throughout the years, KMLA has gone through many hardships but has made it through. This leads me to my question: What does the future hold for the sustainability of KMLA?

Sustainability, by definition, is the ability to be maintained at a certain rate or level. But KMLA has done more than just maintain its current situation. Diving into the rich history of this school reveals that it has bounced back from setbacks and persevered through hardships throughout the years.

One of the first major challenges came in 1996 when students started leaving the school due to the disadvantages they faced when applying to domestic universities. Still, the school persevered and made it through. How? It offered solutions such as allowing its students to graduate early, enabling domestic students to get into universities like KAIST. The school also provided AP classes for internationally bound students and much more. Today, students of KMLA can choose between the domestic and international field. However, this wasn't an option until the school offered an international field as well as a solution to this problem.

In 1998, KMLA faced another challenge when the IMF crisis hit. As a result of financial issues, Pasteur became unable to fund the school. When KMLA first opened its doors, Pasteur ensured that all students had the opportunity to attend school without the burden of tuition fees. However, when the crisis hit, this wasn't possible anymore. During this economic crisis, not only did teachers announce that they would willingly stay at the school without pay, but students pledged to stay at KMLA as well. Members of the KMLA family marched and protested through the streets of Seoul to make sure the doors of KMLA would stay open.

A recent hardship was when the previous government under Moon Jae In announced that autonomous private high schools, like KMLA, would be forcefully turned into public high schools by the year 2025. This threatened the school's unique curriculum and traditions. This change would undoubtedly cause KMLA to lose its identity. However, members of the KMLA family have joined hands to prevent the change and are currently searching for ways to preserve the school's unique identity.

KMLA has been able to navigate its ups and downs by effectively using its strengths. As expressed by Mr. Eom, an English teacher at KMLA since 1995, KMLA, as a whole, takes risks and isn't afraid to challenge itself. The school has a history of pushing boundaries and attempting new approaches, often venturing into uncharted territories. In addition, unity is a strength KMLA possesses. KMLA students, teachers, faculty, and parents work together as members of the KMLA family to solve problems and hardships they face. Furthermore, KMLA always focuses on the future. It learns from the past and uses past mistakes as stepping stones to build the way to the future.

So, about the sustainability of KMLA? Mr. Eom expressed confidence in a bright and enduring future. As long as KMLA continues to harness its ambition, embrace challenges, and foster unity, it is likely to remain a vibrant and successful institution, overcoming difficulties and forging ahead with its unique educational journey. The story of KMLA will continue on.

How Long Will It Last?

A Double Edged Sword: CHATGPT

27th waver Sewoong Park

On April 20, 2023, Yokosuka became the first city to use ChatGPT for administrative work. ChatGPT is estimated to have reached 100 million monthly active users back in January, just two months after its launch; it took TikTok about nine months and Instagram about two years to hit that mark. Owing to its versatile applications in various fields and its ability to articulate intricate answers to complex questions, ChatGPT has garnered a widespread fanbase, acting as a game-changer in countless sectors. However, ChatGPT poses some pressing troubles and risks, especially for students using it for academic purposes. This editorial will examine both sides of the coin and offer solutions on how to use ChatGPT responsibly and ethically, particularly for students.

ChatGPT has several benefits for students who require academic assistance or support. As a substitute for tutors, ChatGPT can provide motivation and guidance, offering students relevant information, examples, feedback, suggestions, and explanations that can enhance their understanding and performance. ChatGPT is extremely useful in helping with homework by providing hints or answering questions. It can also assist research by summarizing articles, finding sources, synthesizing information, or generating citations. When debugging code, it can offer clarification, identify errors, or suggest solutions. For writing tasks, it can generate outlines, introductions, conclusions, or paragraphs based on prompts or keywords. For language learning, it can translate words or sentences, teach grammar or vocabulary, or engage in conversation in the target language.

Moreover, ChatGPT can inspire students to expand their learning and discover new subjects that pique their interest. It can engage students by providing them with informative and captivating answers on a diverse range of topics, challenge students' perspectives by presenting alternative viewpoints or arguments that may encourage them to reconsider their opinions or beliefs, and urge students to nvestigate further by sharing relevant links or references that may direct them to additional sources of information.

Lastly, ChatGPT can improve students' creative abilities and self-expression by offering diverse forms of creative content. Based on the user's input or prompts, ChatGPT can create innovative content that may trigger students' imagination and creativity and provide feedback or recommendations on how students can enhance or refine their self-generated content. By presenting various examples or templates of different genres or communication formats, it can also assist students in expressing themselves in distinct ways or styles of writing.

On the other hand, ChatGPT can also mislead students with inaccurate or fallacious information that may negatively affect their learning or understanding. Before the March 2023 plugin update, ChatGPT was not exactly a reliable source of information, as it based responses on patterns rather than evidence and was unable to cite its sources. Even as of now, it sometimes generates responses that are inconsistent, contradictory, or irrelevant to the user's query.

ChatGPT may also exhibit biases in the training data it has received, which can result in inappropriate responses that reflect existing social, cultural, or political preferences. Although most sensitive preferential questions are censored, its biases are occasionally shown indirectly in its answers. Experts evaluate it to have a “liberal progressive” tendency. Despite, or thanks to, the harsh criticism on the quality of response ChatGPT provides, there have been several updates specifically targeting these problems: most notably, the web-browsing feature to combat its original limitation of being ignorant of events after 2021 and incapable of going in-depth on certain fields. Now, ChatGPT is able to provide more detailed supported responses based on diverse sources on the internet.

ChatGPT can also discourage critical thinking and independent inquiry by providing students with ready-made answers that may not require further analysis or evaluation. It may make students lazy or complacent by giving them the illusion of knowledge or understanding without requiring them to engage in deeper learning processes. It may also inhibit students' creativity and originality by providing them with generic or clichéd responses that may not reflect their voice or style and prevent students from developing their own opinions or perspectives by providing them with predetermined answers that may not challenge them to think for themselves.

ChatGPT can also foster plagiarism and cheating by providing students with content they can copy or use without proper attribution or acknowledgment. It may tempt students to use its content as their work without giving credit to the source or author. ChatGPT may also enable students to bypass academic integrity policies or standards by providing them with content that may not be easily detected by plagiarism detection software or tools. ChatGPT may also undermine students' academic performance and learning outcomes by providing them with content that may not meet the expectations or requirements of their instructors or assignments.

Students should use ChatGPT responsibly and ethically, and always verify, question, evaluate, and acknowledge its responses with their sources, reasoning, judgment, and voice. ChatGPT is a powerful and versatile tool for students, but it also comes with potential risks and challenges that need to be properly addressed and managed. Students should not blindly trust ChatGPT or rely on it as a substitute for critical thinking and independent inquiry. They should also not use ChatGPT as a means to plagiarize or cheat and should produce work that reflects their effort and learning.

Used correctly, it can be a helpful and inspiring tool for students who need guidance or assistance with their academic tasks. Which path will you choose?

Bridging the Medical Divide:
Empowering KMLA Students to Overcome Rural Healthcare Inequalities

27th waver Yena Lee

Medical faculty distribution inequalities have become increasingly severe in South Korea, particularly in the remote areas of Gangwon Province, where KMLA is located. While metropolitan areas are oversaturated with health services, rural areas lack adequate access to medical facilities. According to a report by the Ministry of Health and Welfare, Hoengseong, the closest city to where KMLA students reside, is identified as an emergency-vulnerable region. With the growing elderly population, the importance and necessity of medical and healthcare facilities is escalating. It is evident that students at KMLA have to endure long drives to reach the nearest emergency room at "Hoengseong Daesung Hospital," which lacks pediatric professionals. Let's explore the medical vulnerabilities faced by KMLA students and our neighbors, as well as the actions being taken in Hoengseong.

According to the 2020 Korea Sustainability Report, South Korea's health worker density is continuously increasing. Additionally, the country has made remarkable progress in medical technology, leading to a consistent growth in the medical device market. When considering the regional disparity in the number of doctors per 1000 people, Seoul and its surrounding metropolis have 4.51 doctors, while Gangwon Province, home to KMLA, has only 2.61 doctors per 1000 people. In Seoul, there are a total of 32 hospital rooms of varying sizes per 1000 people, whereas in Gangwon-do, there are only 5. This significant regional gap contradicts the current growth index of health worker density in South Korea. Consequently, it is evident that the issue lies not only in how to "develop" medical services but also in how to "distribute" them. The inequality in the number of medical facilities is glaringly apparent.

In Gangwon Province, it takes an average minimum of 35 to 45 minutes to reach a specialized medical center. As a result, some patients are at risk of severe health loss, or even death, if they are delayed beyond repair. KMLA is situated in an inland, heavily forested area, making it challenging to address emergency situations through local hospitals due to the region's geographical conditions. Most local hospitals lack pediatric doctors, forcing students to seek medical care elsewhere. The school nurse emphasizes that this vicious cycle of doctor shortage will continue since doctors are unlikely to relocate to Hoengseong or other rural areas, including public health centers and medical facilities. Consequently, the scarcity of doctors ultimately creates a blind spot in medical care. However, it's crucial to remember that time does not wait for emergency patients. Thus, KMLA students have no choice but to learn how to provide their fellow students with crucial actions to potentially give the essential extra time to live if a critical accident were to occur. Almost being in a medical blind spot, KMLA entrusts every student with the responsibility of being fully trained in first aid.

For instance, a student once bumped her head on a sharp corner while fainting, resulting in a vivid memory of blood scattered around her unconscious body. The bunk beds in the dormitory pose a fall risk due to steep stairs, making head trauma a constant danger. Here are the step-by-step first aid measures to address such incidents:

1. Keep the person still: The injured person should lie down with the head and shoulders slightly elevated. Avoid moving the person, especially the neck. Do not remove any protective gear like helmets.

2. Stop any bleeding: Apply firm pressure to the wound using sanitized gauze or a cloth. However, do not apply direct pressure to the wound if a skull fracture is suspected.

3. Perform CPR if there are no signs of circulation, such as breathing, coughing, or movement.

4. Sometimes, there may not be any visible bleeding despite a severe head trauma. However, students should not exclude the possibility of internal bleeding. Precise first aid, along with calling emergency services (119) and notifying the dorm parents, should be carried out promptly to prevent further damage.

Additionally, students should also be aware of first aid measures to deal with electric shocks, as they use various electronic devices at KMLA. Degraded electric wires or touching electronic devices with damp hands can lead to electric shocks, which can cause fatal organ damage due to the high voltage (220V or more than 600V) in household alternating currents. Here's how to respond to such situations:

1. Ensure personal safety: Move away from the source of the shock and check the surroundings for potential additional electronic hazards.

2. Turn off any other electronic devices.

3. Call emergency services (119).

4. Elevate the patient's legs 20-30cm from the ground to prevent further electric shocks.

5. Wrap the burnt area with a dry and clean cloth.
(*Disclaimer: If the patient is not breathing, perform CPR.)

While these steps may seem simple, people often become confused in unexpected situations, increasing the likelihood of making mistakes. Therefore, repetitive first aid education is necessary, and the school should make first aid certification compulsory for every student and faculty. According to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, individuals who received CPR as a first aid measure had approximately 3.58 times higher chances of saving a patient's life compared to those who did not receive any emergency intervention. This highlights the significance of first aid in saving lives when time is of the essence. KMLA is a close-knit community situated in a medical blind spot. Once again, it is the responsibility of every student and staff to help and save others during emergency situations. This is how we can ensure that none of the KMLA family members fall victim to medical inequality and how we can confront and overcome the challenges posed by medical disparities.

Is KMLA a Democratic Society?

A Measure of the School's Democracy Index

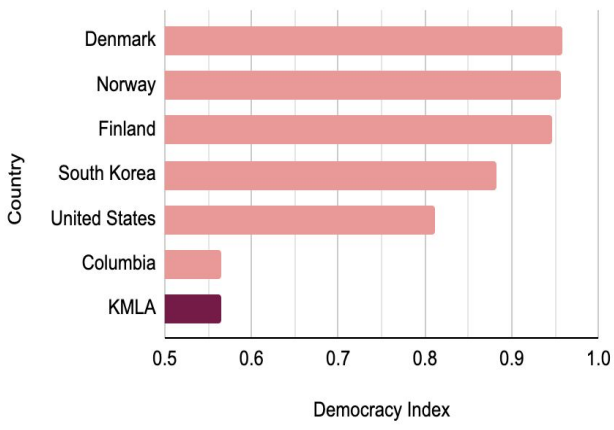
26th waver Chaehyeon Moon

KMLA prides itself in its intricate three-branch student council system.

The structure of the student council was adapted from the three-branch system of modern democratic governments: the executive branch oversees most day-to-day student affairs; the judicial branch conducts student courts where students get a chance to defend themselves from falsely accused wrongdoings and avoid the consequential penalty points; the legislative branch creates, debates, amends, and passes—on a student level before the matter is passed onto the teachers—school rules.

This political structure is undoubtedly one of the most faithful adaptations of modern-day democratic regimes. From a certain viewpoint, it may even be regarded as a better mechanism of bringing ideal democracy to life than modern-day governments, as judicial branches and bureaucrats which would normally be appointed are elected positions in KMLA.

However, amidst all the elections and student bureaucrats, a fundamental question arises: Is KMLA a democratic society?
Does the complicated design of the political structure actually help the students learn about and practice democracy in school? Minjok Herald took a closer look to assess our school's political culture using the democracy index.



KMLA's Democracy Index lies at 0.566

KMLA's Democracy Index was measured at 0.566, equal to that of Colombia—a hybrid regime that was ranked 84th out of 176 countries in terms of the state of democracy. Freedom House, a non-profit organization known for its political advocacy surrounding issues of democracy, has described Colombia as "among the longest-standing democracies in Latin America, but one with a history of widespread violence and serious human rights abuses." While KMLA has no place for widespread violence or serious human rights abuses, its nature as a school and not a state—and thus the necessary authorities accorded to the teachers that come with certain limitations on the autonomous power of the student government has placed KMLA shoulder to shoulder with a hybrid regime (a political regime that mixes democratic and autocratic features) in terms of the state of democracy.

Meanwhile, South Korea lies in 20th place with a democracy index of 0.883 and the country ranked 1st is Denmark with a striking 0.958.

What is to be improved in KMLA?

Considering KMLA's identity as a school, it matters more what aspect of democracy KMLA lacks rather than where KMLA stands among other states. Overall, KMLA's democracy was found to be very strong in the first category (Electoral Process and Pluralism), with all 10 indicators pointing to 1.

The categories that KMLA most struggled with were the second, which measured the functioning of government and the fifth, which measured civil liberties. Some indicators that KMLA scored low on were:

14. Is the legislature the supreme political body, with a clear supremacy over other branches of government?

:: No (0), KMLA's legislative body—the Assembly of Representatives—which consists of the Legislative Council and 30 Representatives from each class, is not the supreme political body. The votes made at the assembly are nonbinding, and even the system of direct voting in KMLA (instead of legislative members representing their people's interests) is taken into consideration, the vote is merely a plebiscite and not a referendum. In other words, the votes by students on school issues are nonbinding.

Democracy Index*

The Democracy Index is an index of the degree of democracy of a country based on 60 indicators of 5 categories. For each of the 60 indicators, either 1 (democratic), 0 (not democratic), or 0.5 (somewhere in between) is given. The numbers are averaged altogether to produce the index, which ranges from 0 to 1. The democracy index is measured every year by The Economist in an attempt to measure the state of democracy in 167 countries and territories. Minjok Herald has made necessary adaptations (that is, took out the immeasurable questions and modified some others in consideration of KMLA being a school and not a state) to measure the state of democracy of the Korean Minjok Leadership Academy. Each indicator score was determined either by a panel of journalists at Minjok Herald or by surveys answered by 23 KMLA students.

15. Is there an effective system of checks and balances on the exercise of government authority?

:: Yes, but there are some serious flaws (0.5). There is no system of checks and balances between the branches of government in place, and the Executive Council holds substantial authority over school matters compared to the other two branches. There is, however, frequent checking of student government authority by KMLA students who actively voice their opinions regarding government performance. The balance of students' opinions on the level of confidence towards the student government performance (35% quite a lot of confidence, 35% neutral, 25% no confidence or absolute distrust) also contributes to the checking of power by students.

24. Popular perceptions of the extent to which they have free choice and control over their life

:: Moderate (0.5), which is if 50-70% of people think that they have a great deal of choice/control. According to the survey conducted by Minjok Herald, 36% of students responded 'no' and 64% 'yes'. An anonymous student responded that the reason for choosing 'no' was because of the "teachers that disapprove of girls wearing pants under school uniform skirts for the sole reason of 'untidiness.'"

While it is natural for students to have limited control over their lives in some aspects, again, considering KMLA's nature as a dorm school, some students have expressed their discomfort with regulations that attempt to direct every aspect of their lives—even by going as far as banning pants under skirts students wear for practical (warmth, protection against bugs/plantation, and so on) reasons.

25. Public confidence in government

:: Moderate (0.5). The Economist's standards allocate a score of 0.5 if the % of people who have a "great deal" or "quite a lot" of confidence in government is 25-40%. 35% of KMLA students responded to having such an amount of confidence.

The measure of the Democracy Index shows that as much as KMLA prides itself in its student government system, and while the system goes to great lengths to protect ideas of democracy within the school in some aspects, there are still areas for the school community to address and enhance. By focusing on strengthening the functioning of government promoting student liberties, and ensuring checks and balances, KMLA would further its commitment to fostering a truly democratic environment for its students.

The Candlelight Spirit of KMLA: Does it Still Exist?

26th waver Jimin Ha

Various facilities, such as the futsal stadium adjacent to our dorm, the gazebo in front of the Culture Center, and specific scholarships provided by KMLA, have been made possible through financial aid from Gangwon-do and Hoengseong. Additionally, every KMLA member has received emergency coronavirus relief funds on multiple occasions. The unique location of KMLA greatly benefits from the generous support of the Gangwon local government, Gangwon-do Office of Education, and Hoengseong-gun. Undoubtedly, every student can readily cite examples of this support. Moreover, this support extends beyond financial assistance; it encompasses the pride and hospitality that the community exhibits towards KMLA students. For instance, when we visit a restaurant in Hoengseong, we are warmly greeted with compliments praising KMLA. The local community holds deep affection for our school and takes pride in our presence.

Interestingly, there exists a contrast between the perspectives of the local community and KMLA students. Usually, KMLA students don't think of Hoengseong as their home and lots of them have never even been to the area outside of school in Hoengseong. The point is that we are not interested in what is going on in the local areas. And thus the fundamental question is, "Is it okay to be at a distance from the local community's issue, and to ignore the school motto that we should dedicate ourselves to it like a candle?" and " Can a KMLA student be a real KMLA student amongst the disconnection from the local community and lack of candlelight spirit?"

If someone asks our students to choose between the life of the rich and easygoing, and life that's lacking but sharing, more than half will choose the former. Society is becoming more and more materialistic and meritocratic, so the students' values and standards are, naturally, being adjusted to this society's expectations. Thus I wondered about the existence of the candlelight spirit that sacrifices itself for the development of the greater. And also wondered if this extreme indifference to the local community just occurred as a sudden change or if there are some triggers to cut off the linking between the community. To get some information about past generations of KMLA, Minjok Herald reached out to 20th waver Byungjoon Eric Yoo, who spent a month in May with the current KMLA students as part of his teacher training, about the atmosphere of community dedication in the 20th wave.

The main question that Minjok Herald asked him was "Do you think there is a visible change in the students' mental attitude or school toward social interaction?" And he provided some specific experiences and his thoughts about the matter. He said he couldn't evaluate students' thoughts and responsibility toward the society and local community, and he doesn't know how students thought about it in his time. However, he said he recognized the decreased chance to interact with the local community. According to his answers, before the covid pandemic, there were a lot of clubs or students going out to do some volunteer services inside Hoengseong. For example, the Korean medicine club Dongyibogam went to the senior citizens' center to check their health and entertain them, some clubs went to the elementary school nearby KMLA and taught the students, and joined the festival held in Hoengseong for performance. He said it is sad that the official connections, which the school provides students for volunteering in community service, are all gone after covid pandemic.

Not only in the field of local volunteer work, but this change has also happened to students in choosing their major. One day, read the quote saying "It is medical, dental, oriental medicine, medicine, or veterinary school that goes round and round anyway" from the cover of Hankyung Business magazine. Students who have a candlelight spirit would be sad and upset with this that they were telling us those majors are the only answer for high school students like us. These days, people usually think a job that makes a lot of money is the point of choosing a major, and consideration of social dedication and a student's personal interests are excluded in decision-making. Mr. Yoo said 60 out of 90 domestic students in the 20th wave applied to medical school. While the number itself does not reflect anything bad, it is important to choose to become a doctor with firmly-held beliefs. And the belief that KMLA wants to inculcate to students is not to go to Africa and sacrifice everything to help others, but to become SOME kind of doctor, or lawyer that helps the people who really need their technical help. He added to keep in mind not to differentiate social responsibility and personal ambitions, but to make harmony with both and to make dedications in society with your job and interest.

During the interview, Mr. Yoo shared his experience from when went to the Deokcheon Branch School to teach the students there and play with them. There were only 6 students and they were the ones who were unable to go to the elementary school because of the distance between their home and the Deokcheon elementary school. After a few kids there got their smartphones with the financial support of the state, they did research on KMLA to find out what kind of school Mr. Yoo was going to. The internet sites like Youtube introduced KMLA as a prestigious school that only smart kids can enter, and the kids there told Mr. Yoo, "If we work hard on our studies, maybe one day we could be KMLA students too." However, once they heard about KMLA's tuition fee, they told him, "I think my family will not be able to handle this amount of tuition fee even if I managed to get into KMLA." Mr. Yoo said he was ashamed that he couldn't say anything to them, and was aware of the irrational education system in Korea. Finally, he explained that his experience at Deokcheon branch school was one of the major reasons why he chose to major in education.

With the rise of mandatory community service hours in high schools, students only seek volunteer work that would look fancy on their resumes. KMLA should reorganize the local interaction programs like pre-covid generations of KMLA did or even more to encourage the students to contribute to the local community. If we construct the systems right, mandated community service in KMLA could help people get involved at an early age. It could make an entire generation that sees the benefits of giving back. It can genuinely find enrichment in donating their time and effort to selfless causes and finding out what they can do for society after graduation.

What distinguishes KMLA from other prestigious high schools is its focus on developing individuals into leaders who dedicate themselves to the advancement of their respective fields, embodying the spirit of a burning candle. The accomplishments of our alumni can be attributed to their belief that they will make a difference with their skills, not just for personal success, but also for societal betterment. **What kind of alumni do you aspire to be?**

LGBTQ Pride in KMLA

26th waver Seoyoung Jeon

Earlier this semester, the Minjok Herald began the process of furthering our theme of “rebloom” in order to better serve the school with a responsible and creative news outlet. To that end, members perused old editions to gather ideas, consider new directions, and of course witness how far KMLA has come. In the 7th edition, published on June 9th of 2000, one of the longest “articles,” written by a male freshman and published on the last page, caught our attention:

“Gay Teens in KMLA - SHOCKING!!”

The first paragraph proceeded as such: “Gay teens in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy, the most prestigious school in Korea? Many people will be shocked at such a statement, but… Nothing is perfect, and I am not worried this will damage the school’s reputation. Plus, between you and I, this story is true, but it has nothing to do with homosexuals.”

This article also talks about “sexual orientation and gender identity(SOGI)” but has nothing to do with sexual immoralities. It is trying to pull out the disregarded discussions to the surface to shape a healthier KMLA community.

Sexuality is a staple of popular culture. Whether it is a romantic comedy, a pop song, or an advertisement for shoes, the media typically portrays sexual relationships in a clichéd and idealized way that caters to heterosexual “norms.” In Korea, where we are surrounded by sexual connotations in popular culture, many of us are largely oblivious to the influences of sexuality in our lives. Even when SOGI is ambitiously examined and openly explored, it still remains in a cloud of embarrassment that is hesitant to share itself outside of closed circles. Combined with the Confucianist culture that abstains from expressing sexuality, Korean society generally considers discussions of gender and sexuality as taboo, or at least “unnecessary.” Last year, the mayor of Seoul commented that Pride Parades degrade the “fine customs” of the city. This hostile attitude towards LGBTQ is reflected by this year’s decision of Seoul City to ban the Pride Parade from being held at Seoul Square. While we may not have “book bans” against LGBTQ themes in public libraries like in Florida, we are still miles behind Western cultures' ability to at least discuss SOGI diversity in classroom environments. So, where does KMLA, as a school that prides itself in providing the most innovative education in Korea, sit in this spectrum of sexual education and diversity inclusion?

The answer is: ahead of most schools in Korea, but nowhere close to the levels of high schools in other modern nations, whose students KMLAians often compete against to enter the world’s top liberal arts colleges. The question we can take from this is - does KMLA prepare students for the open-mindedness encouraged by world-class institutions? This does not necessarily limit itself to sexuality or LGBTQ itself, but it is clear that this is our least explored area of proactive discussion concerning societal issues that impact us all. Simply put, our school culture is at most “unconcerned” about LGBTQ issues, and the students who may be affected by this lack of consideration.

What many students love the most about KMLA is that this school accepts a diversity of thoughts. Our community gives opportunities to students with distinctive interests to express their opinions. We learn that the community is ready to hear diverse voices and doesn’t look down on someone because they may possess “unpopular” perspectives. Some students may not agree with this, but we have to consider KMLA’s environment which is markedly flexible compared to the vast majority of other Korean high schools. Nevertheless, let us admit that mutual respect for a variety of ideas is not evenly applied to embracing minorities. In the ironic society of KMLA, there are ‘diverse” intelligent students; but economic, racial, and sexual diversity is, at first glance, mostly absent on the surface, and it results in our hegemony resting on privileged perspectives. The KMLA society is prone to adopting the majority's views and doesn’t always succeed, or at least have the proclivity, to consider those outside its range of initial awareness.

All schools in all parts of the world will have a school motto, a school rule book, and a set of values they claim to represent. They will also set boundaries on what they deem acceptable or unacceptable. While a Catholic school might forbid a rainbow flag during the month of June, a charter school in Manhattan might fly it right next to the national flag. Some students take a hard stance against slurs. Others may overlook them. What is KMLA’s approach to LGBTQ - if we can claim to even have one?

Whatever the cause, students who do not identify as “cisgender” or “heterosexual” do not feel like their concerns are welcome in our community. The school atmosphere is generally not open to discussing sexual orientation or gender identity, even in the context of classroom materials that may touch upon it through literature or politics. Is it truly possible to study “The Picture of Dorian Gray” by Oscar Wilde without touching upon his sexuality? How would students react to such a lesson?

Some teachers have mentioned that in previous years, there were seniors who openly came out, and some waves have been far more comfortable than others with the existence and inclusion of students who do not hide their colors. In the past, there was also more active discussion on these topics. There was even a student club that was made for advocating LGBTQ+ students, which seemingly faded from continuity during the pandemic. The name of the club is ‘Voices of Queers,’ and its Facebook page can still be found with a surprising showing of public support from KMLA students of the past. I wondered what effect it had on the KMLA community when it existed. Here is an interview with an anonymous alumnus who was one of the founding members of the VoQ.

MH: What was the background and purpose for starting ‘Voices of Queers?’

The start of VoQ was very impulsive. I felt frustrated that there was not enough discussion about sexual orientation and gender identity, so I opened the Facebook page and then started to gather members. It began as one person, but we could work like the other school clubs after each member started to join, one by one. But we didn’t report it as an official club since we had to record membership names for the official club enrollment, which accompanied the danger of an outing. We were an unofficial club that provided a safe space and a place for solidarity with LGBTQ+ and their allies. The wider purpose was to reinforce LGBTQ+ awareness and representation at KMLA.

MH: What were the main activities of VoQ? Aside from posting various articles on the page, what other activities did VoQ engage in? And what was the response of the students to VoQ's activities?

In addition to posting articles on the page, VoQ also engaged in activities such as organizing meetings among members to promote solidarity and friendship. While the primary goal was to improve awareness within KMLA, it was also important for members to feel a sense of belonging and support each other. I also remember surveying awareness of LGBTQ on campus. Due to privacy reasons, I couldn't provide detailed information, but that was when I could gauge the students' reactions the most. There were various responses, and while there were instances of hateful comments, I also remember receiving a lot of warm words of encouragement.

At its peak in terms of membership, we even operated a booth at the SQCF (Seoul Queer Culture Festival). Some members were in charge of the administrative aspects of setting up the booth, while others were responsible for designing small items like postcards. I recall working together to open and manage the Seoul Queer Parade booth with other like-minded individuals outside of the school. It must have been a meaningful day for many people to come together with a shared purpose.

MH: What was the attitude and atmosphere among the school and students regarding discussions related to queers while you were attending?

In reality, most individuals who publicly came out did so after graduating, often on social media. However, I do recall instances where discussions about LGBTQ took place during class time or among friends when someone publicly came out. During the summer semester of 2017, I requested establishing a class on Gender and Society, which frequently involved discussions on queers. The school's response was not particularly favorable, as the teacher who oversaw VoQ at the time mentioned that they had received a warning about VoQ activities from someone from the school administration. Although some students adopted a dismissive attitude, I don't recall a widespread reluctance to discuss the topic.

MH: Do you consider KMLA to be an inclusive environment for LGBTQ+?

It would be difficult to say that it is an inclusive environment. During my time at KMLA, the structural environment did not consider LGBTQ+ students. Starting from the binary gender-based dormitories and uniform policies, the school did not acknowledge the existence of LGBTQ. Regarding the uniform policy, I remember that after I graduated, there were activities within the school advocating for changing the uniform, and there were discussions about allowing assigned female students to wear pants for safety reasons. However, I'm not sure about the current situation.

In terms of the social environment among KMLA students, it wasn't significantly different from general Korean society. There were instances of students openly expressing hatred towards LGBTQ, and there was a tendency to avoid discussions. However, if there is a difference between when I was there and now, it would be that thanks to the courageous students who spoke up, there were at least some discussions and a certain level of visibility, whether positive or negative.

I think KMLA is better than general Korean society in terms of allowing individuals to express their individuality, but it falls short of being an environment where LGBTQ students feel welcomed. However, when I was there, there were quite a few discussions on gender and sexuality among students, and it was an environment where individuals could exist to some extent in the way they wanted. So I don't want to talk about it only in a negative light!

MH: If you have any message you would like to convey to LGBTQ+ students within the school, please share.

To all LGBTQ+ students living diligently in the challenging environment of KMLA, I want to say that you deserve love and are truly valuable, no matter where or how you exist. Even if it may be challenging now, I truly believe that there will be better days ahead, so let's stay strong together. You will all walk different paths, and I sincerely support you, no matter which path you choose to take.

As the alumnus said, KMLA is still lacking in the representation of LGBTQ+ students and embracing them. From an optimistic perspective, the diversity and inclusion within the campus would improve along with the receptive attitude of the emerging generation. On the other hand, augmenting competitiveness between individuals and fragmented student voices may indicate that it is far from achieving an environment for everyone. Although each opinion may differ on the current level of diversity inclusion on campus, it is evident that inclusiveness decides a sense of belonging. Especially, SOGI diversity is not perceptible from a glance, requiring intricate support for their rights. To enrich and unite the KMLA family in the era of “rebloom”, the productive discussion on minorities should be recognized in its importance.

A Contemplation on the Penalty Point System

Written by a former Judicial Council Vice President whom you might love to hate, or hate to love.

26th waver Doyeon Kwak

Before the discussion on whether the school should adjust, either to raise or lower, the standard of charging penalty points comes to the table, the goal of the system shall be addressed. The provision of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy's *School Regulation* begins with such sentence: "This regulation book contains the rules on KMLA students' school life which enables it to be autonomous, and the purpose of these regulations is to cultivate law-abiding spirit, self-management ability, high morality, and upright values that are necessary for the students to grow into leaders of all walks of life."

As the number of articles on the topic published in the Minjok Herald proves, disputes over KMLA's penalty point system have been a chronic issue ever since the first student court was held in 1998. After passing through the phases of the "Student Guidance Department'' and the "Honorary Council," in 2006, the first Judicial Council was finally established and the 35th Judicial Council is now in office. During the tenure of the 34th Judicial Council, 15 court sessions were held, 42 final defending speeches were submitted and investigated, 96 petit juries participated in sentencing, and 2,372 defendants in 4,164 cases were sentenced.

The penalty point system is not merely a matter of numbers on a spreadsheet indicating who violated what article written on the *School Regulation*. Nor is it simply a little bit of cumbersome work of attending the student court conducted from 7 P.M. on every Thursday evening.

For many students, it is a matter of whether they can spend their spare time freely or on cleaning teachers' offices or doing part-time work for monthly Chicken Day.

It is a matter of securing potential survival in this rather arduous school. Annually, there are cases of students making the difficult decision to file for a year's leave of absence in order to hold on to their mental and physical health when the bottomless well of penalty points becomes too deep.

Besides expulsion for 80 penalty points, there are other punishments for getting more than 20, 40, or 60, resulting in "special training," which serves as a time for introspection on how to avoid committing repeat violations. Other consequences from heavy penalty points might include community service, exemption from scholarship recommendations, disqualifications from student council candidate registration, or suspension for a day. Accordingly, when the Division of Student Affairs announces that they are going to wind up the penalty point list, panic arises on a number of students' faces, which was the case for 73 students, or 16% of the total students, last June. Soon they appear during lunch time not at the cafeteria, but at teachers' offices, wiping the dust off of whiteboards or organizing bookshelves.

The complaint that this penalty system needs rectification arises often, ironically from both the students who are on the verge of getting punished for their penalty points and the students who have a negative number on the penalty point dashboard, meaning that their merit points exceed penalty points. The former group of students criticizes that the system is like "One mistake and you're toast" as they think teachers easily accuse them with heavy penalty points for petty infractions, while the merit points to prevent punishments are given too frugally. The latter group accuses that the action of offsetting penalty points by earning merit points makes a fool out of the students who sincerely try not to violate rules and does not achieve the initial purpose of the whole system written in the provision of the *School Regulation*.

Likewise, KMLA has the identity of a judicial institution for a society made up of over five hundred people. However, the perception that this is the fundamental identity of KMLA is the tail wagging the dog. KMLA essentially is an education institute. Therefore, simultaneously as students have the right to lead independent lives with basic rights preserved, the teachers are given the duty to guide students to become mature citizens of this society, the society, and the world, and someday a leader with sincerity.

The word “accepted” on the KMLA website that every student had seen in January of the year they entered KMLA was consent from the school for the student to become a member of this society, and the commitment of enrollment that all students and parents signed was a contract: A social contract that they would willingly hand over part of their rights to the school to achieve goals of becoming a person with advanced intelligence, health, and most importantly, virtue.

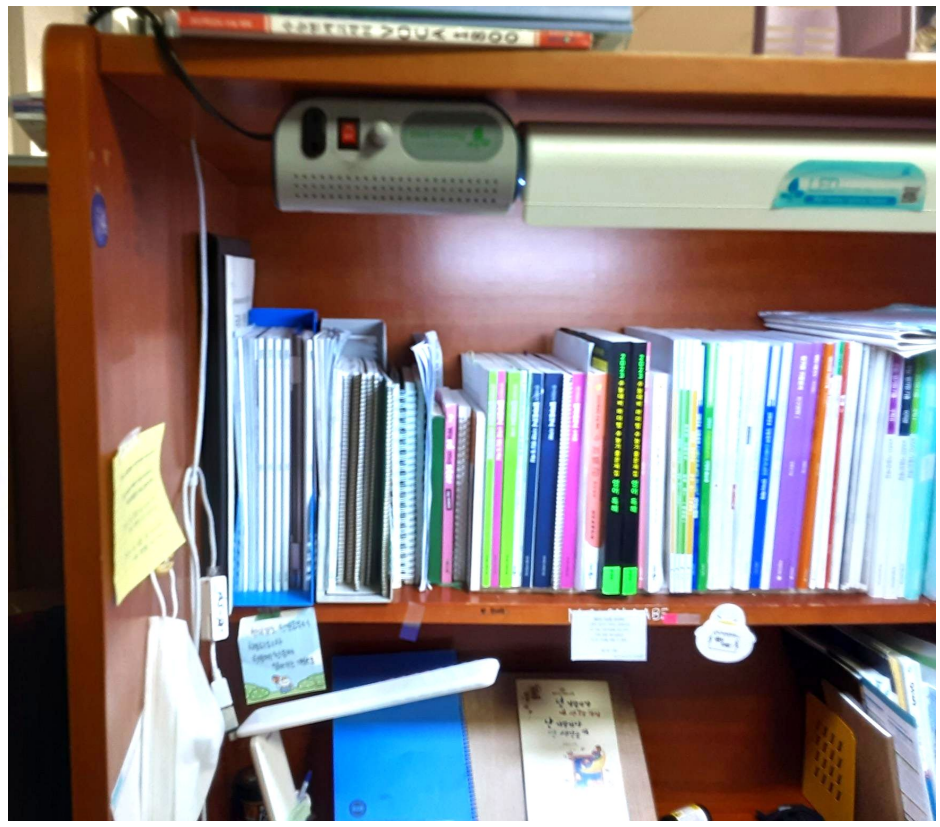
The effectiveness of the system cannot be entirely denied as it does evoke extrinsic motivation for students to abide by the rules and secure public order. For example, how many students would be so glad to raise their exhausted bodies from bed and rush outside to attend the morning exercise if it were not for the threat of 3 penalty points for being absent? It is also an efficient method to keep 450 students in some discipline, which is a number that about 70 teachers cannot handle one by one if it were not for the simplicity of entering the penalty points on a computer. Thus, abolishing the whole system would be unnecessary. However, for the student who lies back in the auditorium chair during student court as he muses over how boring it is, or for the student who lashes out to the Department of Student Guidance to assert that they have mistakenly charged her with 3 penalty points for being late to school when she knows she was in fact late, or for the student who impolitely asks a teacher to give him merit points - this system reflects a lack of educational effect via penalty points. The discussion that is needed is not on lowering or raising the bar of penalty points, but on what solution could make up for the deficiency of the system.

Students’ perception that the articles that accusations are based on are ridiculous could be taken care of by the Legislative Council’s greater effort to enhance the degree of democracy. The evaluation that penalty points are given in an irrational context could be modified through Judicial Council adopting greater judicial activism. Most importantly, the criticism that penalty points are abused, inconsistently given, and educationally ineffective could be resolved by teachers’ greater intervention, such as coming to a uniformed standard for penalty points and merit points after discussions between teachers and privately counseling the students who commit repeated violations.

“The matter of the penalty point system cannot be simply resolved through any single branch’s effort,” said the president of the 20th Judicial Council, Byung-jun Oh. The penalty system might seem so stagnant while all the other tides of reality are rapidly fluctuating. However, it indeed has come through numerous alterations. Since the student court system was introduced in 1998 by the 3rd Student Guidance Department, the 14th Honorary Council in 2005 had implemented a probation policy. The final defending speech policy that rescued countless students from unjust indictments did not exist until the first Judicial Council in 2006. The 11th Judicial Council in 2011 implemented jury trials. The 34th Judicial Council temporarily operated a policy in which merit points are given to students as an incentive to not commit violations, with cooperation with the Legislative Council and the Division of Student Affairs. Through all these trials and errors, KMLA expanded the means for students to exercise their rights and became fairer. As the ruthless world with stricter laws and heftier punishments awaits outside the barrier of the school, dearest students, take advantage of this moment to learn how to abide by the *ethical minimum* and simultaneously *struggle for law*.

What Age 19 Means to You: Life of "K-Gosam"

26th waver Jimin Ha



"Nine, nine, nineteen (nine, nine, nine)",

are lyrics from the song "9-TEEN" by famous K-pop group, Seventeen. Wonder why they repeat the number nine so much? It's because 19 is a special age in Korea, conveying a special meaning for those who are attending high school and want to go to university.

In Korea, we call high school seniors "gosam" - and with a K added it becomes "K-Gosam" - a meme that teases realities of harsh life preparing for college. K stands for Korea, but for us it also means K from KMLA. Rushing towards the goal of university acceptance is a hard journey for everyone, but KMLAians will think that it is 100 times harder because we need to compete with our smart and talented friends who we care about, love, and even live with. Therefore, we are stressed by emotional issues on top of mental and physical ones.

The Gosams, the seniors in KMLA, usually get "senioritis" — the colloquial name for the decreased motivation toward studies displayed by students who have almost reached graduation. Teens with senioritis may drag themselves to classes like sloths, fall asleep on open books, or watch YouTube or play games instead of researching majors or preparing for exams. They don't join club activities with the same passion, and if their exam scores are bad they get the impulse to toss in the towel on battling forward to get into a name-value university. Senioritis is similar to burnout, so naturally, curing senioritis is all about motivation. An academic advisor of Southern New Hampshire University, Abby Tincher, recommends keeping a positive attitude through until the end and to keep the end goal in sight. Here are some tips Tincher suggests for overcoming senioritis.

- Set goals to get motivated.
- Reward yourself.
- Get yourself organized and on schedule.
- Surround yourself with support.
- Change things up.
- Take a break.
- Remember what you're working toward.

Minjok Herald conducted a survey among KMLA seniors to explore their experiences and perceptions as they turned nineteen. Out of the 22 participants, all reported feeling different as seniors, with **82%** admitting to increased pressure while **95%** acknowledged the benefits associated with their senior status, such as fixed study seats and stronger friendships. Surprisingly, **77%** expressed a longing to go back to their freshman and junior years to rectify academic regrets, while **23%** preferred to graduate swiftly, citing the hardships and responsibilities they faced. This survey provides insight into the complex mix of emotions and aspirations among KMLA seniors.

The survey conducted by Minjok Herald delved into the lives of KMLA seniors and their transition to the age of nineteen. With 22 participants, it was revealed that all seniors experienced a sense of change compared to previous years. A notable **82%** of respondents expressed feeling increased pressure, while an overwhelming **95%** acknowledged the advantages that came with being a senior, such as securing study seats and forming closer bonds with peers. Surprisingly, **77%** expressed a desire to revisit their freshman and junior years to address academic regrets, while **23%** wished to expedite graduation to escape the challenges and responsibilities they faced. This survey highlights the nuanced emotions and aspirations of KMLA seniors.

The survey said the greatest proportion of respondents' stress comes from **GPA**. Eleven respondents voted on GPA as the source of stress, and next was CSAT by 8 votes. Other foundations of stress were SAT, EC, AP, recommendation letters, and friends. The last question was "What gosam means to you". One said it is a hit by reality, another said it's an opportunity. One said it is a way to find myself, and one said it is the last ordeal before becoming happy. Every response was quite sad and depressing, but everyone, including Minjok Herald writers, knows that seniors will endure this time successfully, and become fully-functioning and contributing-to-society (maybe is really big ways!) adults. You, 26th wavers, are about to start the greatest improvisation of all. This harsh, but short journey will take you towards what you have dreamed of.

So - let's go KMLA gosams!!

3 Movies to Watch After Midterms

26th waver Dohun Kang

Life at KMLA is a constant juggle of work vs. more work··· and maybe a little bit of play. What would your brain's state be if there weren't at least one cat video a day to give it some relief from AP Calculus? It would be depressed mush. So why not fully rescue it by putting on a good movie to enjoy with friends? Three movies that will have a lasting impact on KMLAians: **Forrest Gump, Oppenheimer, and Elementals**. Three great films made by the hands of three outstanding directors with unique styles. The Minjok Herald will not spoil them but will instead emphasize why students should see them in their limited leisure time and what they may earn in accordance with KMLA ideals.

Forrest Gump is today's retro recommendation. In 1994, before any current KMLA students were born, Forrest Gump follows Forrest, a low-IQ but big-hearted man, through the 1950s until the 80s, capturing defining moments of US history as Forest's life progresses from childhood to adulthood. The movie is a classic, and many students might have seen it already, but even if so you should watch it again. He maximizes his talents and succeeds in life. His triumph comes with tragedy, as he endures various tragedies that mold him. Forrest inspires others with his optimism and kindness even in difficult times. Like me, KMLAians will see Forrest as a role model. He works hard, sacrifices, and never gives up. The movie's main subject is Forrest's determination to succeed, using his talents to the fullest. After watching this movie, you'll feel inspired to work hard in any situation with a clear goal.

The second movie is Oppenheimer, directed by Christopher Nolan. Director of Interstellar and Inception and known for not utilizing CGI, Nolan returned to theaters on August 15th in Korea with a biographical picture about the "father of the atomic bomb," J. Robert Oppenheimer. KMLA students will love the movie because it is scholarly, historical, philosophical, and leaves the viewer thinking. As you know, Oppenheimer creates the atomic bomb, which the US dropped on Japan, killing hundreds of thousands.Throughout the film, Oppenheimer feels guilty for the deaths, quoting, "Now I am become death, the destroyer of worlds." The film raises moral questions and makes viewers consider the repercussions of their actions. Despite its 3-hour runtime, the film keeps viewers engaged, maintains tension, and makes them think. I recommend Oppenheimer to students who seek a serious film about justice, as it sparks debate across numerous subjects.

Finally, the film I will recommend most to KMLA students: **Elementals**. It's a movie we can relate to and ponder as Ember, a second-generation immigrant, navigates Element City. Like any young adult, she struggles to keep her father happy and proud as she pursues her aspirations to fit into a world that sometimes doesn't fit her. She must hide her genuine feelings to avoid disappointing her family. Amber learns her true personality and career goals after meeting Wade, a city official. Why does this movie relate to KMLA students? Or any other teen? We constantly face choices. One is to follow our parents' work route because that is "safe" and what others do. Or··· follow your heart, jump, and do what you want even if it's impractical? Congratulations to students with matching options! But for those who feel like a puzzle piece that doesn't always fit, I hope this film helps figure out a healthy future. The film also addresses living in a multicultural environment and retaining your cultural identity while tolerating others. International students can watch it on the plane as they head into the unknown and occasionally lonely worlds waiting for them abroad. Elementals is a great choice for students who wish to rekindle their soul's spark, pioneer their own road, or just watch an emotional animation.

So don't be afraid to break out the popcorn even if there's a quiz due. There's never a "perfect time" at KMLA, so if you're going to "waste it" on entertainment you won't be wasting it on any of these films. Enjoy!

How to Survive in KMLA's Campus

28th waver Minho Choi

Walking through our vast campus is like participating in an extreme sport. Forget about regular high schoolers strolling to class. We're practically mountaineers on a mission! If you are late for class, the school's footpaths become an obstacle course, complete with bumpy concrete, worn paths, and steep slopes that give us unintended adrenaline rushes stronger than the caffeine punch of three cans of Monster. No one needs that to start their morning.

And morning exercise? Trying to be alert and awake at 6 a.m. is like asking a sloth to run a marathon. We're tired from late-night study sessions, and the struggle is real. The injured get to skip it, but they have to present a signed paper as proof. It's really hard to get permission. If the injury isn't severe, you're forced to attend the exercise even though you're really feeling sick. But the real danger lies in the race against time. With the exercise starting at 6:30 a.m., most students pour out of their dorms around 6:20 to 6:25. It's like a mini Olympics sprint event. Our half-awake bodies make it easy for us to trip, sprain ankles, or scrape knees. It's a true test of balance and speed, especially when we're wearing those long, uncomfortable robes. The rush to the gym is enough to make our spirits sag.

Oh, and let's not forget the weightlifting program we unknowingly signed up for. Carrying textbooks and laptops all day is no joke. According to scientific calculations (we KMLAians are experts, you know), our school bags exert the same force as dropping an apple from an 80-meter height. Talk about a gravity-defying workout! And we have to endure that force all day until we can finally put our bags down.

Now, about those old and worn facilities... Well, let's just say they have character. Our school is like a time capsule, preserving the spirit of ancient times. But hey, we finally got new beds! It only took a quarter century, but it is a mark of tangible and certain progress. Who needs modern facilities when you can experience the thrill of living on the edge?

Anyways - love or hate the daily adventure traversing up and down our infamous hill - here are some tips for us poor students:

1. Do not run up the hill. Running makes your muscles get tired easily. And plus, you might get injured by falling down. Instead, try to walk in big strides. Less tiredness, more effectiveness.

2. If your bag isn't very heavy, carry it with your hand. It reduces the force applied to your shoulders.

3. Breathe deeply. Fast breathing causes fast heartbeats and nausea.

4. Also, there are some minor shortcuts that Mr. Ganse pioneered. Ask the members of CrossCountry about the "Ganse route."

5. Get a good night's sleep. Sure, KMLA isn't a place that offers you "beauty sleep." But a few less YouTube videos or Instagram posts etc. will allow you to cross out a few more things on your to-do list and give you a much-needed physical boost to get you through the week!

When it comes to infrastructure, our school isn't described as "brand new, but it makes us into a resilient bunch. And when it comes to planning where classes and dorms are situated, we can't go back in time and beg the school admins and their architects to reconsider. But stronger legs are a definite fact, right? So as our calf muscles and thighs continue to become the thickest of all high school students in Korea, let's embrace the adventure,

laugh at the absurdity, and keep our sense of humor intact. After all, what's life without a little KMLA-style suffering and excitement?

So proud to be KMLAian.

27th waver Seungchan Oh

Talent

I'm so talented in architecture.
Cause I made my own furniture.

Warm

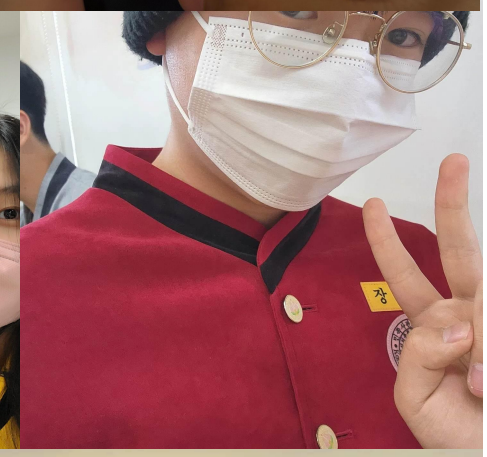
I'm so warm.
Cause I can't wear long pants.

Energized

I'm so energized.
Cause I slept 5 hours and ran in the morning.

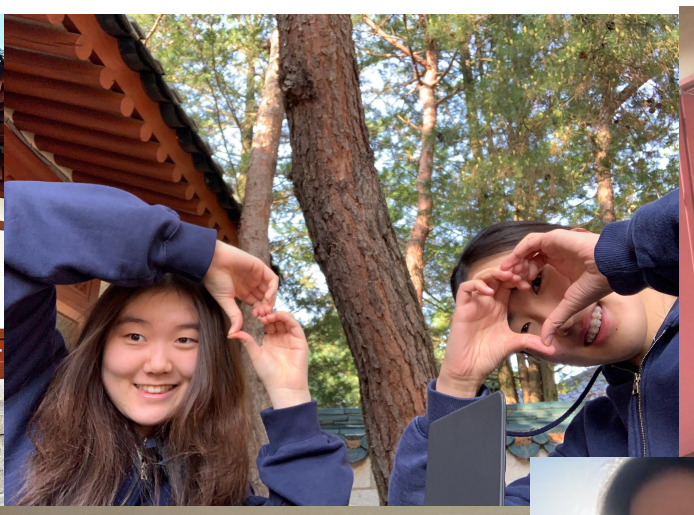
Proud censoring

I'm proud to be censored.
Cause it means I’m right.



SNAP

器之樑棟



SHOTS

LIFE IS A PARTY
LET'S CELEBRATE IT!

SHOP NOW!
PLAYBILL
THE LION KING

“**The o**nes **who** a**r**e crazy **e**noug**h** t**o** t**h**ink t**hey** ca**n** c**h**ange t**he wo**rld a**r**e t**hos**e **who** d**o**.” – **Steve Jobs**